

TEACHING THE MULTIPARAGRAPH ESSAY:
Personal and Fictional Narrative



Composition Guide
GRADES K-12

Personal and Fictional Narrative

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Jane Schaffer Writing Program



allstudentscanwrite



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Dedicated to the lessons, the classroom narratives, and the mentoring
of
Jane C. Schaffer

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Common Core State Standards: Writing Narratives

(highlighted areas show vertical alignment additions or deletions)

Grade	Standards	The Jane Schaffer Writing Program's Narrative Workshop Covers the Following Standards:
K-2	CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.W.K.3	Use a combination of drawing, dictating, and writing to narrate a single event or several loosely linked events, tell about the events in the order in which they occurred, and provide a reaction to what happened.
	CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.W.1.3	Write narratives in which they recount two or more appropriately sequenced events, include some details regarding what happened, use temporal words to signal event order, and provide some sense of closure.
	CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.W.2.3	Write narratives in which they recount a well-elaborated event or short sequence of events, include details to describe actions, thoughts, and feelings, use temporal words to signal event order, and provide a sense of closure.

Grade	Standards	The Jane Schaffer Writing Program's Narrative Workshop Covers the Following Standards:
3	CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.W.3.3	Write narratives to develop real or imagined experiences or events using effective technique, descriptive details, and clear event sequences.
	CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.W.3.3.A	Establish a situation and introduce a narrator and/or characters; organize an event sequence that unfolds naturally.
	CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.W.3.3.B	Use dialogue and descriptions of actions, thoughts, and feelings to develop experiences and events or show the response of characters to situations.
	CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.W.3.3.C	Use temporal words and phrases to signal event order.
	CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.W.3.3.D	Provide a sense of closure.
	CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.W.3.4	With guidance and support from adults, produce writing in which the development and organization are appropriate to task and purpose.
	CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.W.3.5	With guidance and support from peers and adults, develop and strengthen writing as needed by planning, revising, and editing. (Editing for conventions should demonstrate command of Language standards 1-3 up to and including grade 3 here.)
	CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.W.3.6	With guidance and support from adults, use technology to produce and publish writing (using keyboarding skills) as well as to interact and collaborate with others.
	CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.W.3.10	Write routinely over extended time frames (time for research, reflection, and revision) and shorter time frames (a single sitting or a day or two) for a range of discipline-specific tasks, purposes, and audiences.

Grade	Standards	The Jane Schaffer Writing Program's Narrative Workshop Covers the Following Standards:
4	CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.W.4.3	Write narratives to develop real or imagined experiences or events using effective technique, descriptive details, and clear event sequences.
	CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.W.4.3.A	Orient the reader by establishing a situation and introducing a narrator and/or characters; organize an event sequence that unfolds naturally.
	CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.W.4.3.B	Use dialogue and description to develop experiences and events or show the responses of characters to situations.
	CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.W.4.3.C	Use a variety of transitional words and phrases to manage the sequence of events.
	CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.W.4.3.D	Use concrete words and phrases and sensory details to convey experiences and events precisely.
	CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.W.4.3E	Provide a conclusion that follows from the narrated experiences or events.
	CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.W.4.4	Produce clear and coherent writing in which the development and organization are appropriate to task, purpose, and audience. (guidance and support not included)
	CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.W.4.5	With guidance and support from peers and adults, develop and strengthen writing as needed by planning, revising, and editing. (Editing for conventions should demonstrate command of Language standards 1-3 up to and including grade 4 here.)
	CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.W.4.6	With some guidance and support from adults, use technology, including the Internet, to produce and publish writing as well as to interact and collaborate with others; demonstrate sufficient command of keyboarding skills to type a minimum of one page in a single sitting.
	CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.W.4.10	Write routinely over extended time frames (time for research, reflection, and revision) and shorter time frames (a single sitting or a day or two) for a range of discipline-specific tasks, purposes, and audiences.

Grade	Standards	The Jane Schaffer Writing Program's Narrative Workshop Covers the Following Standards:
5	CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.W.5.3	Write narratives to develop real or imagined experiences or events using effective technique, descriptive details, and clear event sequences.
	CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.W.5.3.A	Orient the reader by establishing a situation and introducing a narrator and/or characters; organize an event sequence that unfolds naturally.
	CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.W.5.3.B	Use narrative techniques, such as dialogue, description, and pacing, to develop experiences and events or show the responses of characters to situations.
	CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.W.5.3.C	Use a variety of transitional words, phrases, and clauses to manage the sequence of events.
	CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.W.5.3.D	Use concrete words and phrases and sensory details to convey experiences and events precisely.
	CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.W.5.3.E	Provide a conclusion that follows from the narrated experiences or events
	CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.W.5.4	Produce clear and coherent writing in which the development and organization are appropriate to task, purpose, and audience.
	CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.W.5.5	With guidance and support from peers and adults, develop and strengthen writing as needed by planning, revising, editing, rewriting, or trying a new approach. (Editing for conventions should demonstrate command of Language standards 1-3 up to and including grade 5 here.)
	CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.W.5.6	With some guidance and support from adults, use technology, including the Internet, to produce and publish writing as well as to interact and collaborate with others; demonstrate sufficient command of keyboarding skills to type a minimum of two pages in a single sitting.
	CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.W.5.10	Write routinely over extended time frames (time for research, reflection, and revision) and shorter time frames (a single sitting or a day or two) for a range of discipline-specific tasks, purposes, and audiences.

Grade	Standards	The Jane Schaffer Writing Program's Narrative Workshop Covers the Following Standards:
	CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.W.6.3	Write narratives to develop real or imagined experiences or events using effective technique, relevant descriptive details, and well-structured event sequences.
6	CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.W.6.3.A	Engage and orient the reader by establishing a context and introducing a narrator and/or characters; organize an event sequence that unfolds naturally and logically.
	CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.W.6.3.B	Use narrative techniques, such as dialogue, pacing, and description, to develop experiences, events and/or characters.
	CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.W.6.3.C	Use a variety of transition words, phrases, and clauses to convey sequence and signal shifts from one time frame or setting to another.
	CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.W.6.3.D	Use precise words and phrases, relevant descriptive details, and sensory language to convey experiences and events.
	CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.W.6.3.E	Provide a conclusion that follows from the narrated experiences or events
	CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.W.6.4	Produce clear and coherent writing in which the development and organization are appropriate to task, purpose, and audience.
	CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.W.6.5	With guidance and support from peers and adults, develop and strengthen writing as needed by planning, revising, editing, rewriting, or trying a new approach. (Editing for conventions should demonstrate command of Language standards 1-3 up to and including grade 6 here.)
	CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.W.6.6	With some guidance and support from adults, use technology, including the Internet, to produce and publish writing as well as to interact and collaborate with others; demonstrate sufficient command of keyboarding skills to type a minimum of three pages in a single sitting.
	CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.W.6.10	Write routinely over extended time frames (time for research, reflection, and revision) and shorter time frames (a single sitting or a day or two) for a range of discipline-specific tasks, purposes, and audiences.

Grade	Standards	The Jane Schaffer Writing Program's Narrative Workshop Covers the Following Standards:
	CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.W.7.3	Write narratives to develop real or imagined experiences or events using effective technique, relevant descriptive details, and well-structured event sequences.
7	CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.W.7.3.A	Engage and orient the reader by establishing a context and point of view and introducing a narrator and/or characters; organize an event sequence that unfolds naturally and logically.
	CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.W.7.3.B	Use narrative techniques, such as dialogue, pacing, and description, to develop experiences, events and/or characters.
	CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.W.7.3.C	Use a variety of transition words, phrases, and clauses to convey sequence and signal shifts from one time frame or setting to another.
	CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.W.7.3.D	Use precise words and phrases, relevant descriptive details, and sensory language to convey experiences and events.
	CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.W.7.3.E	Provide a conclusion that follows from and reflects on the narrated experiences or events
	CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.W.7.4	Produce clear and coherent writing in which the development, organization, and style are appropriate to task, purpose, and audience.
	CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.W.7.5	With some guidance and support from peers and adults, develop and strengthen writing as needed by planning, revising, editing, rewriting, or trying a new approach, focusing on how well purpose and audience have been addressed. (Editing for conventions should demonstrate command of Language standards 1-3 up to and including grade 7 here.)
	CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.W.7.6	Use technology, including the Internet, to produce and publish writing and link to and cite sources as well as to interact and collaborate with others; including linking to and citing sources.
	CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.W.7.10	Write routinely over extended time frames (time for research, reflection, and revision) and shorter time frames (a single sitting or a day or two) for a range of discipline-specific tasks, purposes, and audiences.

Grade	Standards	The Jane Schaffer Writing Program's Narrative Workshop Covers the Following Standards:
	CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.W.8.3	Write narratives to develop real or imagined experiences or events using effective technique, relevant descriptive details, and well-structured event sequences.
8	CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.W.8.3.A	Engage and orient the reader by establishing a context and point of view and introducing a narrator and/or characters; organize an event sequence that unfolds naturally and logically.
	CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.W.8.3.B	Use narrative techniques, such as dialogue, pacing, description, and reflection, to develop experiences, events and/or characters.
	CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.W.8.3.C	Use a variety of transition words, phrases, and clauses to convey sequence, signal shifts from one time frame or setting to another, and show the relationships among experiences and events.
	CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.W.8.3.D	Use precise words and phrases, relevant descriptive details, and sensory language to capture the action and convey experiences and events.
	CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.W.8.3.E	Provide a conclusion that follows from and reflects on the narrated experiences or events
	CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.W.8.4	Produce clear and coherent writing in which the development, organization, and style are appropriate to task, purpose, and audience.
	CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.W.8.5	With some guidance and support from peers and adults, develop and strengthen writing as needed by planning, revising, editing, rewriting, or trying a new approach, focusing on how well purpose and audience have been addressed. (Editing for conventions should demonstrate command of Language standards 1-3 up to and including grade 8 here.)
	CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.W.8.6	Use technology, including the Internet, to produce and publish writing and present the relationships between information and ideas efficiently as well as to interact and collaborate with others
	CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.W.8.10	Write routinely over extended time frames (time for research, reflection, and revision) and shorter time frames (a single sitting or a day or two) for a range of discipline-specific tasks, purposes, and audiences.

History of the Founder and the Program

Jane Schaffer earned her degree in French and English at UCLA in 1968 and her secondary teaching credential from San Diego State College in 1969 and started teaching English, French, and Latin later that year. Since then, her quest has always been to find a way to teach all students how to write. She developed her writing program for students at all levels from special education and English Language Learners (ELL) through honors, Pre-AP®, and Advanced Placement® (AP®).

She taught at Santana High School in Santee, California, for eighteen years. In 1987, she and a colleague helped to open West Hills High School in Santee, a new school in the same district.

They had the opportunity to teach paragraph and essay writing to freshmen rather than to juniors and seniors as had been done at her previous school. The program led their students at all grade levels to the #1 spot (of ten comprehensive high schools) on the annual district writing assessment, a place held for many years.

The inspiration for this guide springs from Schaffer's own experiences as a student in school. Like many teachers, she didn't learn how to write in high school and did poorly as a college freshman. Her college professors made comments such as "It's obvious you can't write." She met many teachers who were treated similarly. To borrow from William Faulkner, they all not only endured; they prevailed.

Ever since, we wanted to spare our students the same embarrassment and humiliation that we felt when our essays earned Ds and Fs. The goal of this guide is to demystify the blank page and enable every student to master the elements of composition. Students often think that writing is a mystery, and only the teacher has the solution. It isn't a secret; it's just hard work. Teaching writing is teaching thinking. Our goal is to break the process into digestible steps that all students can follow.

Over the years, we have conducted many workshops in many states and countries to share our writing program, and we continue to do so. In 1984, we started offering workshops in Advanced Placement Literature and Composition in San Diego and have branched out since then to include Program Improvement districts, schools with 900 API, and grades ranging from kindergarten to college. Currently, we employ national trainers who conduct our workshops.

In all our workshops and in this guide, we strive to give the *why* as well as the *how*. This guide represents three days of response to literature training.

The Early Years

As young teachers in the early 1970s, we adopted a structured approach to writing because we were desperate. Our students' writing was chaotic. It had no sense of beginning, middle, or end, with no order to the thoughts and no higher-order thinking at all. It was filled with what we call

concrete detail -- *who, what, when, where*, but no *how* or *why*. Students simply grabbed sentences out of the air and wrote just enough to fill the page.

For several years, we used the ideas in *Power Writing* by J. E. Sparks, professor at the University of Southern California. He developed a numbered paragraph structure guided by a main idea supported with details. We liked the increased organization in students' writing but thought the paragraphs were missing something. They lacked a "so what?" That "so what?" turned out to be a concept called *commentary*.

How Commentary Began

The missing piece, the "so what?", was born one day during a one-to-one conference with a gifted junior. He was writing an essay in 1975 about how Lake Erie had changed since he had been a young boy living there. He brought his prewriting to the teacher at her desk. The teacher looked over the list of concrete details and told the boy to analyze his examples — pollution, dead fish, oil slicks on the beach, the fire when the Cuyahoga River burned. The teacher said, "These look good – now go analyze them."

The boy said, "I have no idea what you teachers mean by *analyze*." This was a reasonable statement; he wanted to do the assignment but didn't know how to begin or what it should look like when he was finished. Then the teacher asked him to say how the experience had changed or affected him. He thought for a few seconds and said, "I realized my past was lost. The cherished days of my childhood were ruined. The halcyon days were behind me." The boy really said "halcyon." Schaffer was speechless that a student knew the word and used it correctly.

The teacher said, "You did it — what you said to me was analysis. And we're going to call it *commentary* because you *commented* to me about your details." It's a far more user-friendly word for teenagers than *analysis* and *interpretation*. That day began a department conversation about what it means to analyze a topic and how to lead teenagers away from plot summary — the bane of English teachers' existence — and toward deeper thought. Most teachers don't remember how they learned to write. They often taught themselves and alone made the leap from plot summary to analysis. Some know a certain person who helped them, but most of us have no memory of the moment. We just did it.

That student's reactions made us realize two points:

- 1) Talking is the missing link in thinking. Students can say what they are thinking but need help getting it down on paper.
- 2) We assumed far too much about both content and mechanics, and that has rung true ever since. We thought students knew about topic sentences and indentations and analysis, but we were wrong on every count. We like to think we've made unwarranted assumptions less frequently since then.

Critical Terms in the Program

Five terms deserve attention here as unique parts of the Jane Schaffer Writing Program®. Other terms in the program, such as *introduction*, *body*, and *conclusion*, are commonly used everywhere. Our unique terms are illustrated in Fig. 1 and include:

- *topic sentence* (abbreviated as *TS*)
- *concrete detail* (abbreviated as *CDs*)
- *commentary* (abbreviated as *CMs*)
- *chunk*
- *ratio of CDs to CMs*

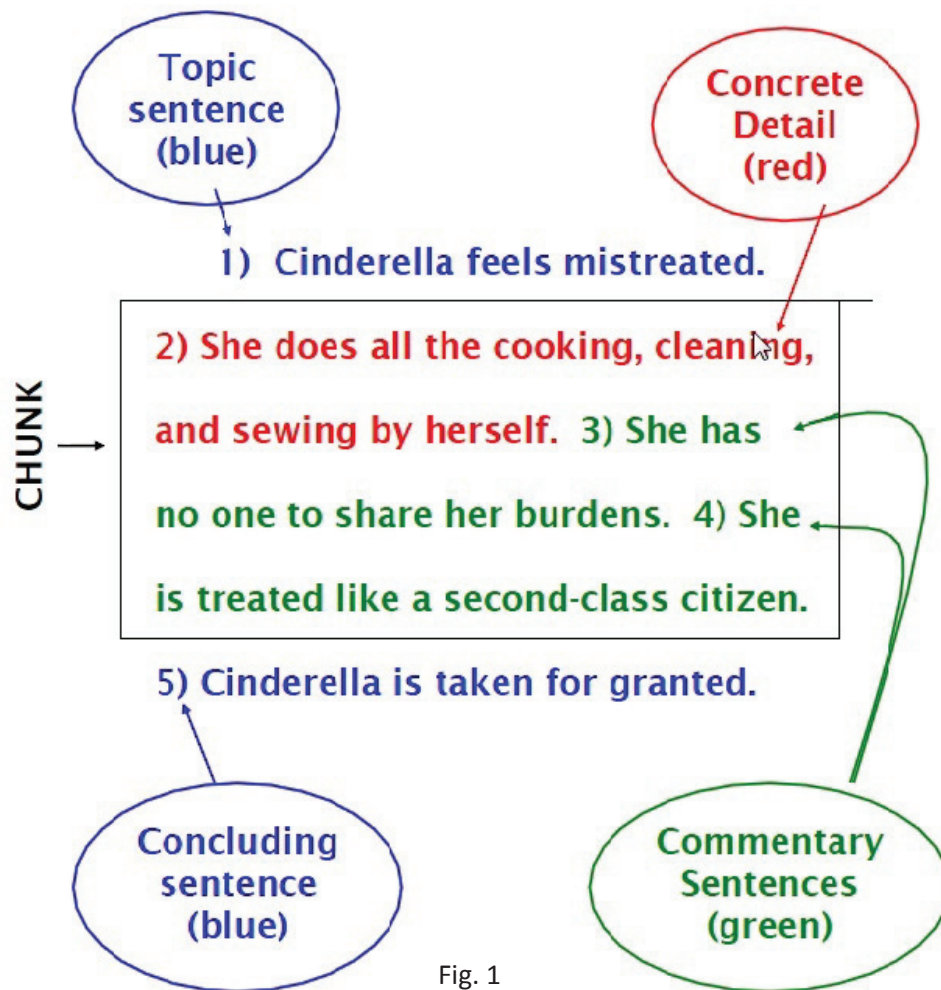


Fig. 1

1. *Topic sentence* (commonly abbreviated as *TS*)

Our topic sentence is not a summary sentence that starts a report, as many students have done before they come to us. Here's an example of an incorrect topic sentence, one that does not meet our requirements for the following prompt:

Prompt: Write a paragraph that discusses George and Lennie's goal.

Incorrect topic sentence: In *Of Mice and Men*, George and Lennie save money to buy a farm.

This topic sentence is all plot summary, all concrete detail with no commentary. We are looking for an analytical topic sentence with a subject and an opinion, which we call *commentary*, and no, or virtually no, concrete detail. Any connotative word counts as a commentary word. This topic sentence is better:

Correct topic sentence: In *Of Mice and Men*, George and Lennie yearn to buy a place of their own.

Our model has two commentary points: *yearn* and *place of their own*. Both have feelings that students can identify (can point to): *yearn* conveys a deep longing or wanting; a *place of their own* suggests an ownership of something personal, something that belongs to them alone, somewhere they belong.

It turned out to be as simple as counting the number of commentary words in the sentence to show us that this topic sentence works. We ask students to circle the commentary words and then show us the sentence. Our minimum requirement for a paragraph assignment is one commentary point or word. Students may include more than one -- two or three and sometimes more. Here are examples for Cinderella:

- Topic sentence with one commentary point:

Cinderella feels sad.

- Topic sentence with two commentary points:

Cinderella feels sad and lonely.

- Topic sentence with three commentary points:

Cinderella feels lonely, catering to everyone's needs but her own.

2. *Concrete detail* (abbreviated by our students as *CDs*)

These sentences answer the questions, *Who? What? When? Where? What happens in the story?* They are facts, not opinions. The words and phrases describe anything that is in the story. They do not answer the questions *Why?* and *How?*

The easiest concrete details for students to practice in the beginning state literally what a character does. Every student has something to say; it's what they talk about at school all the time when they discuss their day there. We start with paraphrased concrete details because they avoid the punctuation and capitalization issues associated with quotation CDs. Students learn those later on.

Here are examples from *Cinderella*:

After her father dies, she does all the cooking and cleaning by herself
(2).

3. *Commentary* (abbreviated by our students as *CMs*)

Commentary means any word that has connotations, or feelings, that students can explain to us. We show them three words to model our thinking: *walk*, *stroll*, and *strut*.

The word *walk* has no connotation; it means literally to place one foot in front of the other in order to move. The word *stroll*, though, has feelings attached to it. It has the feeling, or connotation, of slowness, a casual feeling, taking your time. The word *strut* is another connotative word; it conveys feelings of "say it loud, say it proud," a sense of arrogance or cockiness.

We tell students that a topic sentence with *walk* would not do the job, but one with *stroll* or *strut* would. This helps them begin to understand the concept. If we need more examples, we use *eat*, *inhale*, and *gobble*; *look*, *stare*, and *glare*; and so on.

4. *Chunk*

A *chunk* describes the part of the response to literature paragraph that includes one part concrete detail and two or more parts of commentary. It isn't the whole paragraph; it is the section that comes between the topic sentence and the concluding sentence. One student remembered it as the part between the blue bookends. This chart, also available in poster form on our website, has helped to clarify students' thinking.

5. *Ratio of concrete detail (CD) to commentary (CM) in a body paragraph*

Ratio compares the amount of concrete detail to the amount of commentary in a body paragraph. The ratio we are looking for in a response to literature paragraph is 1:2+. In other words, for every sentence of concrete detail, we want two or more sentences of commentary. The plus (+) is critical. Students may always write more than two commentary thoughts.

Students will try to write two other ratios:

- 1:1 (one part CD to one part CM)

The ratio of 1:1 is a good beginning (and for the AP United States History DBQ, it is recommended), but English teachers instructing students in literary analysis have said that the commentary felt undeveloped and needed more thought to elaborate on the first point. The second commentary has always been the harder of the two to produce but the one that adds richness to the overall thought.

- 1:0 (only concrete detail with no commentary at all)
If students write 1:0, we call that plot summary, a reading check, or a book report.

People have asked how the *ratio between concrete detail and commentary* came about. We had scored essays at holistic sessions, including the Advanced Placement® (AP®) English exam; the old SAT writing test (now part of the SAT I); the California state writing assessments for middle and high school; and, local district writing assessments. We wondered if there were magic numbers we could teach students to give them signposts — number of words, sentences, paragraphs. So we started counting everything and discovered that there was, indeed, a numerical yardstick that could guide students. The ratio turned out to be this:

1 : 2+

Papers that held to this ratio earned higher scores than those that did not. Again, students can always develop their thoughts more; the plus (+) in the ratio means they can include more than two points of commentary. After one student asked, “Is it OK if I have a third thought?” we laughed at ourselves and learned to encourage them even more. However, the textual evidence is important, and novice writers tend to go off topic if they write too many commentary sentences. What happens is that they become so far removed from the CD that they 1) leave the point they were trying to make; and 2) have a difficult time returning to their original thought. Simply monitor.

The 1:2+ ratio applies to response to literature writing but changes for other genres of writing which is found on page ____ of this document.

We still analyze paragraphs and essays on released exams to make sure the ratio hasn’t changed, and it hasn’t. It still applies for response to literature paragraphs and essays.

JANE SCHAFFER'S NON-NEGOTIABLES

Philosophical Points

NN#1. All students can think; all students can write.

NN#2. Formula/structure is a place to start for students who need it; some don't need it at all. We want students to leave the formula behind when they are ready to do so. Breaking the formula is called weaving – mixing fact and opinion/concrete detail and commentary.

NN#3. Consistency of a program outweighs individual teacher preference. Everyone abides by majority votes.

NN#4. Common terminology for the paragraph and essay helps students learn.

NN#5. Writing is a process that includes the prompt, prewriting, T-charts, webbing pages, graphic organizers/shaping sheets, drafting, revisions, and rubrics. All of these steps are required.

NN#6. Meeting regularly to talk about student work is critical.

What We Do in Class

NN#7. We color-code the paragraph and the essay on the overhead or a whiteboard (black, blue, red, and green pens).

NN#8. We use a department-wide scoring guide for all writing assignments.

NN#9. We see students in one-to-one conferencing as often as possible.

NN#10. We have multiyear, cumulative writing folders for each student that we pass on to the next teacher each fall.

NN#11. We write with each other and with our students (Shared Writing); "We can't teach what we don't do" (Carol Jago).

The Formula Issue

We would like to comment on the formulaic nature that underlies the Jane Schaffer Writing Program®. Our philosophy is guided by three beliefs, and these beliefs have become Jane's #2 Non-Negotiable:

- 1) **Formula is a place to start for students who need it.**
- 2) **Some students don't need it at all, not even for a minute. If teachers take those writers backward into a formula, they are violating the integrity of the Jane Schaffer Writing Program® in particular and the writing process in general.**
- 3) **Our goal is for all students to leave the structure as soon as they are ready.**

Rationale

1. **Formula is a place to start for students who need it.**

Just as novice cooks need a recipe or beginning riders need training wheels, some students benefit from having a layout to follow until they master the basics of paragraphs and essays. It is one more example of scaffolding.

Some say that the program stifles creativity. A music teacher reminded us, however, that musicians don't play jazz unless they know scales and arpeggios. In a discussion with a class, a former student said that even Picasso knew representational figures before he moved into abstract art.

2. **Some students don't need it at all, not even for a minute. If teachers take those writers backward into a formula, they are violating the integrity of the Jane Schaffer Writing Program in particular and the writing process in general.**

With naturally gifted writers or those who come to us well-trained in composition, we just label what they're doing already, clarify the ratio for them, and set them free. We identify these students on the first day's diagnostic sample.

3. **Our goal is for all students to leave the structure when they are ready.**

The formula doesn't bother us because, unlike other formulaic approaches, we want and expect students to leave it after they have mastered it. We do not hold students to the formula once they are ready to make the leap out of it. Some students ask about leaving it behind in the first week; others hold onto it throughout high school as a guideline to make sure they don't go off-track. You, the teacher, the expert, however, must not make the same mistakes others have made by putting your students in a box and making them stay there.

The most noticeable change when students leave the formula occurs in what students call *weaving* – mixing concrete detail and commentary thoughts in the same sentence. The structure is a means to an end, not the end in itself. Our end is and always will be the same: a process-driven, product-oriented piece of writing that makes sense to the reader.

Jane's #7 Non-Negotiable: Color Coding

We color-code the paragraph and the essay. Along with Collaborative Writing, we learned it from elementary teachers. The kinesthetic approach to learning is well documented and helps students to master content. We asked one seventh-grade boy why he liked using the colored pens. He said, "They help me remember what kind of thoughts I need to include and where to put them."

Here is a chart of the colors and their applications:

COLOR	APPLICATION
blue	topic sentence and concluding sentence in a body paragraph
red	concrete detail in a body paragraph
green	commentary in a body paragraph
black	the entire introduction and conclusion in an essay

We chose our four colors because they were the least expensive ballpoint pens available at office supply stores. Colored pencils work as well but are more expensive and need sharpening often; however, many elementary teachers prefer them. We wanted four separate pens that students could pick up and use because we saw a greater engraving of the concepts on the brain when they did this. We like students to use those pens made of a single piece of plastic, not the two-tone ones with a color at the top and a white barrel. Students, who are sometimes mischievous, can break them or change the colors to another pen.

We don't recommend the pens with four colors in one. They are less expensive but don't ensure the same results that we see with four different pens. When we are reading a nonfiction piece, we have the students underline the parts of a paragraph, using the correct color. Or, we have them purchase highlighters – blue for TS and CS; pink for CD; green for CM; and yellow for thesis statement. Caution: Highlighters will dry out overnight if not capped properly.

Students will wean themselves from the colored pens when they are ready; we do not recommend requiring them *ad nauseum*. Depending on the individual child and the expectations, some students leave the colored pens behind on the second or third day of class; others want to use them throughout elementary school, middle school, and or high school. One senior in high school said, “They help me think thoughts.” We encourage students to use whatever tools will help them think clearly. Some teachers like the final drafts color-coded, but we recommend that final drafts for high school students be typed or written in black/blue ink. For elementary students, we like to see the color-coded paragraphs and final drafts. For middle school, we start out with color-coding. If we are approaching the program from a vertical perspective, K-12, color-coding begins the year, every year, but disappears in the high school years after the first week (Again, the decision depends on the student and the complexity of the work.).

There are many ways to organize the pens. Our preferred approach is to put the pens in quart-size lock-top baggies for each student. Some teachers number the baggies with a Sharpie and assign each bag to a specific student each class period or block. We leave the bagged sets in a basket by the door and train our students to pick one up each day when they come in and return it to the basket on their way out. Deborah Louis assigns Materials Managers each cycle. These students not only pick up the baggies five minutes before the bell without being told, checking to make sure all pens are accounted for, but also she has them pass out papers, pick up papers, run administrative-type errands, and block the door so no one will interrupt (Just kidding on “blocking the door.” We sure would like to do that sometimes, wouldn’t we?)

In some classes, students have a set of pens of their own and bring them each day, but we like to be prepared for as many situations as possible. We sometimes decide to remove the caps to prevent harm to people and damage to desks.

If you are fully digital, then pens are not an issue.

One more admonition: Some students and teachers are color-blind. In that case we simply label the sentences: TS, CD, CM, CS.

Four Stages of Teaching

We have watched our own teacher behaviors over the last four decades, observed other teachers in grades kindergarten through college, and read teaching theory in *English Journal*, *Voices from the Middle*, and works by Nancie Atwell, Anne Berthoff, Madeline Hunter, Ken Macrorie, James Moffett, and Donald Murray. All of these sources have guided us to recognize four stages of teaching behavior. Our sample timelines indicate the appropriate stage for each day's lesson, recognizing that the stages usually overlap and need teacher direction.

#1	Model
#2	Collaborative Writing
#3	Pair/Small Group
#4	Independent

The Model (M)

We always supply a model (M) for an assignment. We learn by models; we need to know what an assignment should resemble when we submit it to our teachers. In addition, as teachers, creating models helps us to troubleshoot our prompts and allows us first-hand knowledge of what students will encounter. We know the model has done its job when a student looks at it and says, “Oh, *that’s* what you meant!”

We know there are two issues regarding models: first, they take time to write; and, second, students sometimes write clones of our model. We would rather help students avoid the “clone” issue than read some of the chaotic writing we’ve seen in the past.

Unfortunately, most of the teachers we have observed do not offer models to their students because of the time involved. When a teacher complains about a class set of papers and we ask to see the model, we often hear that there was no model provided or prompt tested. Students need more guidance than just the prompt. We know that we pay with time before, creating the model, or time after, in correcting the inevitable mistakes. We encourage all teachers to use models and create a bank of them for use with their and their colleagues’ classes. We provide models for various literary works in our workshops.

Collaborative Writing (CW)

Collaborative Writing (CW) means that we write something together as a whole class. It is one of the many scaffolding steps that we use constantly. The teacher leads the lesson, using the chalk board, an interactive white board, a document camera, tablet, or laptop (Prior to a workshop, let JSWP know what technology you use, so we can model our system using your devices.)

For most teenagers, going from the model to small-group work or, even worse, from model to independent work is far too great a leap.

We first saw CW in elementary classrooms where it is a dominant vehicle for instruction. In talking among ourselves, we discussed whether we had ever been taught Collaborative Writing as secondary teachers and realized we had not. Everyone loses. Collaborative Writing provides a mid-step that has unbelievable benefits. There is no grade at stake other than copying and annotating correctly, so students speak up who otherwise wouldn't. They feel safe. Teachers can constantly check for understanding as the class offers ideas and asks questions. We rely upon collaborative writing all year long whenever a new concept is introduced or an old concept needs revisiting.

What we can't tell others is how long or how often they will do this type of writing with their classes. We do know we use it with every new concept until we see that the class is ready to move on. We use it in revisiting an area that may be giving the class some trouble, such as making topic sentences all commentary with no concrete detail in response to literature paragraphs and essays.

Pair/Small Group (PSG)

To make PSG work, teachers must be involved. I row run constantly when doing PSG. If I try to go to my desk to work on something, I get very poor results.

Pair/Small Group work (PSG) is common in classrooms across the country. Some prefer only pairs because it ensures, mostly, that students are actively doing something productive. When a group grows to three, one student is often ignored; the problem increases with groups of four or more. We prefer pairs because we have a better chance of seeing what is called "attending behavior," students are actually participating instead of sitting back and watching.

Many of us remember being in groups in school where we, as individuals, did all the work. We wanted the "A" badly enough to carry the group along, and everyone knew this, so why should anyone else contribute? Pairs make it easier for us to monitor student behavior as well.

Sometimes we move to the PSG level and realize we moved too quickly, that the class was not ready for this mid-level of independence. Students ask more than the usual questions and seem confused. We can see it in their eyes and notice their apprehension. We return immediately to Collaborative Writing until we decide that the class is ready to try PSG again.

Independent (I)

One of the integral components that truly marks your program is that teachers must be involved at every step in the writing process. I use myself as the bad example here. Before I created Jane Schaffer®, I taught writing by giving assignments and going to my desk to do other work. I discouraged questions. My standard response was "Just keep writing."

Actually, I wasn't quite that bad, but it makes the point. Those kids who needed help didn't get it and in many cases, they just gave up.

The Jane Schaffer Writing Program® does not make teaching writing easy. I work much harder now, but I get results for all of my kids.

The Independent level (I) is the one most familiar to teachers and students. Each student does the assignment by him- or herself and turns it in for a grade.

What concerns us greatly is the speed of teachers' lessons. As one woman observed during a workshop, "We teach too fast." We've said it before and will repeat it. We are all racing to cover a scope and sequence, to prepare students for the next state test, or to get through the whole textbook. We have seen districts where the scope and sequence is beyond what the finest teachers could accomplish in one school year. But moving too quickly, moving ahead to another mode of writing before students master the current one, only compounds students' confusion. We have a new credo: Slow Down.

The following chart provides more guidance in the teaching sequence:

STAGES IN THE TEACHING SEQUENCE OF WRITING

Argumentation, Expository / Informational, Narrative, Response to Literature

1.	Teacher Model “Guided Writing” “I Do”	➤ Teacher gives the class a completed example--from the writing prompt to the prewriting to the shaping to the final draft. ➤ Equipment and Materials: ○ hard graphic organizers and pens for each student and teacher (students copy as teacher presents each step and the thinking behind each step) ○ hard copy of the model from start to finish for all students (give this clean copy of all steps after the students copy and submit for grade) ○ chalkboard, dry erase board, interactive whiteboard, or document camera ○ if digital, use Google Docs, JSWP App, BYOD, laptop, digital graphic organizers ➤ Assessment: Credit is given for copying precisely the model either on paper or digitally; ▪ on-task behavior, focus ▪ asking questions, clarification ▪ color-coding correctly ▪ correct grammar, mechanics, usage
2.	Class Collaborative “Shared Writing” “We Do”	➤ The teacher and the students write collaboratively in class. ➤ The teacher guides a thoughtful and multimedia discussion. Shared resources. ➤ Everyone is writing on the same, specific topic. Mutual goal. ➤ Equipment and Materials: see above (no model; hard copies or digital graphic organizers) ➤ Assessment ○ Everyone offers two comments for each part of the process through the final draft. ○ Teacher frequently assesses individuals and group (definitions, colors, purpose) ○ Group processing after each step in the process: “reflecting on the group’s work to clarify and improve the effectiveness of the members in working together to achieve the group’s goals by (a) describing what member actions were helpful and unhelpful and (b) making decisions about what actions to continue or change” (Johnson, et.al). ○ Everyone submits entire process (after each step).
3.	Small Group “Shared Writing” “You Do Together”	➤ Students write in pairs. Use same materials as “We Do.” Analog* only. ➤ Promotive interaction: “Students promote each other’s learning by helping, sharing, and encouraging efforts to learn. Students explain, discuss, and teach what they know to classmates. Teachers structure the groups so that students sit knee-to-knee and talk through each aspect of the assignment” (Johnson, Johnson, & Holubec). ➤ Interpersonal and small group skills: leadership, decision-making, trust-building, communication, conflict management ➤ Assessment: Combining individual accountability with positive interdependence ○ Teacher evaluates ▪ Content – Individual accountability • CDs – list CDs separately; then decide best one(s) together • CMs – list CMs separately; then create sentences together • Student 1 – TS; Student 2 – CS ▪ Interpersonal dynamics and 12-inch voices ○ Each student self-evaluates (positive comments; critique for improvement)
4.	Independent Writing “I Do”	➤ Provide rubric with prompt before process begins ➤ Each student completes the process from start to finish ➤ Publish on walls or in clouds ➤ Assessment – See rubric

*Analog will be used in this document to mean anything not digital

PARAGRAPH FORM

• _____

PARTS OF A PARAGRAPH AND THE JANE SCHAFER CHUNKING TECHNIQUE		
1.	TOPIC SENTENCE (TS)	
2.	CONCRETE DETAIL (CD)	
3.	TRANSITIONAL LEAD-IN TO A CONCRETE DETAIL (TLCD)	
4.	COMMENTARY (CM)	
5.	A CHUNK	
6.	RATIO CD:CM	
7.	TRANSITIONS	
8.	CONCLUDING SENTENCE (CS)	

Jane's #3 Non-Negotiable: Common Terminology

We spent ten years' time asking teachers about the terms they used when they taught writing. To describe the specific information in a story, for example, teachers' answers ranged from *support* to *citations* to *details* and beyond. We were astonished by the number of synonyms that abound in English classes across the country. Those conversations led to our current list of terms on page ____.

Common terminology helps students learn better. As one girl said, "You mean I don't have to un-learn and re-learn and un-learn and re-learn with each teacher?" Students don't always understand that concrete detail, for example, is the same as plot reference, evidence, and proof. They think they are learning entirely different concepts and don't realize that the terms are just synonyms.

To achieve consistency in the curriculum, the first step we took, and the simplest one, was to standardize the terminology within the department. We agreed to operate by majority vote; people in the minority were expected to abide by all department votes. Our philosophy on this approach is quite clear: Consistency of program outweighs individual teacher preference.

It doesn't matter if teachers use different terms. What does matter is that every teacher in the department uses the same terms in every English class and that all students learn the terms during the training unit.

Materials and Activities

1. For Chart #1 that focuses only on concrete details (CDs) and commentary (CMs), we print copies of this page for each student on colored paper for permanent residence and reference in their binders. It takes many practices for them to differentiate between the two concepts and produce good commentary. Having the chart helps them to learn the difference.
2. Two terms deserve explanation. *Play-by-play announcer* and *color commentator* come from sports events and have been extremely valuable in helping students learn to differentiate CDs and CMs. The play-by-play announcer describes the action on the field: *The quarterback just made a 10-yard pass.* The color commentator interprets the play: *He's got a better throwing arm than that and has the skill to make it to the wide receiver.* Even with students who don't follow sports, they understand the reference because our society is permeated with athletics. We provide more analogies in our workshops regarding how to discern CD and CM in various cultural and social settings.

PARTS OF AN ESSAY

ESSAY

A piece of writing that gives your thoughts about a subject. Essays have an introduction, body paragraphs, and a conclusion.

INTRODUCTION

The first paragraph in an essay. It includes the thesis, most often at the end of the introduction.

THESIS

A sentence with a subject and opinion that guides your whole essay. This comes somewhere in your introduction and most often at the end.

BODY PARAGRAPH

A middle paragraph in an essay. It develops a point you want to make or a reason you want to give that supports your thesis.

TOPIC SENTENCE

The first sentence in a body paragraph. This must have a subject and opinion for the paragraph. It does the same thing for a body paragraph that the thesis does for the whole essay.

CHUNK

It is the smallest unified group of thoughts you can write. It is the combination of concrete detail(s) and commentary. (1:2+); (2+:1); (3+:0)

CONCRETE DETAIL (CD)

Examples, facts, details, dialogue, that happens on the outside of you.

- What I have read
- What I have seen
- What I or someone else has done
- What I or someone else said

COMMENTARY (CM)

Your opinion, feelings, or comment about the concrete detail that happen on the inside of you. It comes from

- your mind and your heart
- your opinions and feelings
- your ideas
- your beliefs

TRANSITIONS

Words and phrases that show the connections between concrete details, commentary, and paragraphs. Clear transitions help show how your ideas relate to each other.

CONCLUDING SENTENCE

The last sentence in a body paragraph. With synonyms, highlight the most important words in the paragraph.

CONCLUSION

The last paragraph in your essay. It may sum up your ideas, reflect on what you said in your essay, provide more commentary about your subject, or give a personal statement about the subject. Do not repeat words.

STEPS IN THE WRITING PROCESS

PREWRITING

The process of getting your concrete details and commentary down on paper before you organize your essay into paragraphs.

SHAPING THE ESSAY

The step that is done after prewriting. It is where you find sharper words, add new ideas, write clearer phrases and sentences, add transitions, remove repeated words, check your grammar, punctuation, and spelling.

DRAFTS

Multiple revisions of your essay until your final draft.

PEER RESPONSE

Also known as grouping and/or conferencing, peer responses are the written and/or oral responses and reactions to a partner's paper. You can point, tell, show, highlight, share, say back, and analytic talk, to name a few.

REVISION

Ultimately, good writing comes only from revision. Here is where you replace weak areas not noticed before.

PUBLISHING

"Always consider sharing your finished writing with a wider audience."

THE JANE SCHAFFER WRITING PROGRAM™

Teaching the Multiparagraph Essay

TERMS AND DEFINITIONS

PARTS OF AN ESSAY		
1.	WHAT IS AN ESSAY?	A piece of writing that gives your thoughts (concrete details and commentary) about a subject. All formal essays include the following paragraphs: introduction, body paragraph(s), conclusion. The different types of essays are also known as Modes of Discourse, “modes” meaning “a method” and “discourse” meaning “conversation” (a method of conversation between a writer and his/her audience). The Jane Schaffer Writing Program® teaches students in the following modes: Narration, Exposition, Information, Summarization, Persuasion, Argumentation, Analytical (Literary Analysis), Style Analysis.
2.	THE INTRODUCTION	The first paragraph in an essay. It includes the thesis, most often at the end. It begins broadly and narrows to the thesis.
3.	THESIS STATEMENT	A statement with a subject and opinion (<i>commentary</i>). This comes somewhere in your introduction and most often at the end of your introduction. It acts as a roadmap to the entire essay.
4.	BODY PARAGRAPH(S)	Paragraphs between the introduction and conclusion. Each paragraph develops a point you want to make which supports your thesis statement. Each body paragraph includes a topic sentence (TS), facts and opinions (CDs and CMs), and a concluding sentence (CS).
5.	THE CONCLUSION	The last paragraph in your essay. It begins narrowly with a restatement of the thesis (not a repeat) and broadens. It may sum up your ideas, reflect on what you said in your essay, provide more commentary about your subject, or give a personal statement about the subject. Your conclusion for literary analysis is all commentary and does not include concrete detail. It does not repeat key words from your paper and especially not from your thesis and introductory paragraph. It gives a finished feeling to your whole essay. Non-literary writing may include CDs. Ask your teacher.
6.	TRANSITIONS	Words, phrases, and sentences that link ideas and provide a smooth and logical flow to your thoughts so that your reader will follow your logical progression of ideas. Moving from one point or idea to another is done successfully with the use of transitions.

THE JANE SCHAFER WRITING PROGRAM™
Teaching the Multiparagraph Essay

TERMS AND DEFINITIONS

PARTS OF AN ESSAY		
1.	WHAT IS AN ESSAY?	
2.	THE INTRODUCTION	
3.	THESIS STATEMENT	
4.	BODY PARAGRAPH(S)	
5.	THE CONCLUSION	
6.	TRANSITIONS	

PARTS OF A PARAGRAPH AND THE JANE SCHAFER CHUNKING TECHNIQUE		
1.	TOPIC SENTENCE (TS)	The first sentence in a body paragraph. For literary analysis and personal narrative, the TS includes the subject and the writer's opinion (commentary) that leads the paragraph. For argumentation, expository/informational, the TS includes the subject of the paragraph, but, depending on the assignment, might include something other than a commentary. The TS does the same thing for a body paragraph that the thesis does for the whole essay.
2.	CONCRETE DETAIL (CD)	Also known as CD, specific details that form the backbone or core of your body paragraphs. Synonyms for concrete details include facts, specifics, examples, descriptions, illustrations, support, proof, evidence, quotations, paraphrasing, or plot references. A concrete detail is one complete sentence. "What I read," "What I have seen," "What I/others have done," and dialogue.
3.	TRANSITIONAL LEAD-IN TO A CONCRETE DETAIL (TLCD)	This is usually a phrase that introduces a quotation so that the quotation does not abruptly appear out of nowhere. Usually, this phrase or sentence illustrates what is happening in the scene, and it sets up the quotation. For advanced writers, the lead-in may be a CD or a CM.
4.	COMMENTARY (CM)	Also known as a CM, one commentary equals one sentence. It is your opinion or comment about something; not concrete detail. Synonyms include opinion, insight, analysis, interpretation, inference, personal response, feelings, evaluation, explication, and reflection.
5.	A CHUNK	It is the smallest unified group of thoughts in a paragraph that combine CDs and CMs. The combination depends on the <i>RATIO</i> for each mode. A paragraph may have multiple "chunks."
6.	RATIO CD:CM	The RATIO of concrete detail (CD) to commentary (CM). Typically, for literary, style, and rhetorical analysis, the ratio is (1:2+): 1 sentence of concrete detail plus <u>2 or more</u> sentences of commentary equals one "chunk." Typically, for argumentation, expository/informational, and narrative, the ratio is (2+:1): 2 or more sentences of concrete detail plus 1 commentary sentence equals one "chunk." For summary, typically (3+:0).
7.	TRANSITIONS	Words, phrases, and even sentences that link ideas and provide a smooth and logical flow to a writer's thoughts. It helps the reader understand the writer's logic. Transitions are important within and between body paragraphs.
8.	CONCLUDING SENTENCE (CS)	The last sentence in a body paragraph. For literary responses, the CS is all commentary; for expository and summary paragraphs, it depends on the assignment or purpose of the piece and may include concrete detail, such as: predictions, connections, inferences, clarifications, and evaluations. Do not repeat key words from the paragraph. Provide a finished feeling.

PARTS OF A PARAGRAPH AND THE JANE SCHAFER CHUNKING TECHNIQUE		
1.	TOPIC SENTENCE (TS)	
2.	CONCRETE DETAIL (CD)	
3.	TRANSITIONAL LEAD-IN TO A CONCRETE DETAIL (TLCD)	
4.	COMMENTARY (CM)	
5.	A CHUNK	
6.	RATIO CD:CM	
7.	TRANSITIONS	
8.	CONCLUDING SENTENCE (CS)	

THE PROCESS OF WRITING AND THE JANE SCHAFER STEPS IN THAT PROCESS

1.	PRE-WRITING	Traditional prewriting includes mapping, clustering, bubbling, webbing, brainstorming, free writing, and outlining. The Jane Schaffer method of prewriting includes Gathering CDs, T-charting, the WOW exercise, and the shaping sheet.
2.	GATHERING CDS	The Jane Schaffer “Gathering CDs”™ think-sheet helps you to determine what concrete details you will use in each paragraph in response to a writing prompt that your teacher gives you. It also helps you to provide preliminary CMs based on the CDs selected which will also help with your initial topic sentence (TS).
3.	T-CHARTING	The Jane Schaffer “T-Chart”™ is a think-sheet that helps you to begin forming a paragraph with a Topic Sentence, CDs, CMs, and a Concluding Sentence.
4.	WEB-OFF-THE-WORD™	The Jane Schaffer “WOW”™ think-sheet helps you when you want to figure out a different way of saying something. It also helps you to develop your vocabulary and own style of writing.
5.	WEB-OFF-THE-TOPIC-SENTENCE™	The Jane Schaffer “WOW”™ think-sheet helps you to create a concluding sentence for your paragraph by selecting the most important words, phrases, and ideas surrounding your topic sentence and webbing off of them in order to stay focused but not repeat yourself.
6.	WEAVING	Jane Schaffer’s integral step of blending concrete details and commentary. Once you and your teacher feel confident in your ability to identify and understand CDs and CMs, and you are able to apply the concept/ratio correctly, then you are ready to move beyond the structured format to weaving. Remember—all formal essays reveal the author’s voice and style and are organized and logical. They include the introduction, body paragraphs (TS, CDs/CMs, CS), and a conclusion.
7.	THE SHAPING SHEET	The Jane Schaffer step performed after prewriting and before the first draft of the essay; this is where you make sure you do the following for each paragraph: 1) include transitions between ideas; 2) vary your sentence openings; 3) include different types of sentences (simple, compound, complex, compound-complex); 4) correct spelling, punctuation, and capitalization errors; and 5) add or delete words, phrases, and sentences to create your voice and your own personal writing style.
8.	PEER RESPONSE	Written responses and reactions to teacher-directed components of your partner's paper. Peer response usually occurs with shaping sheets and first drafts.
9.	FIRST DRAFT	The first version of your essay (also called the rough draft) where you combine the introduction, body paragraphs, and conclusion, editing and revising along the way.
10.	FINAL DRAFT	The final version of your essay. At this point, you’re ready to submit your essay. By the way, good writers can always make a draft better, but a deadline is a deadline!

THE PROCESS OF WRITING AND THE JANE SCHAFER STEPS IN THAT PROCESS		
1.	PRE-WRITING	
2.	GATHERING CDS	
3.	T-CHARTING	
4.	WEB-OFF-THE-WORD™	
5.	WEB-OFF-THE-TOPIC-SENTENCE™	
6.	WEAVING	
7.	THE SHAPING SHEET	
8.	PEER RESPONSE	
9.	FIRST DRAFT	
10.	FINAL DRAFT	

CONCRETE DETAIL	COMMENTARY	RATIO
stuff from the story on the surface paraphrase CD quotation CD	stuff from your head under the surface connotative words-- words with feelings you can describe to me	amount of CD:CM in a body paragraph
the “what” facts examples illustrations evidence support plot references paraphrases citations quotations plot summary What really happens/happened in the story? play-by-play announcer	the “so what?” the “why?” the “spin” analysis interpretation evaluation a character’s feelings George feels (felt) ----- opinion inference insight significance reasons How does/did __ feel on the inside? Why did ___ do that? color commentator	English 1:2+ - style, rhetorical, and literary analysis 2+:1- narrative, expository, synthesis, argument Social Studies 2+:1 3+:0 Science and Math 2+:1 3+:0 All others Varies with the assignment

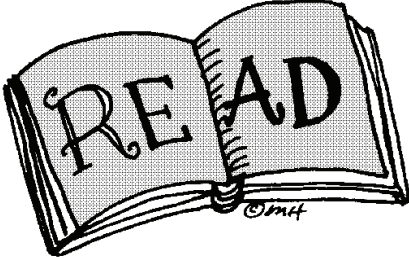
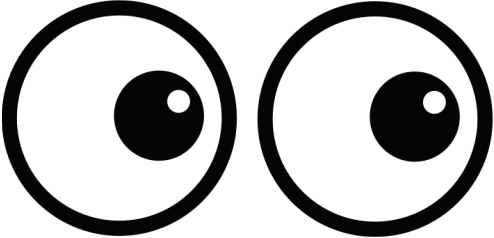
CD / CM CHART NARRATIVE WRITING

CONCRETE DETAIL	• Facts • Examples • Description • The 4 Ws: Who? What? When? Where? • Details that Help Your Reader Actually See the Sights, Hear the Sounds, Smell the Smells, Taste the Tastes, Feel the Objects (Touch) • Dialogue Between People
COMMENTARY	• How did you feel on the inside? • How did other people feel on the inside? • Why did you feel that way? • What were you thinking?
RATIO	In narrative writing, the ratio is CD:CM (2+:1) because your reader needs to have enough concrete details (CDs) to follow and picture the story you are telling.

TERMS	
CONCRETE DETAIL (2+)	COMMENTARY (1)
WHAT HAPPENS IN YOUR STORY? DETAILS	PURPOSE FOR TELLING YOUR STORY
WHEN – DETAILS	CONFLICT(S)
WHERE – DETAILS	HIDDEN THOUGHTS
WHO (APPEARANCE)	WHO (FEELINGS)
COLORS	LESSON(S) LEARNED
WHAT I SAW, HEARD, TASTED, TOUCHED	WHY PEOPLE ACT THE WAY THEY DO
DESCRIPTION	THEME(S)
DIALOGUE	WHAT WAS GOOD
FACTS – DETAILS	WHAT WAS BAD
EXAMPLES – DETAILS	THE TRUTH IN YOUR HEART
PLAY-BY-PLAY ANNOUNCER	COLOR COMMENTATOR

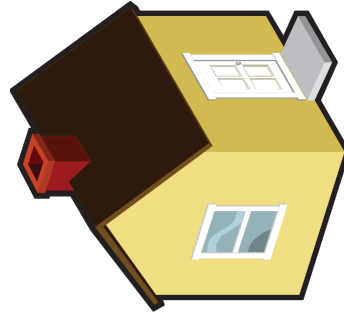
Concrete Detail

CD

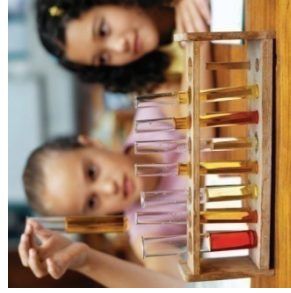
	What did the book say?
	What did I see?
	What did I do? What did someone else do?
	What did I say? What did someone else say?



Who?



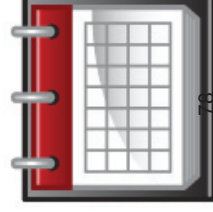
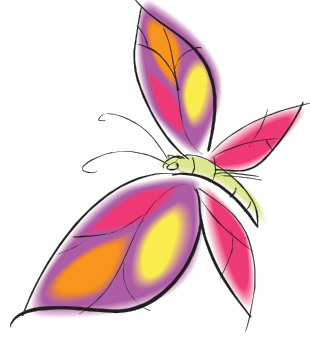
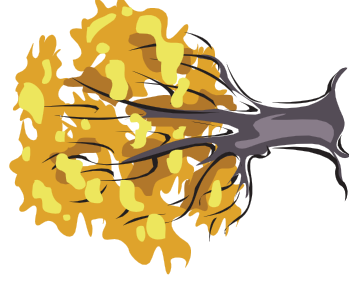
Where?



When?



**What
Happened?**



Concrete Details Examples

- Who was there? Aunt Sue, Mom, my brother Jimmy
 - Elaborate: wearing a blue dress, tall, Size 12 shoe size, my mother's sister
- What happened? First, he walked into the room;
 - Elaborate: He laughed, She cried, I spoke
- When did this happen? Morning, Afternoon, Evening, the day before, the day after, the following year
 - Elaborate: raining, sunny, spring, fall, summer, after school, before school, on my 5th birthday, last week.
- Where did this happen? In the car, at my house, on the streets
 - What kind of car, which room in my house, in Houston? In what neighborhood

Understanding Dialogue Conversation

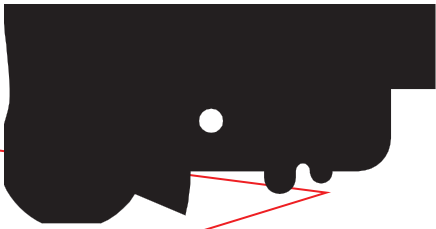
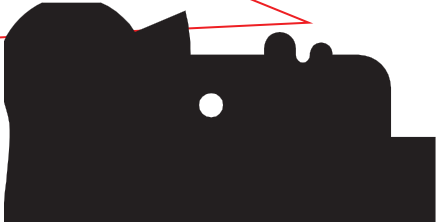
I said, “ _____

_____”

He replied, “ _____

_____”

“Said” Substitutes		
I exclaimed, “	She replied, “	I whispered, “
I stammered, “	He answered, “	He mumbled, “
She cried, “	I responded, “	I stuttered, “
He screamed, “	She said, “	She giggled, “
He guffawed, “	He asked, “	He wept, “





My Head



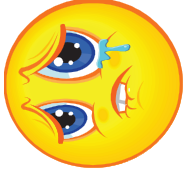
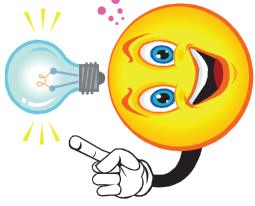
My Heart



My Stomach

Commentary

COMMENTARY



– What was I thinking?

– How did I feel?

– What did I learn?

– Why was this important in my life?

– Why was this important that day?

– Why did I do what I did?

– Why was it a good (bad) decision?

– Why did this make an impact on me?

– How did it change my life?

The Personal Narrative

“It’s always a ‘reflection of self.’ ”

– Norma Wilkerson, English Consultant, Fort Worth, Texas

Four Typical Categories for Narrative Writing

“Write about a time when...”

- an event
- a person
- a place
- a thing

Concrete Details (CDs) for this Genre

Concrete Details bring the paper to life and lift it out of the trite/hackneyed/clichés/boring paper we’ve all read all too often. They must be specific: make me a picture, draw me a picture with words, show me.

They must be well elaborated and well developed. Weaker papers just don’t say enough.

If the CDs are weak, generic, trite, or clichés, the paper has no voice. When students do their prewriting as we teach them to do, they produce strong CDs and CMs.

Many synonyms for CDs exist, and students need to know all of these because different ones work with different people. Here are the most common, but please see the three different “Narrative Terms” handouts for students

- the 4 Ws (when, where, who, what)
- the 5 Ws (when, where, who, what, why)
- description
- narration
- dialogue
- internal monologue

Commentary Thoughts (CM’s) for this Genre

We teach students that their commentary comes from within their own minds and hearts when writing for Response to Literature, Expository, and Argumentation; however, for Narrative, in addition to the commentary deriving from the writer’s perspective, they can be from the point of view of other people as well which is what the omniscient point of view offers:

- the narrator’s feelings
- the narrator’s personal or emotional response or reaction to something that happens or something that someone says
- the narrator’s thoughts about the experience, either when it is happening or afterward

Ratio of CD’s to CM’s (2+:1)

Most personal narrative papers have two or more points of concrete detail to one or more points of commentary (2+:1). In this kind of essay, most writers do not follow the structure. The human brain

processes experience in a way that mixes up details and feelings. We want writers to get to what we call *weaving* anyway, which is mixing CDs and CMs, so do not worry about it, and reassure students that weaving is fine in this genre.

Organization -- typical organizing concept:

Five paragraphs (for training purposes; students are free to leave this behind once they've mastered the big picture)

- ❖ Introduction
 - 1st body paragraph — the beginning of your story
 - 2nd body paragraph — the middle of your story
 - 3rd body paragraph — the end of your story
- ❖ Conclusion

Beginnings

Beginning writers can learn to "hook" their readers in the first sentence. This can be done with any of the following techniques:

- Introduce yourself by name.
- What was going through your mind?
- Describe the setting (place).
- Describe the setting (time).
- If there is a conflict, describe it in the first sentence.
- Create a dialogue between you and someone else.
- An event is in progress
- Combinations of any of the above
- A letter or note is read.
- A prologue (background information) tells of events from the past that set up the story.

Endings

We don't want students to re-hash what they've said earlier, and so don't teach them to restate the intro or repeat anything from their body paragraphs. The conclusion of a narrative may reveal the resolution (end) of the conflict and/or a lesson learned or insight gained by the narrator or characters from the experience. If you have trouble, identify which of the six basic plots that you have chosen to use in your story, and make sure that you have an ending that fits the type.

- End with your feelings about the event.
 - I knew then that I had succeeded. I was overjoyed to have finally found my happily-everafter.
- End with a prediction or advice.
 - The next time I came across a strange-looking little man, I walked right on by.
- End with a summary statement.
 - No matter how you look at it, laughter is good medicine
- End with a quotation.

- Writers who can't seem to find the right ending might also try writing several endings and see which one works best. Do **NOT** use the following openings, but consider what you would write after you or a person says this to yourself or himself:
 - (I/She never realized that)...
 - (I/He discovered that)...
 - (I (have) learned that)...
 - (I now know that)...
 - (I want my reader to understand that)...

Transitions

One characteristic of a narrative involves time: a moment in time or the passage of time. A writer helps the reader follow the story's events, in time and place, by using transitions that show changes in time, place, characters, or action. Transitions can be one word, a phrase, or a whole sentence to show these changes clearly for a reader.

Situate Time (Ex.: The following morning or A hundred years passed (shows change of time))

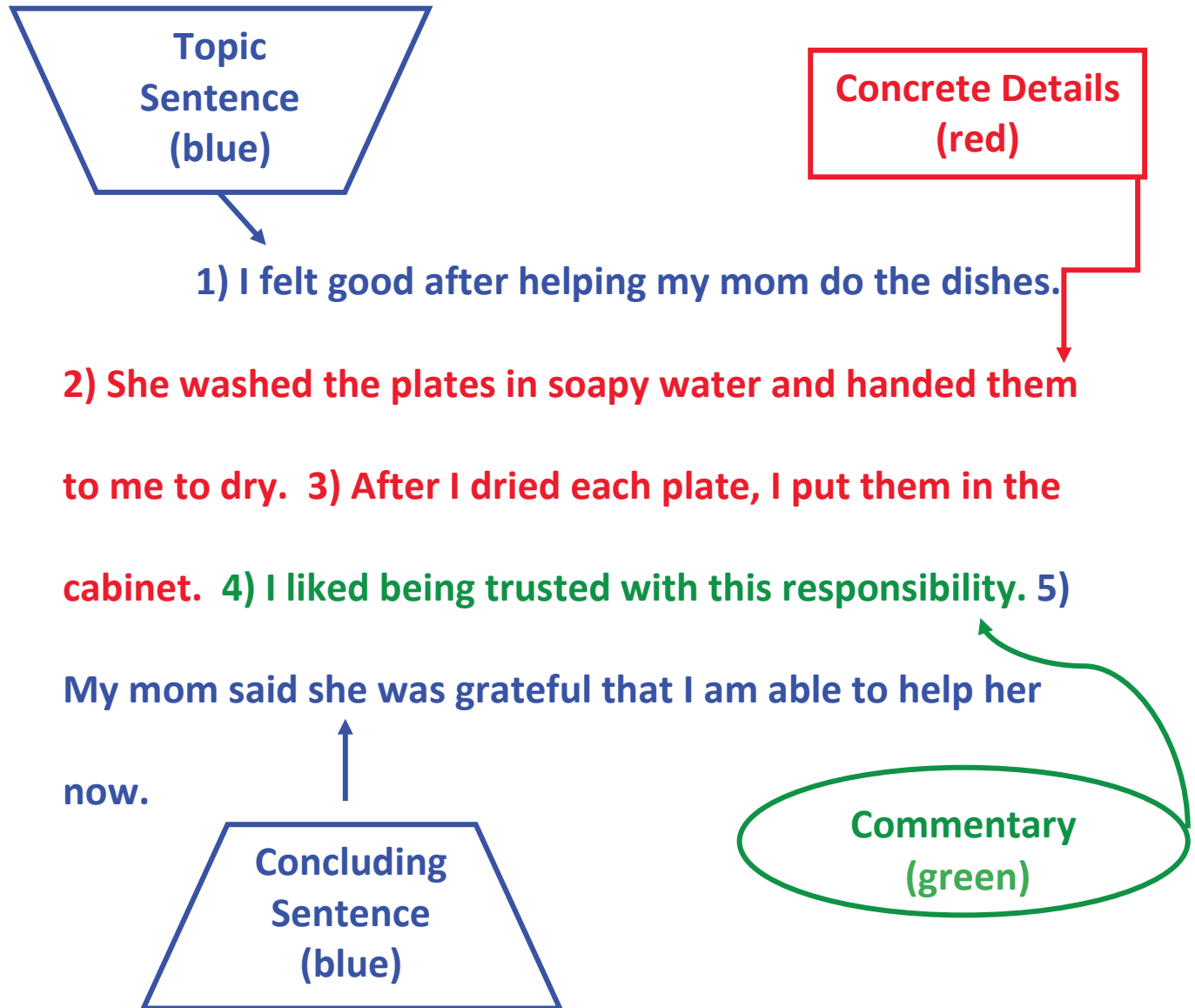
- | | | |
|--------------------|--------------------|-------------------|
| • after | • finally | • now |
| • afterward | • first | • presently |
| • as soon as | • formerly | • since |
| • at least | • in the beginning | • soon |
| • at the same time | • in the end | • sooner or later |
| • at this point | • in the meantime | • then |
| • before | • in the past | • until |
| • during | • later | • when |
| • earlier | • meanwhile | • while |
| • eventually | • moments later | |

Situate Place (Ex. Meanwhile, back at the ranch . . . (shows change in place))

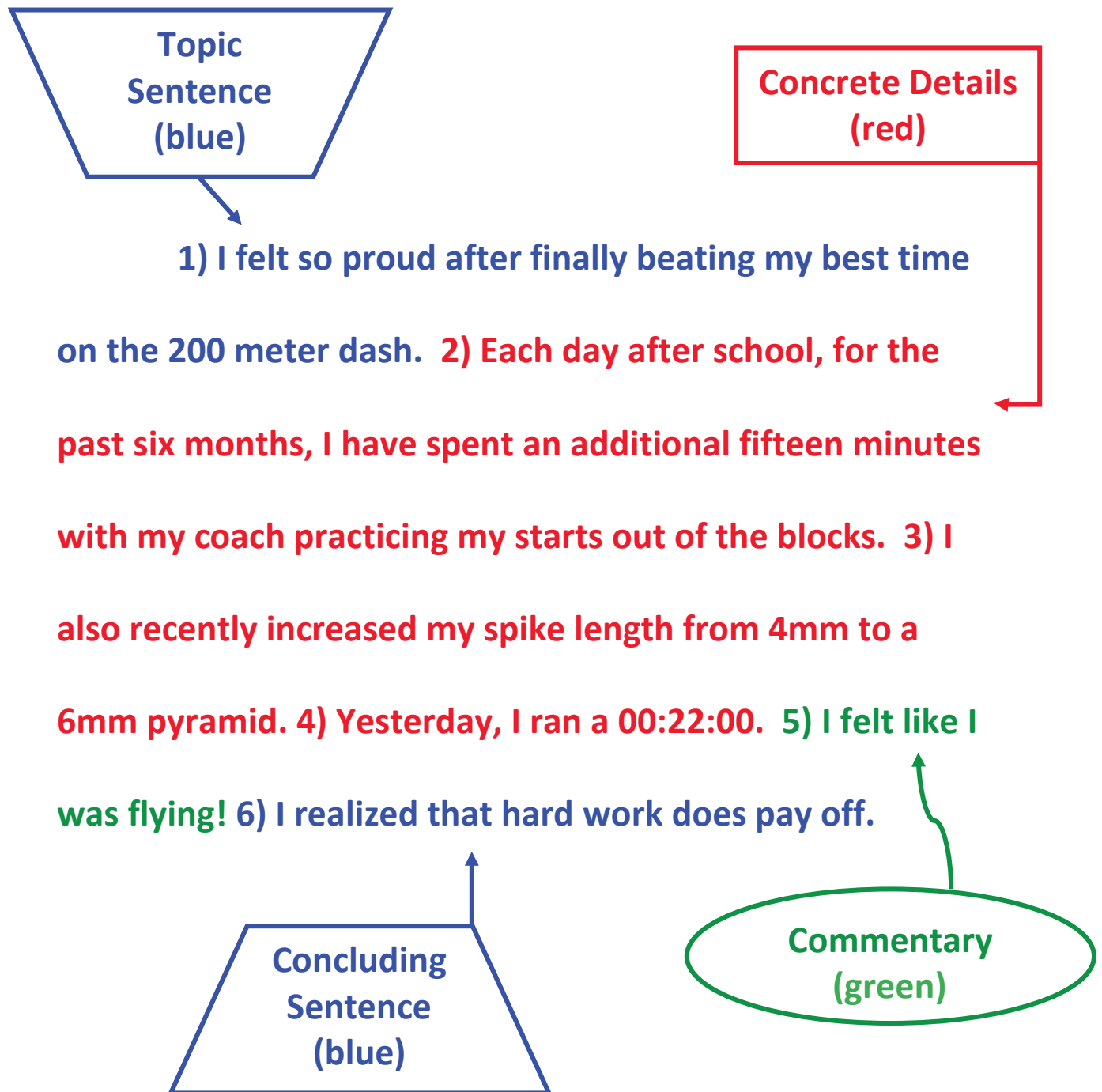
- | | | |
|---------------|--------------|----------------------|
| • aboard | • among | • beyond |
| • about | • apart from | • down |
| • above | • around | • in-/outside |
| • across | • at | • juxtaposed against |
| • adjacent to | • back of | • nearby |
| • against | • before | • next to |
| • ahead of | • behind | • opposite |
| • along | • below | • throughout |
| • alongside | • beneath | • underneath |
| • amid | • between | |

Change in Characters. (Ex. While Cinderella worked hard to finish all of her chores, her wicked stepsisters were busy plotting against her. . . (shows change in characters))

Write a one-chunk personal narrative paragraph (2+:1) that describes how you felt after accomplishing something at home or school.



Write a one-chunk personal narrative paragraph (2+:1) that describes how you felt after accomplishing something at home or school.



Sample Elementary Paragraphs Created by the Children

Prompt: Write a one-chunk (2+: 1) paragraph that describes how you felt after accomplishing something at home or school.

I felt good after helping my mom do the dishes. She washed the plates in soapy water and handed them to me to dry. After I dried each plate, I put them in the cabinet. I liked being trusted with this responsibility. My mom said she was grateful that I help her now.

This is an exciting school year because I can finally do my homework on my own. At 4:00 p.m., I come home from school and have a snack and then check my planner to see what work I have to do. I work at my desk until 5:00 p.m., and I check off each assignment I do. I'm proud because nobody has to bug me about doing homework because I do it by myself now. 5th grade is better than 4th grade because I'm more independent.

It is amazing that I can read three syllable words. My reading tutor has notecards with big words on them. For a long time, I needed help to pronounce any word but not anymore. It's like a miracle to me that I can read a ton of words like my brother. I don't mind going to school because I like to read.

Write about a Person . . .



**someone you
would like to thank**



someone you trust



**someone you
would like to thank**

**someone you
admire**



someone you appreciate



**someone who makes
you laugh**

Write about a Place . . .



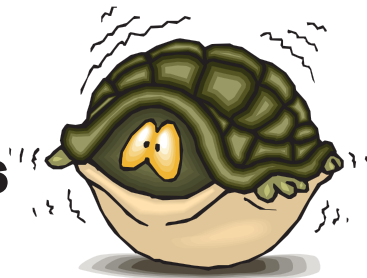
**A place you would
like to visit**



**A place you have
visited that you like**

**A place you have
visited that you like**

**A place that
gives you the creeps**



**A place that
makes you happy**



**a place in your
house or apartment
where you like to hang out**

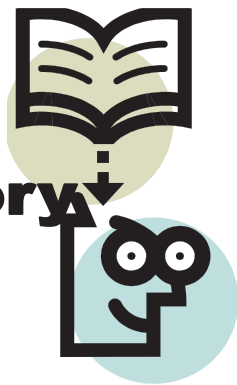
Write about Something . . .

**something you will
never forget**

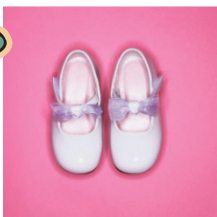


**something that has happened
to you in the last week or month**

**a book or story
you love**



**an object that is
important to you**





Personal Narrative Prompts

1. Write about a time you learned something important about life and discuss how it affected you.
2. Much of what we learn happens outside of school, not in class. Write about a time when an outside-of-school person, sport, experience, or vacation helped you learn something important and why..
3. Write about a time when you respected or disliked someone for something he or she did and say why.
4. Write about a time when you did the right thing and how you felt about it.
5. Write about a time when you appreciated something or someone.
6. Write about a time when it was important to appreciate your heritage.
7. Write about a time when you made a good decision regarding money.
8. Write about a time when you did something you're proud of.
9. Write about a time when you did something you didn't think you could.
10. Write about someone who has influenced you in a good way and say why.
11. Write about an object that is important to you and say why.
12. Write about a time when you made a good decision and say why.
13. Tell me about a time... (you can mean you or someone else)
 - a. when you were happy
 - b. when you felt free
 - c. when you didn't feel free
 - d. when your life changed
 - e. when you did something you're proud of
 - f. when you made a good decision
 - g. when you helped someone
 - h. when you stood up for something you believe in
 - i. when you lost something
 - j. when you found something

- k. when you made a mistake**
- l. when your parents praised**
- m. when your teacher gave you a gold star**
- n. when you were late**
- o. when you told a lie**
- p. when you got an award**
- q. when you hurt someone's feelings**
- r. when someone hurt your feelings**
- s. when you did the right thing**
- t. when you learned something you didn't know before**
- u. when you saw something or someone with new eyes**
- v. when you appreciated someone or something**
- w. when you were scared**
- x. when you were worried**
- y. when you did something you didn't think you could**
- z. when you took a risk**
- aa. when you showed you were mature**
- bb. when you were silly**
- cc. when you made a new friend**
- dd. when you rebelled**
- ee. when you gave in to peer pressure**
- ff. when you were out in nature**
- gg. when you did something you regretted later**
- hh. when you included someone**
- ii. when you excluded someone**
- jj. when you spent money you shouldn't have**
- kk. when you changed schools**
- ll. when you broke something**
- mm. when you taught someone something**

- nn. that made you cry**
- oo. that made you angry**
- pp. that made you sad**
- qq. that made you happy**

14. Tell me about

- a. a turning point in your life.**
- b. something that's happened to you in the past week/month/year**
- c. a person in history that you'd like to talk to**
- d. a person who has influenced you**
- e. someone or something you appreciate**
- f. a person you need to thank**
- g. a person you thanked**
- h. a place that calms you**
- i. a place you like to be**
- j. a place that is exciting**
- k. a place that gives you the creeps**
- l. a person you admire**
- m. a person you don't like**
- n. a person you miss**
- o. a person you appreciate**
- p. an object that is important to you**
- q. a place where you go to recharge**
- r. a place that has changed for the better**
- s. a place that has changed for the worse**
- t. a place you've visited that you liked**
- u. a place you've visited that you didn't like**
- v. a place you'd like to visit**
- w. something you've done recently**

- x. something you wished you had done
- y. something you wished you hadn't done
- z. one of your memories from childhood
- aa. a conversation you've had with someone
- bb. the weekend before the first day of school
- cc. a book you love
- dd. something you like about your house or apartment
- ee. a quotation you like
- ff. a goal you want to accomplish
- gg. how religion affects you
- hh. what kind of parent you think you'll be
- ii. what you want written on your tombstone
- jj. growing up as the oldest/middle/youngest/only child
- kk. what you do when you goof off
- ll. your neighborhood
- mm. a class you loved
- nn. a class you hated
- oo. the contents of your wallet/purse
- pp. a book you read as a child
- qq. something you will never forget
- rr. changing schools

Writing the Personal Narrative Essay

STEP ONE: Make the prompt “All About Me!”

Event: Write about a time when . . . (change “you” or your to “I” or “me” or “my”)

Person, Place, Thing (PPT): Write about someone, some place, something (PPT)

STEP TWO: Divide your topic into three body paragraphs

Event: Body Paragraph One Will Focus on the Beginning or Before the Event

Body Paragraph Two Will Focus on the Middle or the Event Itself

Body Paragraph Three Will Focus on the End or After the Event

PPT: Body Paragraph One Will Focus on the First Reason I Chose this **PPT**

Body Paragraph Two Will Focus on the Second Reason I Chose this **PPT**

Body Paragraph Three Will Focus on the Third Reason I Chose this **PPT**

STEP THREE: Pre-write, Shape, and Draft your three body paragraphs.

Topic Sentence: _____	
CD (facts)	CM (feelings, thoughts)
Who What happened? When Where Why Dialogue	

 Topic Sentence
 1 or 2 sentences of Concrete Details
 1 or 2 sentences of Concrete Details
 Commentary
 Concluding Sentence

x 3

STEP FOUR: Write your introduction and conclusion

3 sentences (but remember other choices on handout)

S1: Universal, general statement;

S2: Transitioning Sentence between 1 and 3;

S3: Thesis – Answer the prompt.

Example of Introduction: *Everybody must make a decision some time in his/her life. These choices might have good or bad consequences. One decision I made that influenced my life in a good way was returning to college.*

Conclusion: 3 sentences (Example below, but remember other choices on handout)

S1: I never realized that . . . *education was such an important part of my life.*

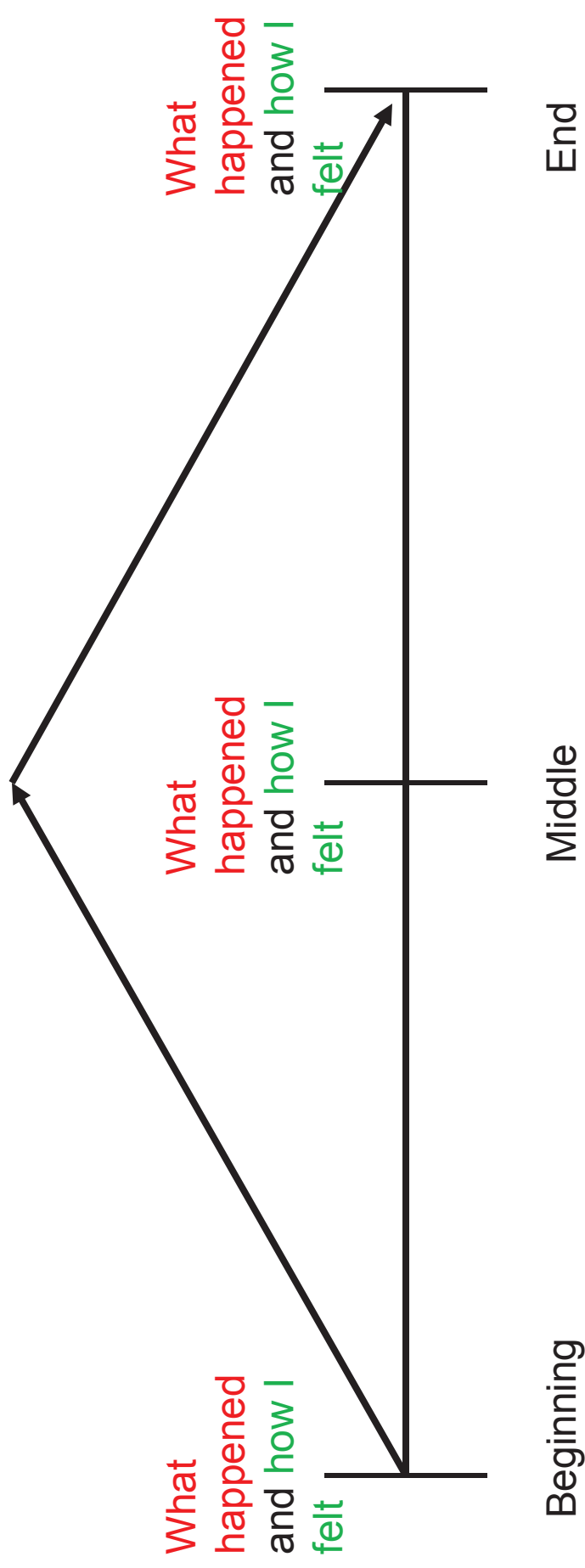
S2: I learned that . . . *once I make a decision to do something, I will do it.*

S3: I now know that . . . *I will live a life without regrets.*

NARRATIVES TWO DIFFERENT LAYOUTS

Parts of an Essay	LAYOUT 1: <i>AN EVENT IN TIME OR A FICTIONAL NARRATIVE</i>	LAYOUT 2: <i>A PERSON, PLACE, OR THING ("PPT")</i>
Intro	Introduction	Introduction
1 st body paragraph	Beginning of your story	1st reason about this PPT that answers the prompt 1st reason you like or dislike this PPT; or 1st reason of what this PPT means to you; and so on
2 nd body paragraph	Middle of your story	2nd reason about this PPT that answers the prompt 2nd reason you like or dislike this PPT; or 2nd reason of what this PPT means to you; and so on
3 rd body paragraph	End of your story	3rd reason about this PPT that answers the prompt 3rd reason you like or dislike this PPT; or 3rd reason of what this PPT means to you; and so on
Conclusion	Conclusion	Conclusion

If you are writing about an event,
consider writing three body paragraphs



**Write about a time when you
made a mistake**

EVENT

- 1. Write about a time when _____.
- 2. Now do a 2-minute quickwrite about #1 on the back of this page.
- 3. Now it's time to think about how to organize your story. Do the blocks below in order: 1, 2, and 3 first; 4, 5, and 6 afterward.

FOCUS	FEELINGS
Think about how you could divide your story into three parts – beginning, middle, and end.	Now describe how you felt during the beginning, the middle, and the end by filling in the blanks below with one or more words.
1. The beginning might focus on <u>Yesterday, at school</u>	4. At first, I felt <u>bad</u>
2. The middle might focus on <u>At home</u>	5. Later, I felt <u>different about Mr. Slinger</u>
3. The end might focus on <u>The next day</u>	6. At the end, I felt <u>much better</u>

1

BP #

NARRATIVE (2+:1)
PERSON, PLACE, OR THING
GATHERING CDS AND CMS ON THE T-CHART

Prompt: Write about a time when you made a mistake. _____

Topic Sentence: I felt bad. _____

CDs	CMs
When? Yesterday	Fill in the Circle in the MIDDLE and then web-off into the Clouds to Dig Deeper:
Details about When: After I left home and went to school All day, when I wanted to share	
Where? At school	
Details about Where: In Mr. Slinger's classroom where all my friends were	
Who? Mr. Slinger, me, my friends	
Details about Who: Mr. Slinger is my second grade teacher	
Details about What Happened (step-by-step)? I brought my purse, glasses, and coins to school. I tried to share them before sharing time. Mr. Slinger told me to put them up. When I didn't, he took them away from me. I wrote him a note and put it in his bag.	What were you thinking? Why? Mr. Slinger is mean.
Dialogue? "It's not time for sharing, Cindy," Mr. Slinger said.	I was feeling <u>mad</u> because <u>I wanted to show my</u> <u>friends my cool stuff.</u>
	What were you thinking? Why? I hate the whole day. It was a disaster. Mr. Slinger hates me.

Shaping Sheet (2+:1)

TS

Yesterday was a bad day at school.

1st CD

When I brought my purse, glasses, and coins to school, I tried to share them.
After Mr. Slinger warned me, he took away my sharing.

2nd CD

I wrote Mr. Slinger a note and put it in his bag.

(revision questions from teacher: What kind of a note was it? (answer: nasty)
How did you put it in the bag without his seeing hit? (answer: I snuck it in there)

CM

I was so mad.

CS

My day was a disaster.

Sometimes making a mistake teaches a lesson.

Yesterday was a bad day at school. When I brought my purse, glasses, and coins to school, I tried to share them. After Mr. Slinger warned me, he took away my sharing. I wrote Mr. Slinger a nasty note and snuck it in his bag. I was so mad. My day was a disaster.

At home I changed how I felt about Mr. Slinger. I found a note and a special treat from Mr. Slinger in my purse. I wrote a note to tell him I was sorry. I felt really bad, and I hoped he would forgive me. Mr. Slinger is my favorite teacher again.

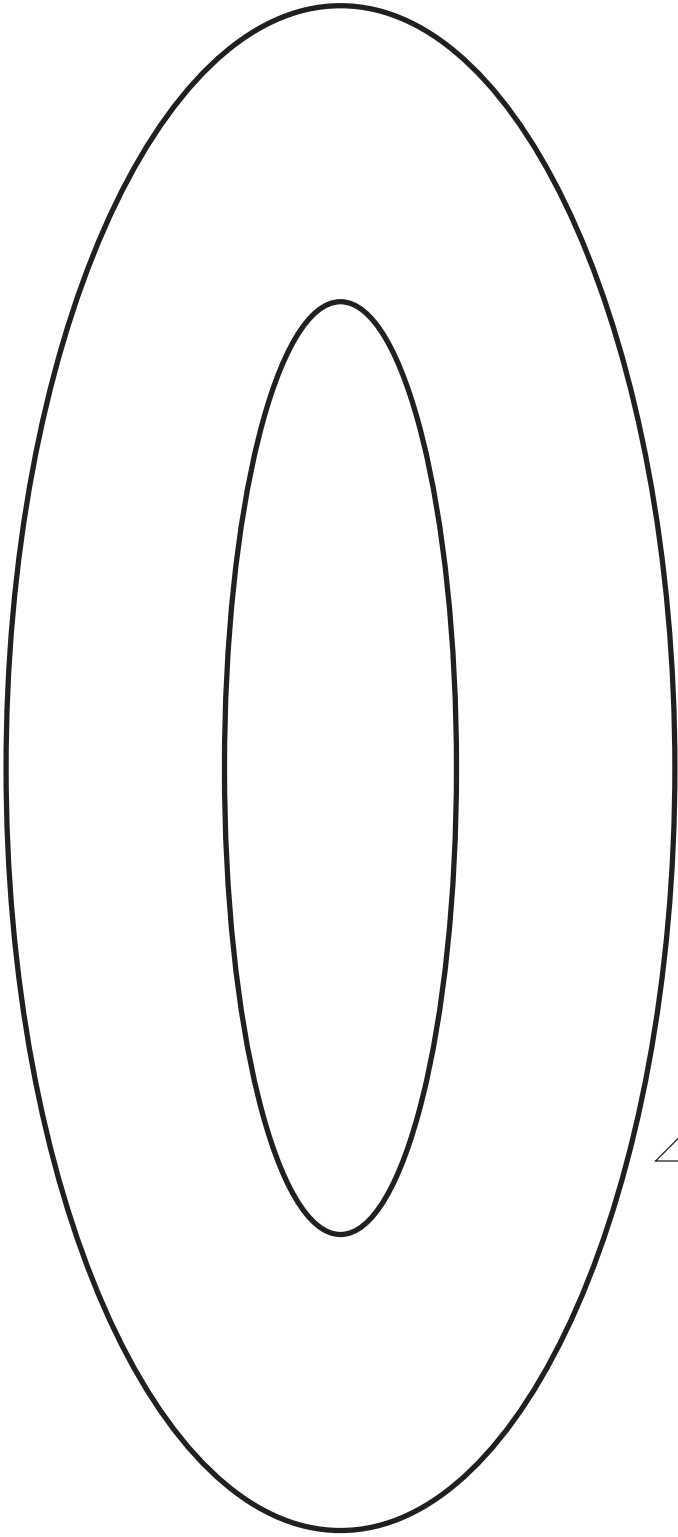
Mr. Slinger was right because the next day was much better. I gave Mr. Slinger my new note. Mr. Slinger agreed he would forget about the nasty note. I waited to share my purse, glasses, and coins until sharing time. Wow! I loved school and my teacher again. I had a wonderful day.

I now know that I can be patient even when I'm really excited.

Step 1: Discovering the Topic of My Narrative

Gather Ideas:

In the center oval, write the key word or phrase from the prompt. Brainstorm some general ideas that could fit the prompt. Star the idea that you know the most about or that interests you the most.



Specific, concrete example:

What did you decide? Write a concrete example of the selected general idea. An example might come from the past, the present. It could include an event, a person, a place, a thing, a memory.

I am going to write about _____

Topic Sentence Beginnings for an Event

Write about a time when . . .

Body Paragraph #1

- At first, I felt
- In the beginning, I felt
- That morning, I was feeling
- What I first remember about that day is that I felt
- My first memory of that time brings back a feeling of
- To begin, I felt
- When the whole situation began, I felt
- Yesterday, Two weeks ago, Last December, When I was six . . .

Body Paragraphs #2 and #3

- Later, I felt
- Later that morning, I began feeling
- That afternoon, I felt
- In the afternoon, I felt
- That evening, I felt
- That night, I felt
- Eventually,
- In the meantime,
- Afterward, I felt
- As the days passed, I began feeling
- The next morning, afternoon, night, I felt
- The next day, month, year, I felt
- As time went on, I began feeling
- After many years, I now feel
- In the end, I felt
- When I now think about that time, I feel
- If I had the choice again, . . .

EVENT

- 1. Write about a time when _____.
- 2. Now do a 2-minute quickwrite about #1 on the back of this page.
- 3. Now it's time to think about how to organize your story. Do the blocks below in order: 1, 2, and 3 first; 4, 5, and 6 afterward.

FOCUS	FEELINGS
Think about how you could divide your story into three parts – beginning, middle, and end.	Now describe how you felt during the beginning, the middle, and the end by filling in the blanks below with one or more words.
1. The beginning might focus on _____.	4. At first, I felt _____.
2. The middle might focus on _____.	5. Later, I felt _____.
3. The end might focus on _____.	6. At the end, I felt _____.

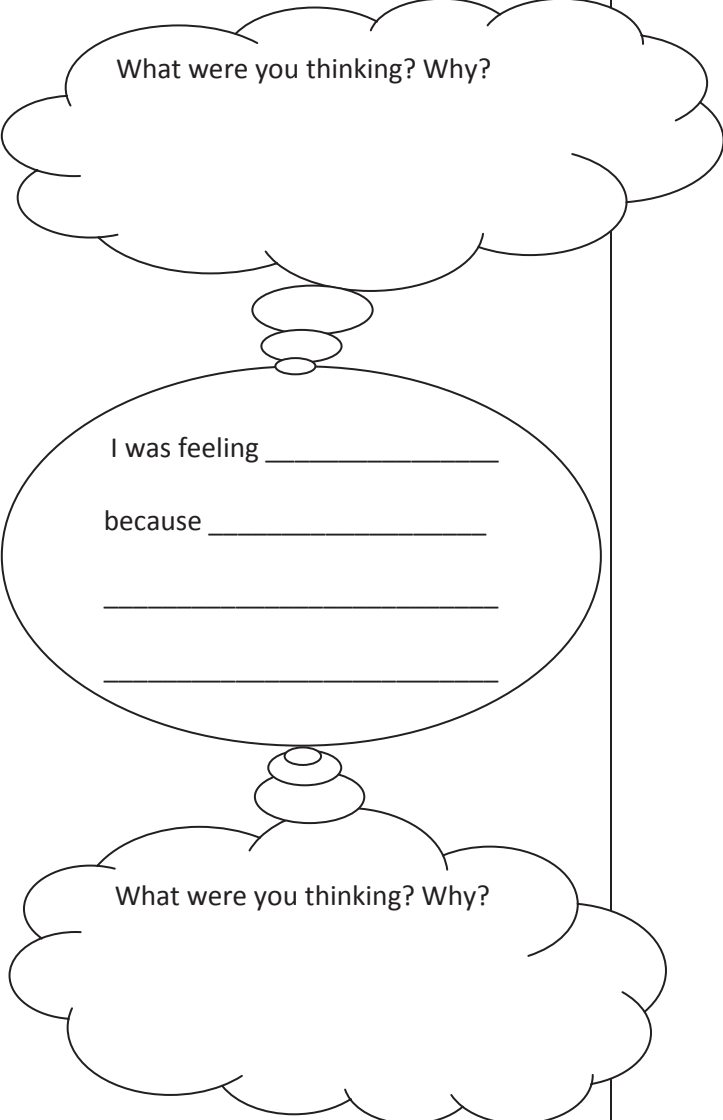


BP #

NARRATIVE (2+:1)
EVENT, PERSON, PLACE, OR THING
GATHERING CDS AND CMS ON THE T-CHART

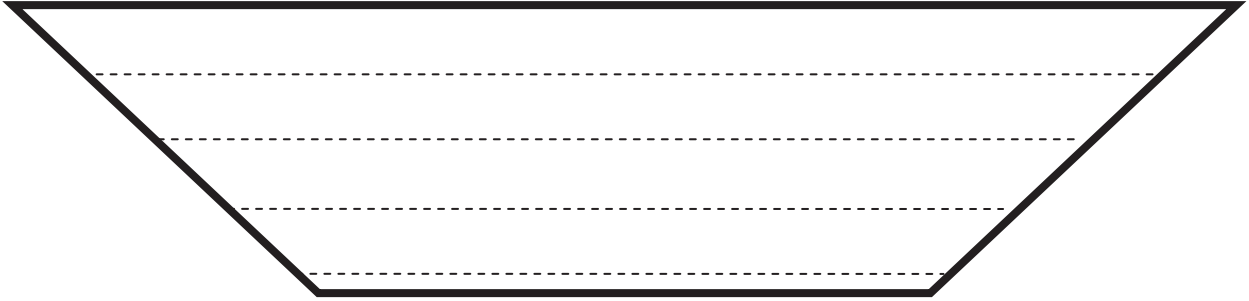
Prompt: _____

Topic Sentence: _____

CDs	CMs
When?	Fill in the Circle in the MIDDLE and then web-off into the Clouds to Dig Deeper: 
Details about When: ----- -----	
Where?	
Details about Where: ----- -----	
Who?	
Details about Who: ----- -----	
Details about What Happened (step-by-step)? ----- ----- ----- ----- -----	
Dialogue? ----- ----- -----	

Shaping Sheet (2+:1)

TS



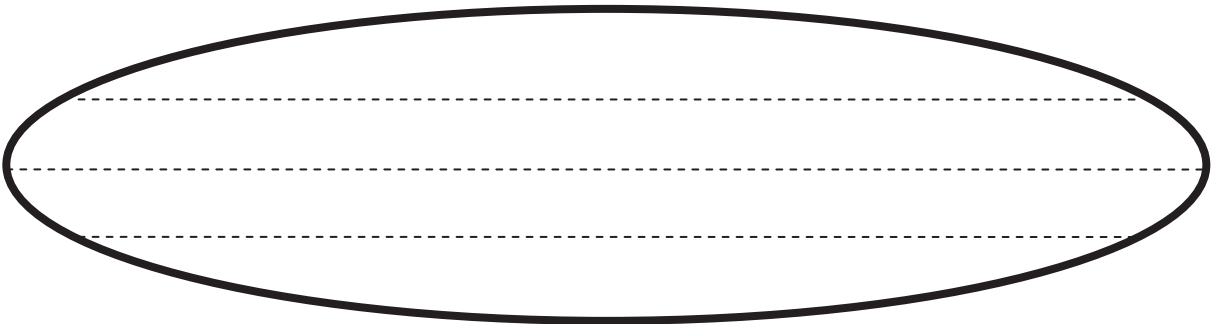
1st CD



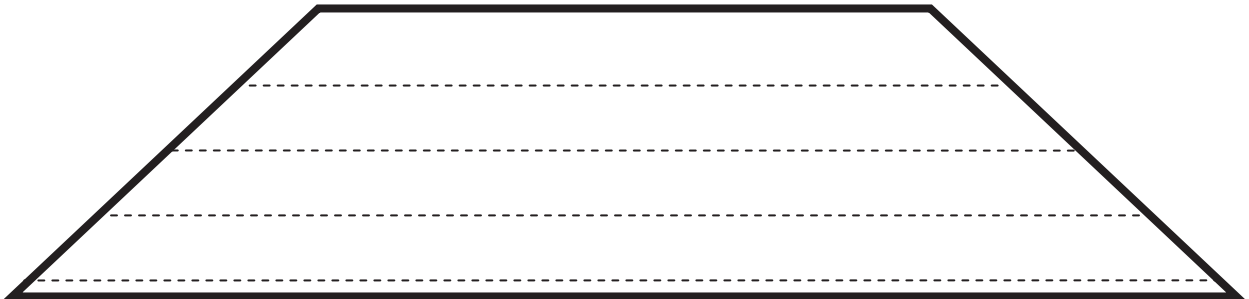
2nd CD



CM



CS





BP #

NARRATIVE (2+:1)
EVENT, PERSON, PLACE, OR THING
GATHERING CDS AND CMS ON THE T-CHART

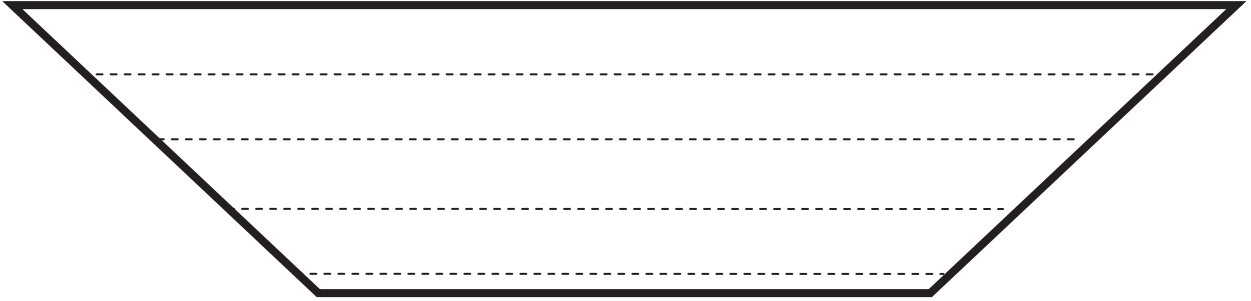
Prompt: _____

Topic Sentence: _____

CDs	CMs
When?	Fill in the Circle in the MIDDLE and then web-off into the Clouds to Dig Deeper:
Details about When: _____ _____	
Where?	
Details about Where: _____ _____	
Who?	
Details about Who: _____ _____	
Details about What Happened (step-by-step)? _____ _____ _____ _____ _____	
Dialogue? _____ _____ _____	

Shaping Sheet (2+:1)

TS



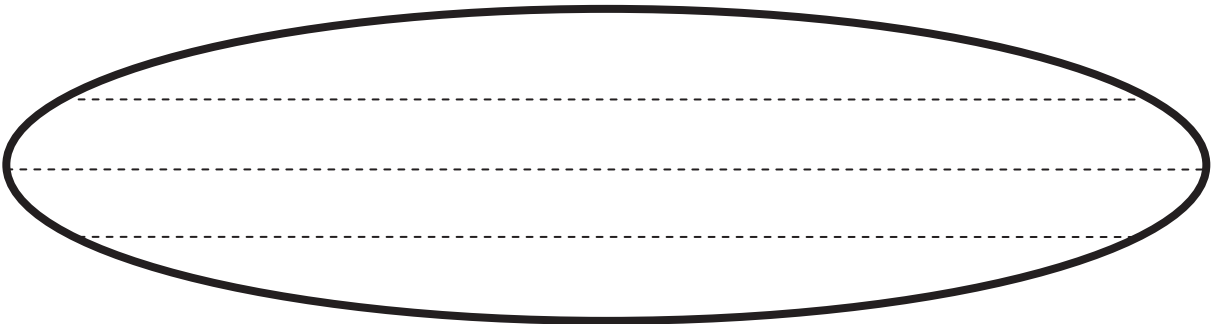
1st CD



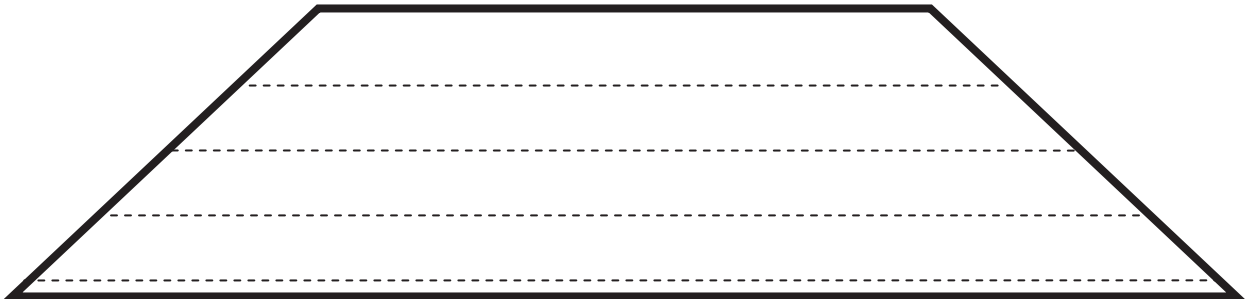
2nd CD



CM



CS



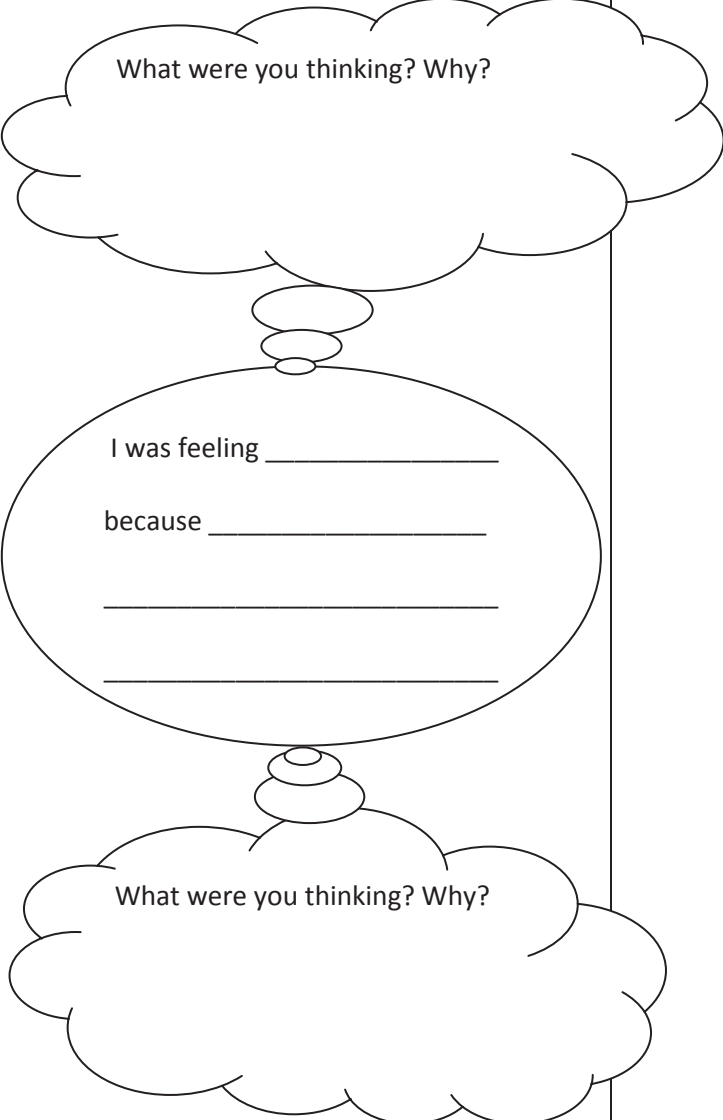


BP #

NARRATIVE (2+:1)
EVENT, PERSON, PLACE, OR THING
GATHERING CDS AND CMS ON THE T-CHART

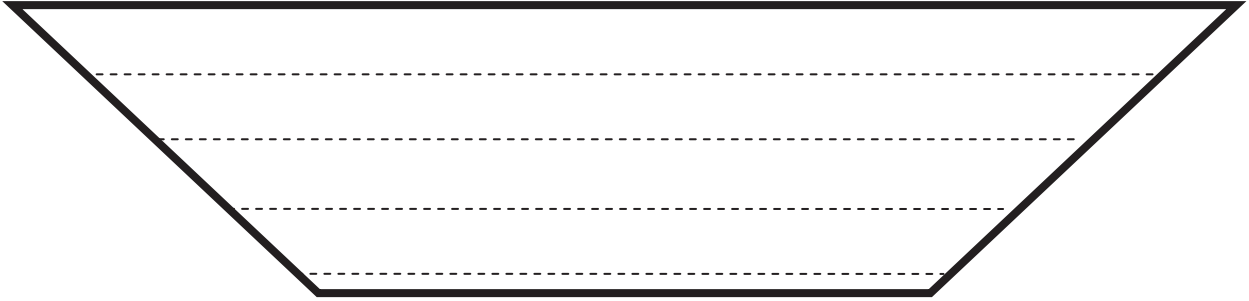
Prompt: _____

Topic Sentence: _____

CDs	CMs
When?	Fill in the Circle in the MIDDLE and then web-off into the Clouds to Dig Deeper: 
Details about When: ----- -----	
Where?	
Details about Where: ----- -----	
Who?	
Details about Who: ----- -----	
Details about What Happened (step-by-step)? ----- ----- ----- ----- -----	
Dialogue? ----- ----- -----	

Shaping Sheet (2+:1)

TS



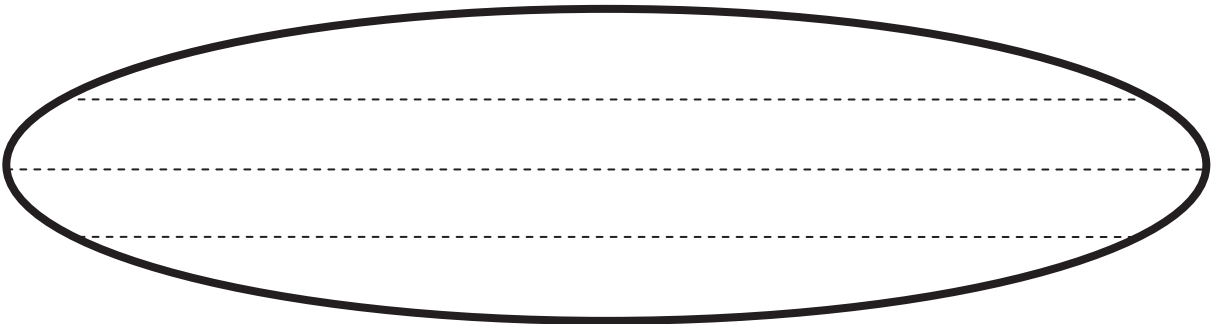
1st CD



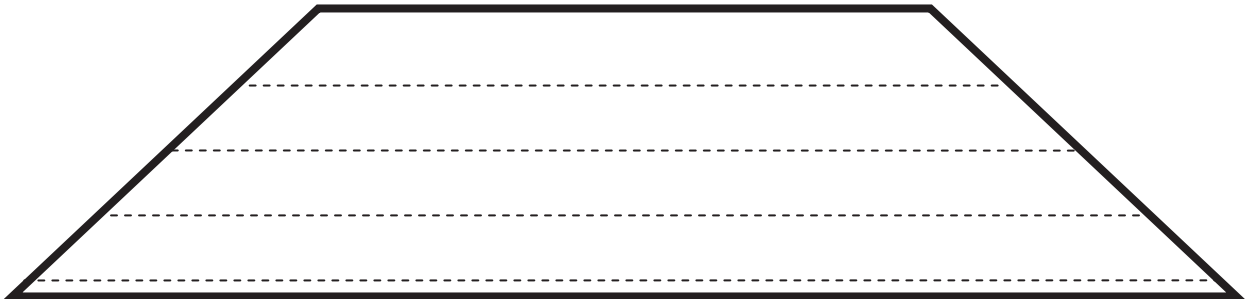
2nd CD



CM



CS



The Introduction

1. anecdote/flashback/tell a story	
2. Start with the climax or high point of your essay or story.	
3. rhetorical question.	
4. a startling fact or statement	
5. dialogue	
6. a famous quotation	
7. internal monologue / What was going through your mind?	
8. combination of any of the above	

The Conclusion

Sentence #	Sentence
1 (I never realized that . . .) (I discovered that . . .) (I (have) learned that . . .) (I now know that . . .) (I want my reader to understand that . . .)	
2 (I never realized that . . .) (I discovered that . . .) (I (have) learned that . . .) (I now know that . . .) (I want my reader to understand that . . .)	
3 (I never realized that . . .) (I discovered that . . .) (I (have) learned that . . .) (I now know that . . .) (I want my reader to understand that . . .)	

“I never want to go to Yellowstone again!” I told my husband, but despite my misgivings, we decided to try it again this spring, a choice that yielded many benefits.

I was concerned that a trip to Yellowstone would probably be depressing. Instead of seeing wildlife on our last few trips, we’d experienced bumper-to-bumper lines of passenger cars and RV’s clogging the narrow roadways and thousands of tourists from every continent on the planet trampling the landscape. One time we’d even come upon a mob attempting to startle a lone, grazing elk by throwing rocks at him. Remembering past trips, I dreaded another attempt at enjoying America’s greatest national park. I couldn’t bear to witness such human disrespect for nature.

The trip turned out to be uplifting, not depressing. We saw three moose the first morning, a black bear ambling through the woods in a hollow just off the road, lots of buffalo and elk grazing or sleeping in the grasslands, and a coyote seemingly posed on a rock to be photographed. The highlight was watching a standoff between an elk and members of the Lamar Valley wolf pack who had driven the aged beast into the river. Although I felt anguished at the elk’s plight, I was reminded of the balance of nature and the daily quest for survival that takes place beyond our usual view. When we decided to make the trek through Yellowstone, I desperately wished to see a wolf, so this real-life drama was especially awe-inspiring.

Knowing that wildlife sightings can be rare because of the impact of tourists, I felt a deep sense of privilege that we had crossed paths with so many animals. As we drove home, we saw one other rare and symbolic member of Wyoming’s unique animal community: a bald eagle soaring against the brilliant blue sky. My husband and I agreed that we were delighted we’d made this trip after all. We both felt fortunate to have had a glimpse into the lives of the non-human beings with whom we share our corner of the world. For someone who respects animals as I do, it was an intensely gratifying few days.

I am thankful that I overcame my disdain for visiting Yellowstone; otherwise, I’d never have seen these precious creatures in their natural environment: free.

PERSONAL NARRATIVE – 2 Chunks, 1st draft

It's been forty-two years and I really shouldn't remember the moment with such clarity, but the fact is that twenty seconds of total embarrassment shaped the rest of my life. The man responsible for my humiliation went on to influence me in many ways, but never quite as dramatically as that first event.

It was September of 1962 and I was feeling very cocky about my success in a beginning Drama class at Ballard High School. My grades were right up near the top and more importantly, I absolutely loved the work. In a short two weeks of school, Drama had become the highlight of my day and I enjoyed every performance experience. The thrill of being in front of an audience was exhilarating. The instructor had established a strong sense of competition in the class. We constantly compared the grades we had received on the many performance assignments, but what really mattered was the praise we often received from the teacher. I truly was beginning to believe that I was something special. However, my arrogance was about to take a hit.

My high school career was always marked by a very casual attitude toward attendance. For some reason I decided to take a day off from school and when I came back, the drama class was buzzing about a major memorization assignment they were given, which was due today. I listened to many of them flounder their way through a very difficult speech. All the while I was enveloped in a smug sense of security. When the "voice in the back of the room" called my name, I rather proudly announced my absence on the previous day, expecting extra time to complete the assignment. However, the "voice" calmly said, "Yes, but you didn't come to see me this morning to get your missing work; that's an F." There was a whine of protest on my lips when it dawned on me that it might be wise to keep my mouth shut. No teacher before had ever made me pay a price for my attendance irregularities.

It was humiliating to have my failing grade announced to the class. I turned several interesting shades of red. For a few moments the unwanted stares and grins of my peers increased my torture. Suddenly, all of my earlier success seemed trivial. Fortunately, I came to realize that my moment of embarrassment was a clarification of the rules necessary to be part of the elite group that Drama was at Ballard. I was being invited to join, if I could accept those rules. It was the first time in my life that I had been treated like an adult. I got over my humiliation in a hurry.

I was a high school drama teacher for twenty-five years and that moment in 1962 began my journey. In a very real sense, I owe much of the joy and success of my life to the "voice from the back of the room."

Cherry Blossoms Scatter

By Deborah E. Louis

*It is precisely because
Cherry blossoms scatter
That we find them appealing.
Does anything endure for long
In this world of sorrows?*

- "Tales of Ise" 125

Mother was sitting at her Singer sewing machine nestled in the corner of our formal dining room when she called Alicia and me into the room.

"Girrlsss!" Her beckoning, soulful tone filled the hallways of our home. To our mother's loving New England voice, I, a ten year-old tomboy, and my sister, a twelve year-old genius and my hero, scampered from our peach-colored bedroom with twin beds placed against a beautiful and broad bay window where lightning bugs visited on warm, southern Texas nights. When we arrived, the reliable whirr of the sewing machine stopped. We hadn't a clue of what she wanted: perhaps she would assign another Saturday chore of housecleaning, perhaps she would announce an upcoming evening event at which I could wear the new Easter dress that I had been allowed to wear only once, the delicate white fabric scattered with red cherry blossoms. She had not called for Jimmy, our little brother, so maybe it was just a girl thing, something about dinner fixings, a fitting, or maybe—a secret. She continued peering at the unmanifested fabric as she quietly said, "Girls, I need to tell you something. I have leukemia."

What? What did she say? What . . . did . . . she . . . say? I stood there listening, but I did not hear, I did not understand. She did not cry, so I was not afraid. She did not elaborate, so I did not know. What was she telling me? What had to be for her and what

should have been for me, a heart-wrenching revelation, was stated so matter-of-factly, that it felt like she was announcing a typical afternoon appointment or an errand to run, and Alicia and I would be expected to watch over Jimmy. And where was Dad? If this were really important, wouldn't Dad be with her, with us?

I don't remember what else she said, really. I only remember that spring was gone, summer had begun, a cool Saturday afternoon aired before me, and I should be out in it, riding my blue bike around the neighborhood or finding the tallest oak tree to climb.

It has been more than thirty-eight years since that day, and I still seek the tallest oaks to climb; but, every once in a while I remember that afternoon. Like last night, after a memorable day of Dr. David Miller taking me "down and into" convex and concave mirrors, leading me forward and backward with images of Caravaggio and Picasso, of altered kaleidoscopes and rippled reflections, as I lay on my twin bed in the solitude of my private chamber, overlooking a garden where hummingbirds visit me on cool Santa Barbara nights, I cried for my mother's comforting New England voice and the beautiful, scattered cherry blossoms.

Deborah E. Louis
Summer Colloquium 2006
A 30-minute exercise ("My Life Story") by Dr. Ginette Paris
Mythological Studies – E1

If you are writing about a person, place, or thing consider developing your body paragraphs:

BP 1 focuses on

First reason I chose this person, place, or thing and what he, she, it means or meant to me

BP 2 focuses on

Second reason I chose this person, place, or thing and what he, she, it means or meant to me

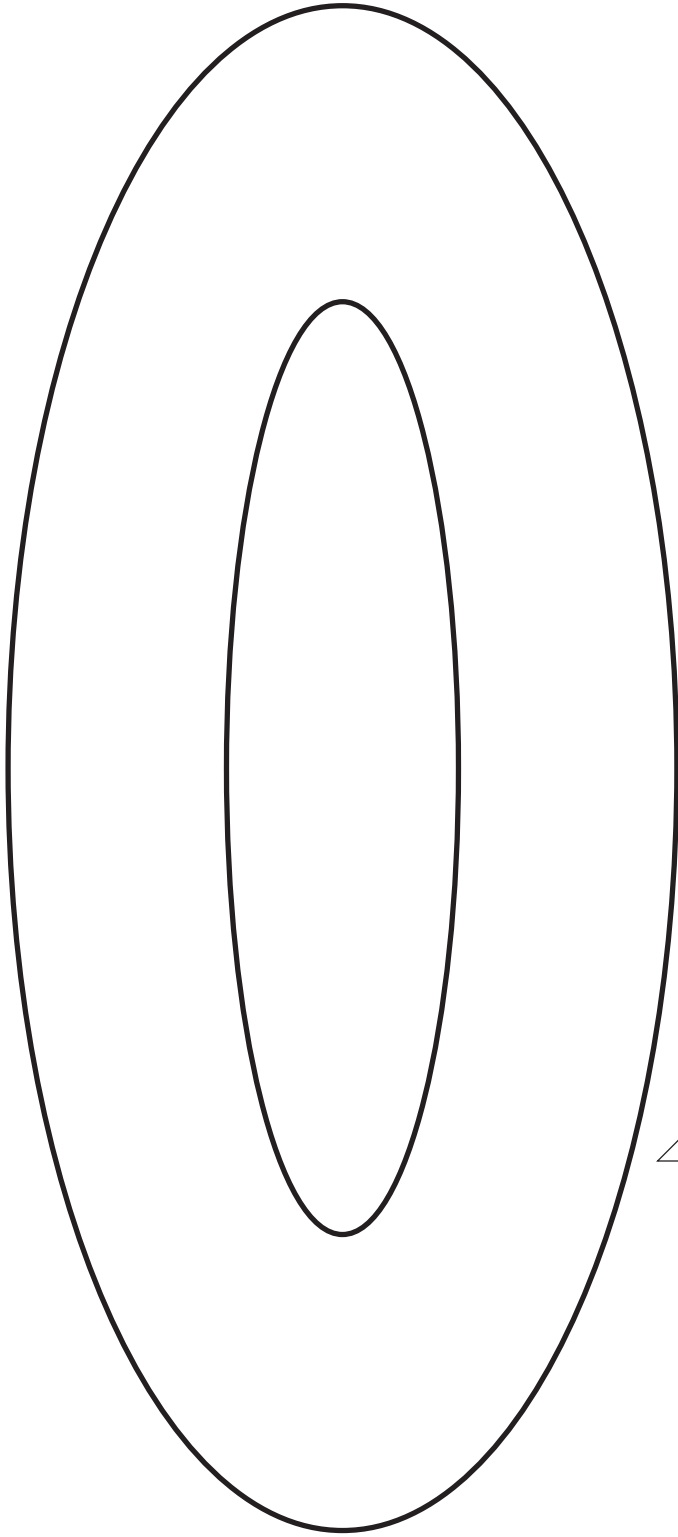
BP 3 focuses on

Third reason I chose this person, place, or thing and what he, she, it means or meant to me

Step 1: Discovering the Topic of My Narrative

Gather Ideas:

In the center oval, write the key word or phrase from the prompt. Brainstorm some general ideas that could fit the prompt. Star the idea that you know the most about or that interests you the most.



Specific, concrete example:

What did you decide? Write a concrete example of the selected general idea. An example might come from the past, the present. It could include an event, a person, a place, a thing, a memory.

I am going to write about _____

NARRATIVE ESSAY LAYOUTS

Person, Place, Thing

1. Prompt:

a. Write about a person who

b. Write about a place that

c. Write about something that
2. Now, do a 2-minute quick (on the back of this page) about the first idea(s) that come into your mind.
3. Next, think about how to organize your story. Complete the blocks below in order: 1, 2, and 3 first; 4, 5, and 6 afterward.

FOCUS	FEELINGS
Think about how you could divide your story into three parts	What feelings are associated with this person, place, or thing?
1. The beginning might focus on the first reason you like this person, place or thing which is	2. This means a lot to me because
3. The middle might focus on the second reason you like this person, place or thing which is	4. This means a lot to me because
5. The end might focus on the third reason you like this person, place or thing which is	6. This means a lot to me because

Topic Sentence Beginnings for a Person, Place, or Thing

Write about a person, place, or thing that . . .

Body Paragraph #1

- What I first remember about _____ was . . .
- When I think of _____, . . .
- I remember _____ like it was yesterday.
- The first reason I like, dislike _____ is that . . .
- What makes _____ important to me is . . .
- My first reaction to _____ was . . .
- I used to feel (feeling) about _____.

Body Paragraphs #2 and #3

- After the initial shock wore off, . . .
- Another reason I like, dislike _____ is that . . .
- When I started thinking more about _____, I realized that . . .
- Later, I began feeling _____ about _____.
- Secondly,
- Finally,
- Equally important is that . . .
- The greatest thing about . . .
- The worst thing about . . .
- Undoubtedly,
- As time went on, I realized . . .
- I finally came to understand that . . .
- After many years, I now feel
- In the end, I believe that . . .
- When I now think about _____, I feel . . .
- If I had to do it again, . . .

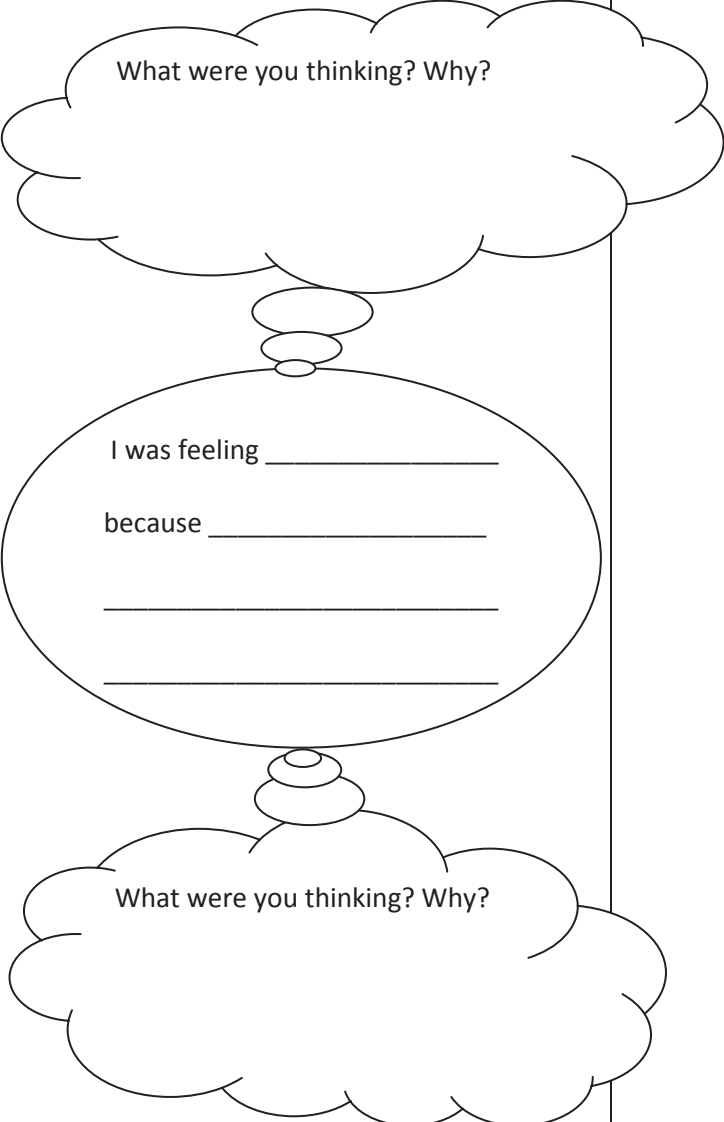


BP #

NARRATIVE (2+:1)
EVENT, PERSON, PLACE, OR THING
GATHERING CDS AND CMS ON THE T-CHART

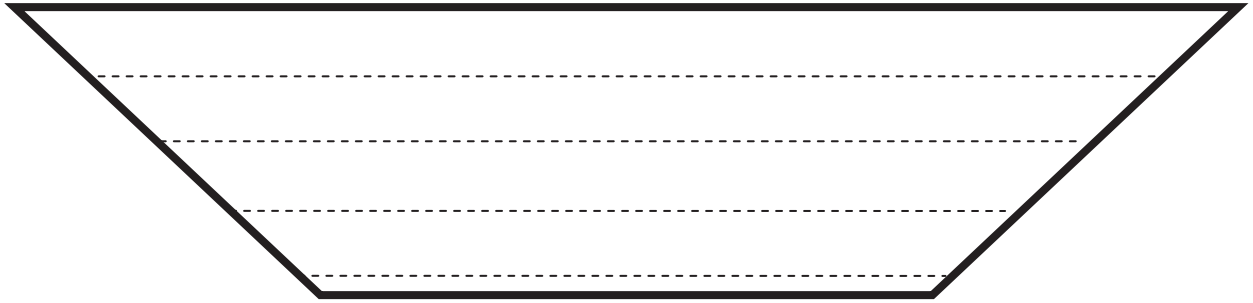
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Topic Sentence: _____

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Details about Where: ----- -----	
Who?	
Details about Who: ----- -----	
Details about What Happened (step-by-step)? ----- ----- ----- ----- -----	
Dialogue? ----- ----- -----	

Shaping Sheet (2+:1)

TS



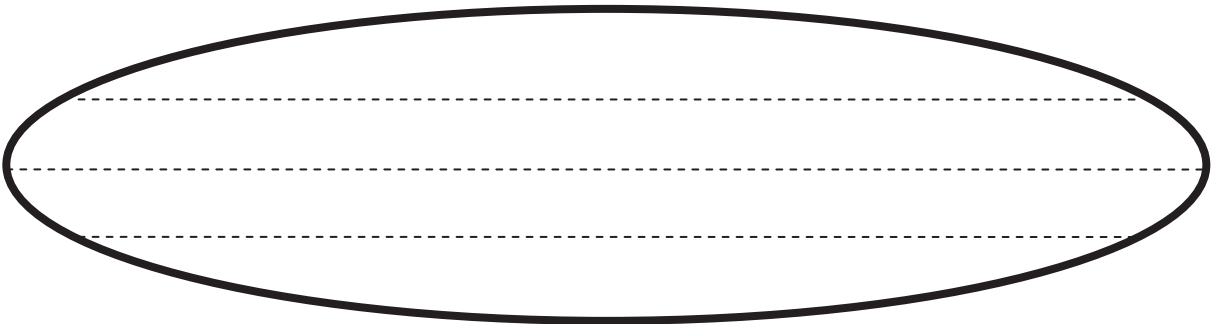
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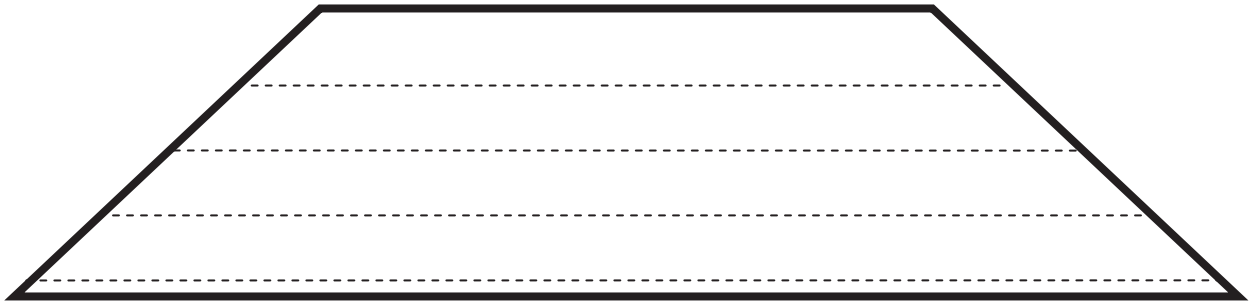
2nd CD



CM



CS



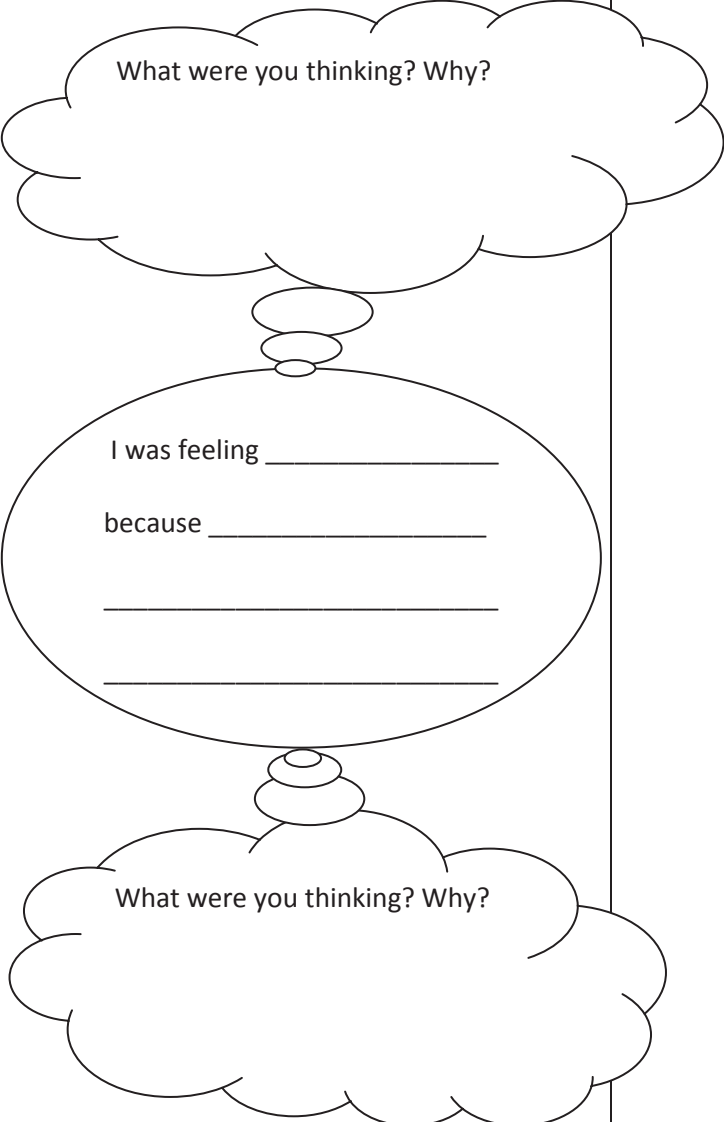


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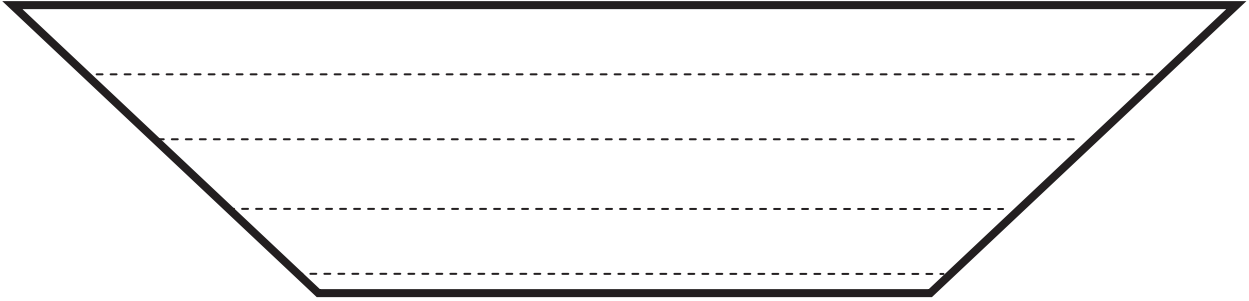
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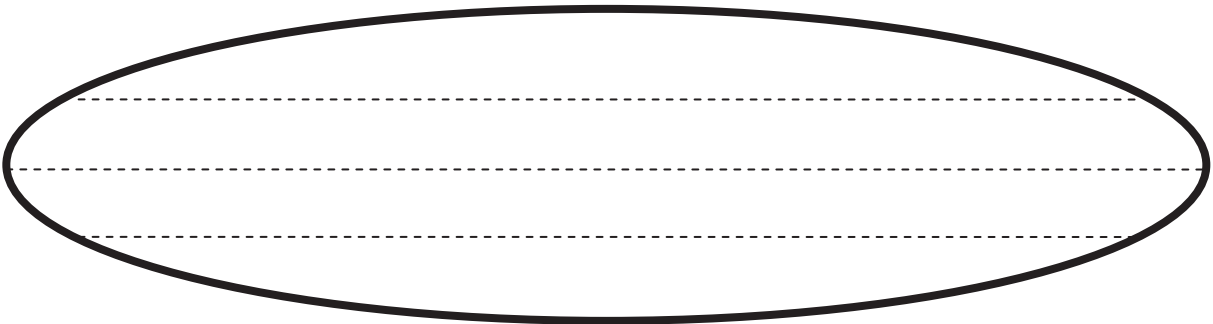
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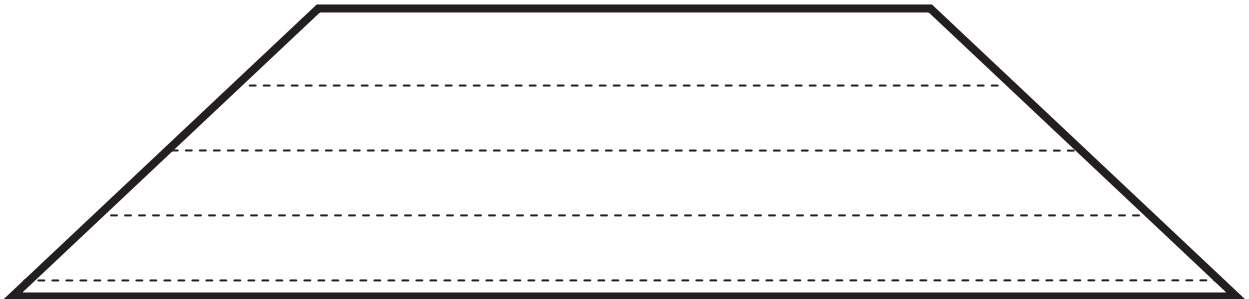
2nd CD



CM



CS





BP #

NARRATIVE (2+:1)
EVENT, PERSON, PLACE, OR THING
GATHERING CDS AND CMS ON THE T-CHART

Prompt: _____

Topic Sentence: _____

CDs	CMs
When?	Fill in the Circle in the MIDDLE and then web-off into the Clouds to Dig Deeper:
Details about When: _____ _____	
Where?	
Details about Where: _____ _____	
Who?	
Details about Who: _____ _____	
Details about What Happened (step-by-step)? _____ _____ _____ _____ _____	
Dialogue? _____ _____ _____	

Shaping Sheet (2+:1)

TS

A trapezoid shape with a solid black outline. Inside, there are four horizontal dashed lines for writing.

1st CD

A rectangle shape with a solid black outline. Inside, there are four horizontal dashed lines for writing.

2nd CD

A rectangle shape with a solid black outline. Inside, there are four horizontal dashed lines for writing.

CM

An oval shape with a solid black outline. Inside, there are four horizontal dashed lines for writing.

CS

A trapezoid shape with a solid black outline. Inside, there are four horizontal dashed lines for writing.

The Introduction

1. anecdote/flashback/tell a story	
2. Start with the climax or high point of your essay or story.	
3. rhetorical question.	
4. a startling fact or statement	
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6. a famous quotation	
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3 (I never realized that . . .) (I discovered that . . .) (I (have) learned that . . .) (I now know that . . .) (I want my reader to understand that . . .)	

Prompt: Your teacher has asked you to describe a place you go to have fun. It can be an amusement park, a secret hideout, your own room, or any other place you go to have fun. Before you begin to write, think about a place you go to have fun and say why.

Have you ever felt like one minute you are flying in the air and another minute your stomach was on top of your head? When I am riding a roller coaster, I am excited and scared at the same time. Going to an amusement park with roller coaster rides is my idea of fun because they are exciting and educational, they make me feel like I am flying in air, and they help me to forget about home chores and school work.

A roller coaster ride like Vertical Velocity makes me feel like I am falling without a parachute. Vertical Velocity is a roller coaster at Six Flags over Texas that rises and falls between two towers. It goes straight up one tower and then travels 70 mph straight down. My best friend, Jordan, and I went to Six Flags a couple of years ago on summer vacation with our families. When we were riding the Vertical Velocity, all I could hear is myself and Jordan screaming, “Aaaaauuuggghhh!” When the ride was over, we looked at each other and made a pact to spend every summer vacation finding roller coasters to ride. The Vertical Velocity is such a rush because at any moment I think I might crash into the concrete. I am always relieved when the ride ends, but then I find myself back in the line again to feel that same crazy feeling of free-falling.

Another roller coaster that I like to ride is called Space Mountain which is not only exciting but also educational. Space Mountain is a roller coaster ride at Disney World in Florida. Jordan and I climbed into what looked like rocket ships, got strapped in, and the ships blasted off into outer space where we saw stars and planets and satellites all around me. When we jumped off and ran back to get in line again, I yelled to Jordan, “Just wait until we tell our science teacher, Mr. Pollux, about this ride!” Jordan yelled back, “Yeah, I can’t wait to start back to school!” Then we both looked at each other and cracked up. When I am riding Space Mountain, I feel cool because I imagine myself as an astronaut in outer space. This roller coaster goes fast, but it also makes me feel like I am vacationing in another galaxy.

My favorite roller coaster ride of all time is the Millenium Force because it is the most awesome ride on the planet. At the beginning of last summer, Jordan and I heard about this ride that had been built in Cedar Point, Ohio. We looked online and found out that this roller

coaster had been rated as one of the most popular roller coasters in the country since it was built in 2001. We asked our parents if we could go, and both sets of parents said, “Yes, if you earn enough money working this summer.” By August, we had saved enough money to go. The ride begins slowly, climbing at an angle of forty-five degrees before it drops 300 feet. Jordan and I rode this ride until we both got sick. It was one of those experiences that I knew I would never forget. The Millenium Force was the ultimate ride of my life.

My favorite place to have fun is strapped into a roller coaster. The freedom I feel when I am up in the air on a roller coaster is one that I cannot describe. When I look back on my life, I will remember the fun times Jordan and I had experiencing roller coasters all over the country, and I will wonder if anything can ever compare.

Duncanville is a sprawling suburb about fifteen minutes south of Dallas with a population of approximately 50,000. However, when I arrived there as a child, Duncanville's population consisted of about 5,000 people, and the suburb had aesthetic characteristics of a small town and a child's paradise.

As children, my sister, Alicia, brother, Jim, and I played countless hours in the wooded lots and by the running creeks that were part of our everyday surroundings. Trees as far as we could see created a haven for tree houses of every shape and size. Twisted vines hung from enormous oaks which reached high into the blue sky. Wild West episodes, kidnapping capers, and hide-and-seek escapades filled up our leisure time and childlike fantasies. In the deep woods were pet cemeteries and secret hideaways. We would leave our home early Saturday mornings and stay gone until dusk and dinner time, riding bikes, having picnics, and fishing and swimming in the creeks. It was a life filled with fun and innocence, adventure and imagination with plenty of friends and open spaces to play. Even our street name, Jungle Drive, carried the magical message of adventures in the wild.

By the time I reached my early teens I decided that the only way I would truly experience any real adventure in my life would be to leave Duncanville and travel to distant lands. Living close to Dallas, I experienced big city shopping, restaurants, and entertainment. Mom would take Alicia, Jimmy, and me to the city to shop for school clothes and to go to doctors' appointments. I became mesmerized by the big city, and desired the chance to further explore its mysteries, believing in my heart there must be more to life than men chewing tobacco, women listening to melancholy country love songs, or marriage with six hungry and crying children. By the time I started college, I began saving my

money to travel. As a freshman at The University of Texas at Austin, I enrolled in French and Spanish. My mother and I discussed my going to Europe when I graduated in order to expose myself to other cultures. By 22 I saved enough money to take a six month trip to Europe on a five dollar a day budget. I flew across the Atlantic Ocean with dreams of adventure and heroism. Jungle Drive was fine for an adventuresome child, but there existed no new ideas or excitement for a maturing, questioning, and adventure-seeking young adult, and I was on my way to see fame and fortune.

Although my travels introduced me to many new and interesting people and places, at times I found myself nonchalantly wandering, daydreaming about my family and friends in Texas, beginning to realize the impact my neighborhood and my state had on my life. I remember thinking that while Texas did not have the mountains of Spain, the rug bazaars of Morocco, or the cuisine and canals of Venice, what it did have was Jungle Drive. Texas had people who understood me, not only my language, but my feelings and “ways.” I came home for awhile, but then I moved to New York City. New York had no open spaces like the Texas plains. New Yorkers were not slow-talking people who did not get in a big hurry like Texans. In New York I could not find cowboy boots, country music, or, yes, even men chewing tobacco. My family lived 2,000 miles away. Living far away was quite an adventure, but it did not make me a different person, and I had come to realize by that time that I did not want to be different; I did not need to impress anyone; I felt good about myself. I returned to my home and my neighborhood.

The state of Texas will always be my home. I may move to the west coast next year or back to the east coast, and that is all right, too. I love to travel, and I

continue to travel all over the world, but Texas and its culture are a part of who I am, and I am proud of that. Yes, with all its “good ol’ boys” and rodeos, oil wells, square dances, lizard-skin boots and banana-styled hats, chicken fried steak, barbecue and baked beans, and even the Cadillacs with longhorns on the hood, I loved Texas as a child, and I love it now. It is where this yellow rose resides.

Fictional Narrative

SETTING

- Setting involves time, place, weather, and surroundings (social mores), all helping to create a specific mood or atmosphere.
- To reveal these elements, writers depend on descriptive writing, calling on all the senses to convey an image to the reader.
- Good description will involve as many of the five senses as possible plus movement.

The elements chosen by a writer to reveal the historical setting of a story may include:

- | | | |
|--------------------|------------------------------|------------------|
| • manner of speech | • technology or lack thereof | • tools |
| • jargon | • architecture | • names |
| • slang | • furnishings | • customs |
| • clothing | • period art | • manners |
| • landscape | • vehicles | • hairstyles |
| • roads | • money | • food and drink |

Mood, or atmosphere, can be indicated through the author's choice of verbs, as well as nouns and adjectives. Strong verbs are always best. Weather can also be used to indicate the atmosphere in a story.

- Examples of Weak and Strong mood development:
 - The cat went across the lawn. [Weak mood]
 - The skinny black cat slunk across the dark, rain-soaked lawn. [Stronger mood]
 - The man was hoping for a romantic evening (Weak mood)
 - When the door opened, the lights were dim, candles were lit, and a love song was playing in the background (Stronger mood)

PLOT

There are **Six Basic Plots** used by famous writers and may be used by beginning writers without fear of plagiarism. These may be used alone or in combination and form the basis of nearly all story conflicts, for books, plays, movies, television programs, and video games.

1. **Lost and Found** - Person or object is lost and recovered (e.g., *The Incredible Journey*, *Home Alone*, *The Changeling*)
2. **Character vs. Nature** - Character survives a natural calamity (e.g., *Jaws*, *Cast Away*, *Life of Pi*, *Unbroken*)

3. **Character with a Personal Problem or Goal** - character solves it, reaches goal or changes attitude or feelings (e.g., *Freckle Juice*, *Rudy*, *Rocky*, *Cinderella Man*, *The Hunger Games*)
4. **Good Guys vs. Bad Guys** - good guys usually win (e.g., *The Three Little Pigs*, *The Wizard of Oz*, *The Sting*, *The Lord of the Rings*, or most westerns)
5. **Crime and Punishment or Mystery and Solution** - Character solves a mystery or crime and the culprit is caught or punished (e.g., *Elementary*, *The Fast and the Furious*, *The Pink Panther*, *James Bond films*)
6. **Boy meets Girl** - Problems or misunderstandings arise; Characters resolve differences or clear up misunderstandings (e.g., *Romeo and Juliet*, *Snow White*, *Cinderella*, *You've Got Mail*, *The Notebook*)

Complications of Plot: Tension, Conflict, Building Suspense

The conflict, goal, problem, or what the main character wants should be set up in the first sentence, paragraph, page, or chapter, depending upon a story's length. If not stated outright, it should at least be hinted at very strongly,

Writers need to create tension in order to keep their readers interested. Writers want their readers to wonder, "What happens next?"

Writers do this in several ways:

- Time pressure –
 - The character has a limited amount of time in which to accomplish a goal or solve a problem. (e.g., *Rumpelstiltskin*, *Hansel and Gretel*, *Star Trek IV*)
 - Forces of nature - tide coming in, impending storm, etc.
 - Deadline dates - preparations, contest entry deadlines, athletic training for a specific contest, mortgage payment, bomb set to go off, harvest before the rain frost, onset of winter, etc.
 - Arrival of holiday - birthday of Christmas gifts to make, etc.
- Series of Setbacks in Plot
 - The most important part of the plot is the series of setbacks the main character faces in trying to resolve the conflict or attain the goal.
 - In well-developed fiction, there are often three or more of them.
 - The series of setbacks make up the middle of the story. The main character overcomes each successively more difficult setback - the last one in a grand way to a satisfactory close.
 - Some ideas for events or setbacks that might temporarily prevent the characters from solving their problems:

- injuries
 - weather
 - losses
 - mistakes
 - misunderstandings
 - mishaps or accidents
- Reader knows a Secret the Character Doesn't Know
 - Tension rises when the reader learns something through the narration that the character doesn't know. The reader becomes anxious for the character
 - Examples
 - *The saddle girth is frayed and about to break.*
 - *A villain is hiding in the house. A trap has been laid.*
- Anticipation of a Major Scene - Characters set up the tension through their dialogue about the Big Event or their warnings. They anticipate another character's arrival or action(s).

POINT OF VIEW

Point of View or “Perspective” refers to how the author of a story speaks to a reader. In other words, everything is revealed through the narrator's eyes

Beginning writers should concentrate on one of two basic points of view:

- **Third Person Point of View** – (most common) The author acts as a narrator. (NOT a character in the story). In third-person, the narrator knows everything and tells the reader what the main characters are thinking and doing. The author uses the third person pronouns such as “he,” “she,” and “they,” as well as the characters' names to tell the story.
- **First Person Point of View**- The author tells the story from the main character's point of view. The author uses the first-person pronouns such as “I” and “me” to tell the story. First person can make a story more believable. To overcome the problem of having to have the main character present in every scene in order to relate the events, writers sometimes have minor characters simply tell the main character about events he or she missed.

BEGINNINGS, TRANSITIONS, AND ENDINGS

Beginnings

Beginning writers can learn to "hook" their readers in the first sentence. This can be done with any of the following techniques:

- The author introduces the main character by name.
- The main character, named, is thinking of something.
- The author describes the setting (place).
- The author tells the setting (time).
- The author sets up the conflict in the first sentence.
- The character is talking (dialogue).
- An event is in progress.
- Combinations of any of the above.
- A letter or note is read.
- A prologue (background information) tells of events from the past that set up the story

Transitions

Narrative fiction is characterized by the passage of time. A writer helps the reader follow the story's events, in time and place, by using transitions that show changes in time, place, characters, or action. Transitions can be one word, a phrase, or a whole sentence to show these changes clearly for a reader.

Situate Time (*e.g., The following morning or A hundred years passed . (shows change of time)*)

- | | | | |
|-----------------|--------------|-----------------|-------------|
| • after | • earlier | • in the | • soon |
| • afterward | • eventually | meantime | • sooner or |
| • as soon as | • finally | • in the past | later |
| • at least | • first | • later | • then |
| • at the same | • formerly | • meanwhile | • until |
| time | • in the | • moments later | • when |
| • at this point | beginning | • now | • while |
| • before | • in the end | • presently | |
| • during | | • since | |

Situate Place. (*e.g., Meanwhile, back at the ranch . . . (shows change in place)*)

- | | | | |
|---------------|-------------|--------------|-----------|
| • aboard | • about | • above | |
| • across | • ahead of | • amid | • around |
| • adjacent to | • along | • among | • at |
| • against | • alongside | • apart from | • back of |

- | | | | |
|-----------|---------------|-----------------|--------------|
| • before | • between | • juxtaposed to | • throughout |
| • behind | • beyond | • nearby | • underneath |
| • below | • down | • next to | |
| • beneath | • in-/outside | • opposite | |

Change in Characters. (e.g., *While Cinderella worked hard to finish all of her chores, her wicked stepsisters were busy plotting against her. . .* (shows change in characters))

Endings

The conclusion of a fictional narrative must reveal the end of the conflict and/or the lesson learned or insight gained by the characters from the experience. If you have trouble, go back and identify which of the six basic plots that you have chosen to use in your story, and make sure that you have an ending that fits the type.

- End with a quotation from one of the characters.
- End with the main character's feelings about the event.
 - I knew then that I had succeeded. I was overjoyed to have finally found my happily-ever-after.
- End with a prediction or advice.
 - The next time he came across a strange-looking little man, he walked right on by.
- End with a summary statement.
 - No matter how you look at it, laughter is good medicine
- Writers who can't seem to find the right ending may need to review the basic plot types and their corresponding resolutions. They might also try writing several endings and see which one works best. Do NOT use the following openings, but consider what you would write after you or the character says this to yourself or himself:
 - (I never realized that)...
 - (I discovered that)...
 - (I (have) learned that)...
 - (I now know that)...
 - (I want my reader to understand that)...

SAMPLE FICTIONAL NARRATIVE PROMPTS

From the Florida Department of Education

Students were asked to write a story about a time an animal does something smart.

From the WASL (Washington Assessment of Student Learning)

- In your classroom, you notice there is a closet your teacher never opens. One day you open it. In several paragraphs, write a story telling what happens.
- While looking out the window one day at school, you notice the principal flying through the air. In several paragraphs, write a story telling what happens.
- One day you find a bottle with a rolled-up piece of paper inside. In several paragraphs, write a story telling what happens.
- One day while hiking in the mountains, you come upon a cave. In several paragraphs, write a story about what happens.
- One day, as you are walking to school, your backpack turns into a pair of wings. In several paragraphs, write a story about what happens.

From the CST (California Standards Test)

- One day on a walk with your dog, the dog suddenly begins to talk about where he used to live and how he would like to go back there. Write about what happens that day.
- Imagine that you suddenly wake up and find yourself a player on your favorite sports team. Fans are cheering for you. Tell why they are cheering, and write a story about what happens next.
- While cleaning out a closet, you discover a treasure map. Write a narrative describing what happens the day you try to find where the map leads.

Narrative Prompt:

One day while hiking in the mountains, you come across a cave. In several paragraphs, write a story telling what happens. NOTE: We tried to write this story in the “voice” or style of a typical fourth grader.

Let me tell you about an exciting adventure I had while hiking with my friend Jessica at Mount Rainier. It was an experience I'll never forget.

Jessica's dad is a forest ranger at Mount Rainier National Park. Last summer he told us about a great hike. Jessica and I were excited and happy as we packed up our backpacks and headed up the mountain. After we walked up over a ridge, we noticed a cave. We were curious to see what it was like inside, so we went in. As we entered, we saw that it was kind of dark. With each step we took, it got darker and darker. Jessica remembered that her dad had told her to pack a flashlight in her backpack, so she whipped it out and flashed it around the walls of the cave. Suddenly, we were surprised to see two big, brown eyes staring back at us. A shiver went up my spine.

We stopped in our tracks. As our eyes adjusted to the darkness, we realized that these were the eyes of a fawn. The fawn looked sad and wasn't moving. We walked closer and realized that the fawn couldn't get up because it looked like his leg was broken. The fawn seemed weak, so we were anxious to do something to help him. We decided to give him some water from our water bottles and feed him some berries we had found along the way. When the fawn wouldn't eat, we got really worried. Jessica remembered that her dad had told her never to touch a wounded animal, so we just watched the fawn and tried to keep him company. After awhile, we realized it was getting dark outside and Jessica's dad might be getting worried. We had no way to help the fawn and we didn't know what to do.

Jessica and I decided that she should go get her dad while I waited with the fawn. It seemed like she was gone forever. All of a sudden, I heard a noise that sounded like a helicopter. I ran out of the cave and was so relieved to see a forest service helicopter shining its lights down and getting ready to land. When the helicopter landed, I was so happy to see Jessica's dad jump out with Jessica and two other rangers. They quickly scooped up the fawn into a special rescue basket. Together, we all climbed aboard the helicopter and took off for the animal hospital.

We had a fabulous ride, but the best part was that Jessica and I knew the fawn was finally going to be okay.



Analyze

1. **Quick fiction** has all of the elements of a traditional short story with some distinctive features:
 - a. Centers on a single event
 - b. Takes place in minutes
 - c. Utilizes back story to compress action
 - d. Focuses primarily on a single character, the protagonist
 - e. Often ends with an ironic twist
 - f. Communicates the importance of or reasons for actions and/or consequences
2. The ABC Plan Overview
 - a. **A = An Idea.** Narrow the focus.
 - b. **B = Breakdown:** Choose a type of conflict. The type of conflict will lead to the theme of the story. Identify a situation in which the conflict will emerge.
 - c. **C = Chain:** Sketch the details of the story elements in the links of the chain.
 - i. Key term
 - ii. Character
 - iii. Setting
 - iv. Back story
 - v. Conflict
 - vi. End
3. Analyze a practice prompt - Identify the key term or phrase of the prompt and write it in the center oval. In the outer oval, list some ideas that fit within the category of the key term.
4. Decide on a concrete example that includes conflict and resolution
 - a. Select the type of conflict that will drive the narrative.
 - b. Write the concrete example in the rectangular box.
5. Complete the entire chain before starting to write. Use the chain to make whatever changes in structure that might be needed as there will not be time or space to revise after the narrative has been written.



Character and Point-of-View

1. In the link, write a few essential characteristics of the protagonist.
2. Begin the story by introducing the character in the middle of the situation.
3. Students may write in 1st or 3rd person point-of-view. However, 3rd person offers several benefits:
 - a. Facilitates description
 - b. Allows for stronger sentence structure
 - c. Reduces the overuse of "I."
 - d. Distinguishes the story from a personal narrative.
4. Using indirect characterization conserves space and adds interest
5. Write with action verbs in the active voice and the past tense. Past tense is not a requirement of quick fiction, but will reduce the problem of students' jumping between tenses.



Setting

Setting establishes the time, place, and atmosphere (emotional context) of the story.

1. In the link, write a few essential details of setting.
2. Devote just a few lines to setting, but those lines provide a good opportunity to use imagery and figurative language.
3. Can add a detail or two here about the protagonist.



Back Story

Back Story is the recent history that brought the character to this point

1. In the link, write a few essential details that explain the previous event(s) that resulted in the protagonist's situation.
2. Transitions are extremely important both when moving into the back story and when returning to the action of the story.
3. WARNING: be sure students make that transition into the action of the story instead of staying in the past and moving forward from there. That defeats the purpose of using the flashback.
4. This makes a good place to introduce the key word from the prompt. However, it can appear anywhere in the narrative. It is not a requirement that the student use it, but it helps to demonstrate that the student is writing on the prompt. The word should appear naturally in the story and not in an expository tag at the beginning or end of the story.



Conflict

The conflict is the story. No conflict = No story!

1. In the link, write a few essential details about the antagonist and the conflict.
2. Limit to a single event.
3. Set the protagonist in opposition to the antagonist (remember, the antagonist does not have to be a person. It could be weather, technology, an animal, a big decision).
4. Build suspense.
5. This section provides a good opportunity for figurative language.
6. End with an ironic twist.
7. Use dialogue, but limit it to important lines.
8. Write with a variety of sentence structure.



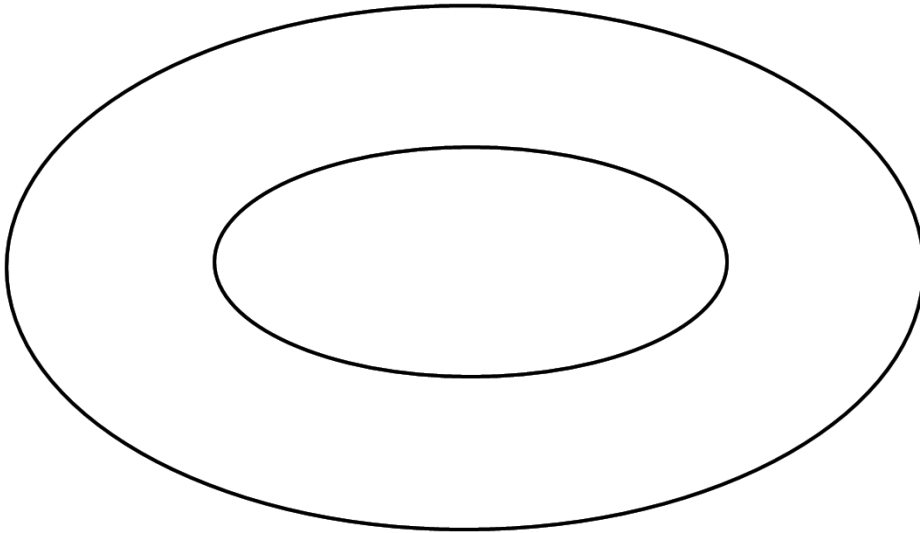
End

1. In the link, write a few essential details about the ending.
2. Two important reminders about endings:
 - a. The ending should represent a clear resolution to the conflict.
 - b. Elements of the ending should connect to elements of the beginning.
3. Editing
 - a. Students should read what they have written. Giving them a few important items to look for will be more effective than assigning the somewhat intimidating task of finding anything that could possibly be wrong with the essay.
 - b. Suggest that they check for transitions, fragments/run-on sentences, and opportunities to strengthen diction, including use of imagery and figurative language.
 - c. Also, throughout the year, have students keep a personal log of their writing mistakes. They should identify their three most common errors and especially look for those problems in the editing process.

Quick Fiction Planning Page

Gather Ideas:

In the center oval, write the key word or phrase of the prompt. Web-off-the-Word™ or phrase some typical experiences that could fit within the category of the prompt. Star the idea that you know the most about or that interests you the most.

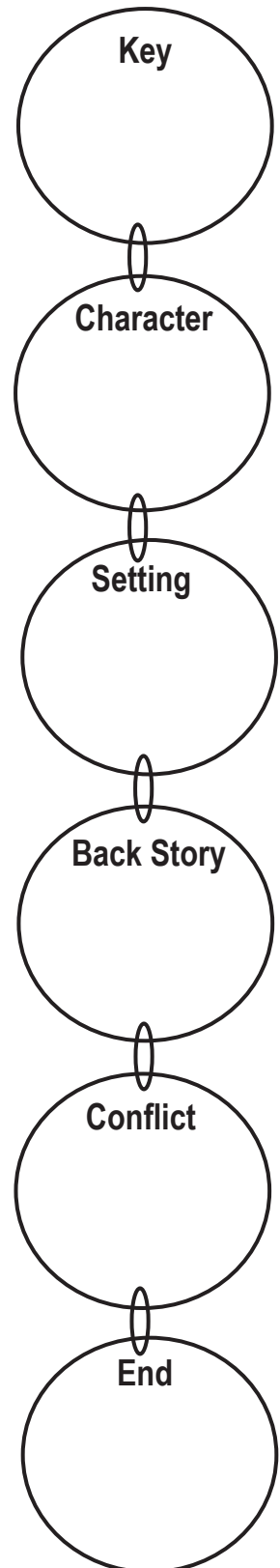


B = BREAKDOWN

Write the idea you selected and your concrete example in the box below. Remember, the concrete example is an imaginary or actual event that took place. If it is an actual event that took place in your life, create a character's name.

The Plot

Use the story chain to develop the situation.



Quick Fiction Practice Prompt

Growing up is a common theme in literature. *Peter Pan*, by J.M. Barrie, is a story about a boy who didn't want to grow up. Of Peter's friend Wendy, the narrator says, "You need not be sorry for her. She was one of the kind that likes to grow up. In the end she grew up of her own free will a day quicker than the other girls." Write a story about growing up.

Literary Writing

Look at the photograph.



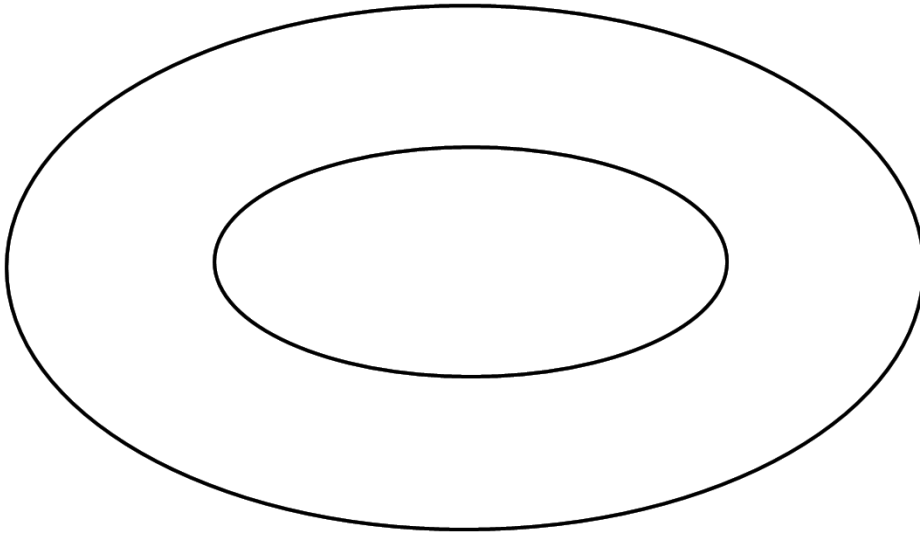
theatlantic.com

Write a story about a traumatic event. Be sure that your story is focused and complete and that it has an interesting plot and engaging characters.

Quick Fiction Planning Page

Gather Ideas:

In the center oval, write the key word or phrase of the prompt. Web-off-the-Word™ or phrase some typical experiences that could fit within the category of the prompt. Star the idea that you know the most about or that interests you the most.

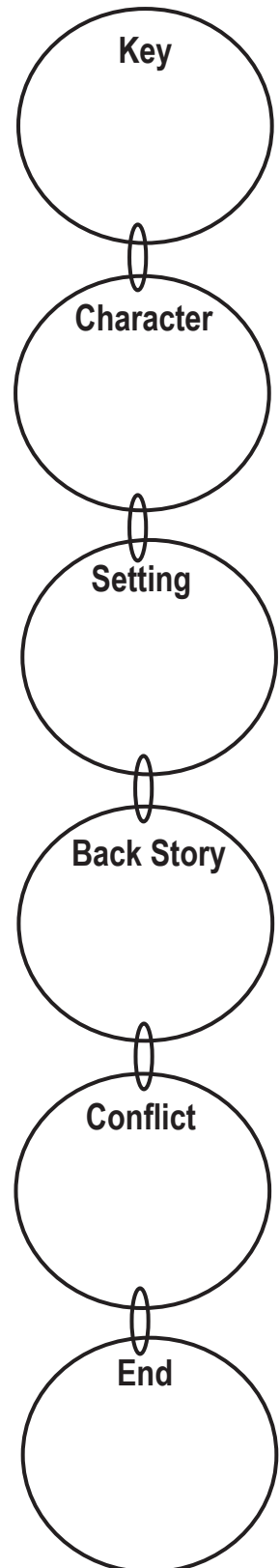


B = BREAKDOWN

Write the idea you selected and your concrete example in the box below. Remember, the concrete example is an imaginary or actual event that took place. If it is an actual event that took place in your life, create a character's name.

The Plot

Use the story chain to develop the situation.



A large rectangular box with a solid black border, containing 18 horizontal dashed lines for writing. The lines are evenly spaced and extend across most of the width of the box.



A Teacher's Toolbox

Jane's #3 Non-Negotiable: The Consistency of a Departmental Program Outweighs Individual Teacher Preference. Everyone Abides by Majority Vote.

As beginning teachers, we saw the lack of consistency within our English departments. One person required outside reading; another didn't. One taught a great deal of writing; another taught speeches; another focused only on the research paper. That was in 1969, but things haven't changed much. As one principal observed, "Everyone does his/her own thing with writing."

But we have seen what happens when consistency is achieved, and we cannot recommend it enough. Both students and teachers reap the benefits. The department doesn't have to agree to all of the shared agreements that we've included below, but it does have to agree to be consistent.

Following are some examples of consistency adopted by a variety of departments. No one department chose all of them. They are all phrased in terms of behavior, of what the group agrees to implement. The list is provided to begin a conversation:

We will all...

- teach writing, not just assign it.
- use a common terminology for the paragraph and essay.
- use the writing process that includes the agreed-upon steps. All of these steps are required unless the teacher indicates otherwise.
- require that all pieces involved in the assignment are turned in with the final draft.
- use a cover sheet, scoring guide, and grading codes list.
- schedule regular meetings to examine and discuss student work.
- use color coding in beginning direct instruction and continue using it with individual students, as appropriate.
- develop and use a department-wide scoring guide for all major writing assignments.
- see students in one-to-one conferencing.
- institute multiyear, cumulative writing folders for each student that we pass on to the next teacher each fall.
- write with each other and with our students.
- do most, if not all, of the writing in class, not as homework, for as long as students need it.

To Establish Consistency

First, the department has to agree to operate by majority vote, and that means having an initial vote to function by that agreement. Consistency of the program outweighs individual teacher preference. It's better for kids.

We realize that this approach is revolutionary in a field where the maverick mentality can hold sway. But we've observed what happens when consistency is in place: students learn better. When a teacher told her sophomore class that she would be using the same essay terminology as the ninth-grade teachers had used, one girl said, "You mean I don't have to

un-learn and re-learn and un-learn and re-learn with each one of you?” Her obvious sense of relief was overwhelming.

This agreement includes the idea that all members will abide by majority vote. Teachers don’t get to “do their own thing.” If they are in the minority, they are expected to abide by majority vote and adjust to the decisions of the group as a whole.

Part of being consistent is abiding by **Jane’s #6 Non-Negotiable: Sharing of ideas and student work is essential.**

Teachers need to discuss what they are doing in their classes for feedback and suggestions. Ultimately, though, monitoring can become an administrator responsibility beyond the realm of the department head and colleagues.

Second, the group can discuss which policies are to be adopted and publicized to department members, administrators, students, and parents. If they aren’t publicized, they won’t be implemented as they should.

- Adaptations for Special Education/ELL Students

We make one exception: we do narrative writing with ELL students until their academic English is broad enough to do response to literature writing.

- Adaptations for Advanced Placement® Students

While the AP® students benefit greatly from the program, the teachers of AP students must present the language of the test so that students won’t be surprised on exam day. Therefore, some of the terminology might be different for those courses. In addition, whereas a department might ask for process papers, AP classes need to practice timed writings. In the Lang and Comp course, nonfiction rules; so, departmental policies regarding modes might need to be altered while at the same time keeping vertical alignment and scaffolding in mind. These are just a few discussion points that a department might address as they differentiate for their students and the curricula.

The Place of Writing in the Curriculum

People have discussed the pressures we all share about covering the curriculum. Our answer: treat the writing part of the curriculum as center stage, and all of the ELA standards across the county will fall under that umbrella. If writing doesn’t get the attention and time it needs, it will never be taught well.

Too often, writing is assigned as homework instead of classwork, and then teachers complain that students can’t write. One problem we face as teachers is that our students don’t do much homework. We can’t remember a time that an entire class turned in a homework assignment. We don’t think it’s malicious; students just don’t think of school much after 3:00 (or earlier). If teachers assign writing as homework, odds are that it won’t be done correctly or done at all (of course, we know those students who always do their work, and we are so proud of them

and the work ethic they have been taught by their parents and teachers). However, when students don't do homework, chaos can follow. If a teacher assigns a reading assignment for homework, and the next day's lesson plan is built on that reading, what are we to do when $\frac{3}{4}$ of the class hasn't done it?

We believe wholeheartedly that students will never learn to write if it is always assigned as homework. In class, students need us to monitor their work carefully, over their shoulders, in one-to-one conferences, at the moment of writing, and teach and re-teach constantly. Furthermore, unfortunately, students plagiarize from the internet, from their friends, and from their parents.

We do allow students to write at home as they become more skilled and trustworthy. Some pieces of the process work well as homework, such as the pre-writing steps. We have devised writing-based practices for homework and have made them as uncheatable as we can. If they are working at a computer, we require all work to be printed before each day and brought to class. If students don't do this, they forfeit the privilege of writing at home. We do not allow students to e-mail their work or bring a flashdrive to school for us to print their work. If they submit it electronically, it's the final draft that will be placed in their electronic portfolio.

There is an exception: some teachers like to use the "Tracking Changes" function from Microsoft® Office® Word®. In that case, the students e-mail their draft, and the teacher makes comments and suggests changes. Once s/he has done that, the document is saved as a .pdf so there exists substantive proof of the resulting grade. The teacher e-mails the original document and the .pdf so that 1) the student can make the suggested revisions, and 2) the student will have the scored essay. The teacher maintains the scored document in an electronic folder.

When teachers allow typed final drafts,

- some have the students do the final in handwriting in class and then send it home for typing and MLA formatting. The two drafts have to match. If students have "lost" their handwritten draft, they have to start over on a new topic. We alert them to the consequences beforehand, so this problem hasn't happened to us yet. Students don't want to take that risk;
- in other cases, schools purchase plagiarism detection software, such as turnitin.com. They check their students' original work through this method; and
- with our new interactive graphic organizers, students may copy and paste from their prewriting into a final draft.

Different teachers have different policies. You're the expert and know your students. Do what's best for the students – Writing is Thinking.

Timelines

We give a diagnostic writing assignment to every student every year. The diagnostic piece goes into the writer's folder (see Toolbox). It serves as a pre-test. During the year, we give formative assessments and follow with a summative post-test for comparison at the end of the year. Here is a typical prompt for an elementary student:

3rd grade: Write a paragraph about a time that you were surprised. Discuss when and where the surprise happened, who was there, what happened, and how you felt.

4th grade: Write a paragraph about someone who makes you laugh and describe a certain moment in time when you laughed out loud because of what that person said or did.

5th grade: Write an essay about a real or fictional place you would like to visit and why. Your essay should include an introduction, one or two body paragraphs, and a conclusion.

Students receive points for completing the diagnostic assignment with the cover sheet and scoring guide. We don't grade it, although teachers may choose to. Even if students are not finished at the bell, we collect whatever they have written and give completion credit, assuming they have been working productively during the period.

Life is a Continuous Cycle of Learning

At the end of the year, we give the same assignment again without mentioning that they have written on this topic. We take a grade on this assignment. Then, we show the students and their parents the two and ask them to reflect on their learning during the year. That's right – the parents' learning, too.

Timing

Teaching writing means teaching thinking, and we have not found a short way to do that at all. It just takes time. And if we don't allow the necessary time, our students will not learn how to write. We try to write a little or more every day.

Paragraph First, Essay Later

We used to start with the essay on the second day of school. One year, a girl said, "I've never done essays before and am going crazy learning so many new things at once. Is it possible to teach us only a few new things at first, and then some more new things later?"

In teacher talk, she was asking, "Can you teach us the paragraph first, and when we learn that, teach us the essay later?" We figured that we had nothing to lose and tried it. The girl was right. The body paragraphs do the hard work of the essay. And when students learn the paragraph first, they only have to learn three new skills later for the narrative essay: writing the introduction to open the paper, the thesis to focus the entire essay with transitions, and the

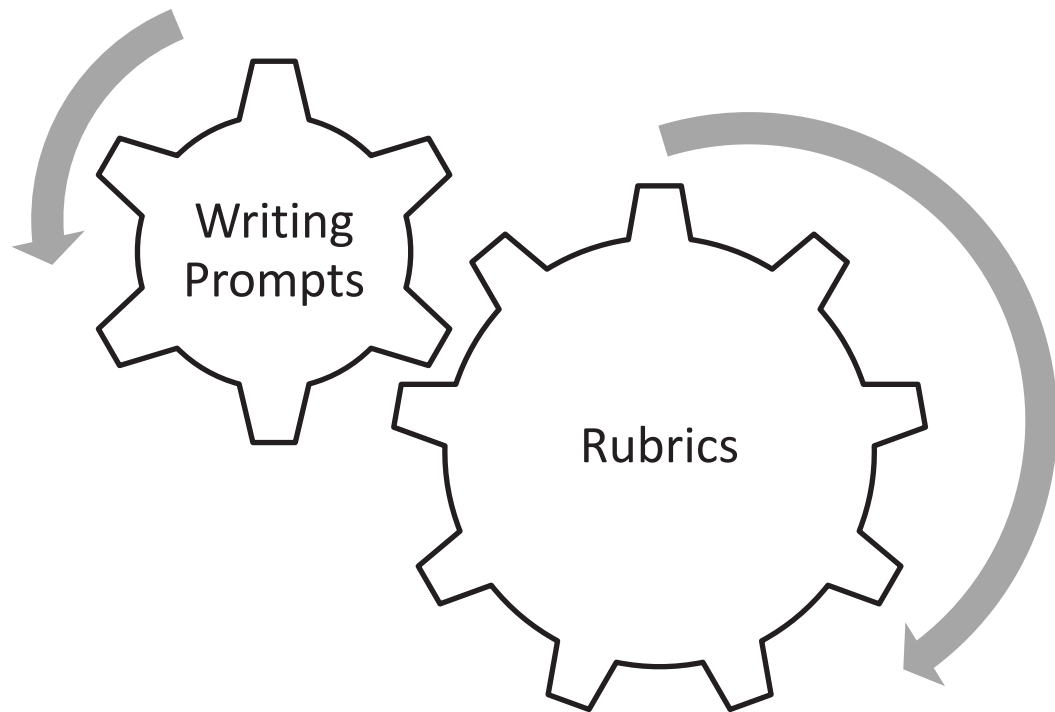
conclusion to close the paper. They've learned the middle already and are pleased when they realize what they've accomplished so far.

Credit for Completion for Process Work

Many assignments do not merit a letter grade, but if we don't assign some worth to it, students won't do it or will do a haphazard job at best. We've all had students ask, "Are you going to collect this?" We think, "Well, we hadn't planned on it, but...." What they are really asking is "Can I ignore it now and ask to do it as homework?" So we collect everything as formative assessment and hone in on a special focus for that particular assignment.

Writing in Class vs. Writing as Homework

We recommend that all writing be done in class for groups other than honors. This is a revolutionary idea. I know, we just had to say it one more time.



TEACHING THE MULTIPARAGRAPH ESSAY

ESSAY SCORING GUIDE

A Excellent

- ❑ Excellent concrete detail; correct and skillful use of transitions and lead- ins
- ❑ Insightful commentary
- ❑ Finds connections
- ❑ Organization is clear and logical
- ❑ Very few, if any, mechanical errors
- ❑ Powerful vocabulary
- ❑ Excellent sentence variety
- ❑ Repeats little or not at all

B Good

- ❑ Good concrete detail; correct use of transitions and lead- ins.
- ❑ Good commentary but less so than an "A"
- ❑ Organization is clear but not as skillfully done as the "A" papers
- ❑ Some mechanical errors may be present, more than the "A" papers
- ❑ Good vocabulary
- ❑ Above- average sentence variety
- ❑ Repeats more than the "A" paper but less than the "C" paper

C Adequate

- ❑ Follows format (ratio; word counts; sentence layout, if required)
- ❑ Acceptable CD; generic CD
- ❑ Obvious, superficial, irrelevant, or generic commentary (GC)
- ❑ Organization is present but less skillfully done than the "B" papers
- ❑ Some mechanical errors present , more than a B paper
- ❑ Average vocabulary or odd word choice
- ❑ Limited sentence variety
- ❑ Repeats are a problem

D Demonstrates Problems

- ❑ Too many mechanical errors (run- ons, fragments, spelling, contractions, apostrophes)
- ❑ Did not copy correctly from the story or the board
- ❑ Uses past tense instead of literary present tense (LP)
- ❑ Does not follow the format (ratio; word counts; sentence layout)
- ❑ CD problems: weak CD (WCD); factual errors; problems with MLA citation format; problems with TLCD; no lead- in; weak lead- in.
- ❑ CM problems: weak CM (WCM); not commentary (NCM); mainly plot summary or restatement of CD; CM doesn't fit the CD, generic CM.
- ❑ Chunk doesn't fit TS (not coherent).
- ❑ Filler
- ❑ Organization is unclear.
- ❑ Simple vocabulary and word choice (WC), odd word choice; slang (SL); wrong word (WW); odd phrasing
- ❑ Little sentence variety
- ❑ Repeats are a bigger problem than with the "C" paper
- ❑ Uses no- no words, including *you, your, yours, would, should, could, may, might; I, me, my* in a literature paper

F Fails to meet standards

JANE SCHAFFER WRITING PROGRAM™ SCORING GUIDE WITH 6 TRAITS

Ideas and Content

A B C D F

- Thesis/topic sentences contain commentary words
- Appropriate and significant concrete detail
- Insightful commentary that finds connections between characters, events, themes, or global perspectives
- Follows format as appropriate (ratio, sentence layout, word counts, chunking)
- Ideas are fully developed

Organization

A B C D F

- Transitions and lead-ins used skillfully
- Sequencing of ideas clear, logical, and effective
- Pacing and overall effect and smooth and balanced
- Sustained focus to each paragraph and essay as a whole
- Composition has a sense of completeness
- Intro and conclusion are meaningful and add depth to the composition
- Writer's progression of thought from sentence to sentence and paragraph to paragraph is smooth and controlled
- Logical movement from idea to idea
- Organization enhances the writer's ability to present ideas clearly and effectively

Voice

A B C D F

- Individual, expressive, and engaging concrete detail and commentary
- Appropriate for audience and purpose
- Authentic and original sound to the paper
- Shows writer's individuality or unique perspective
- Writer engages the reader

Word Choice

A B C D F

- Powerful, accurate, specific vocabulary
- Academic language as appropriate
- Few repeats
- Word choice enhances the overall effectiveness of the communication of ideas

Sentence Fluency

A B C D F

- Strong, concise sentences that are smooth and fluid
- Sentences vary in length and structure
- Easy to read aloud
- Sentences enhance the overall effectiveness of the communication of ideas

Conventions

A B C D F

- Overall strength of the conventions contributes to the effectiveness of the composition
- Few/no weak words: thing, something, anything, everything, nothing, you
- No speculative words in a literature paper (would, could, should, may, might, if, then)
- No personal pronouns in body paragraphs in a literature paper (I, me, my, we, us, our, ours, mine)
- Text looks clean, edited, and polished

Name _____ Date _____

Essay Topic _____

#	Description of Mistake	# of times in this paper
1	awkward, choppy	
2	cliché, vocabulary	
3	fragment	
4	no-no words (would, should, could, may, if, you, your, I, me, my, we, us, our, ours)	
5	problems with concrete detail	
6	problems with commentary	
7	punctuation	
8	run-on sentence	
9	verb tense	
10	subject-verb agreement	
11	word choice	
12	repeats	
○	spelling	

Grade _____

Name: _____

Date: _____

Paragraph Topic: _____

	DESCRIPTION OF MISTAKE / BEGINNING RUBRIC	NUMBER OF TIMES IN THIS PAPER
1 .	Huh? Didn't understand (no comprendo, nie ponemaesh)	
2 .	Indenting	
3 .	Not a commentary	
4 .	Not a concrete detail	
5 .	Needs concrete details/more specifics/more information	
6 .	Problems with concrete detail Pronoun Problem (he, she, it, they, them, us, we)	
7 .	Punctuation (. ! ' ; ")	
8 .	Repeat word(s) repeated or idea(s) repeated	
9 .	Spelling (spelling/contractions/abbreviations/spell out numbers 1-100)	
10 .	Subject-verb agreement	
11 .	Verb tense (past, present, future)	
12 .	Incomplete paragraph	
13 .	Problems with thesis or no thesis	
TOTAL NUMBER OF ERRORS IN THIS PAPER:		

Name: _____

Date: _____

Essay Topic: _____

	DESCRIPTION OF MISTAKE / INTERMEDIATE RUBRIC	NUMBER OF TIMES IN THIS PAPER
1 .	Awkward/choppy/unclear/words omitted	
2 .	Filler/strays from the topic	
3 .	Problems with thesis or no thesis	
4 .	Huh? Didn't understand	
5 .	MLA problems (citation heading) title page/indenting/margins format	
6 .	No-no words (would, should, could, might, if, you, your, yours, I, me, my, we, us, our, ours in literature papers)	
7 .	Not a commentary	
8 .	Not a concrete detail	
9 .	Needs to relate to concrete detail/more specifics/more information	
10 .	Problems with concrete detail	
11 .	Pronoun antecedent (problem - he, she, it, they, them, us, we)	
12 .	Punctuation (. ! ' : ; ")	
13 .	Repeat word(s) repeated or idea(s) repeated	
14 .	Run-on sentence	
15 .	Spelling (sp/cap/contr/abb/apost)/conventions/spell out numbers	
16 .	Subject-verb agreement	
17 .	Verb tense (past, present, and future tenses)	
18 .	Word choice	
19 .	Wordy	
20 .	Wrong word	
21 .	Incomplete paragraph/essay/did not follow guidelines	
22 .	Did not address the prompt/summary	
TOTAL NUMBER OF ERRORS IN THIS PAPER:		

Name: _____

Date: _____

Essay Topic: _____

	DESCRIPTION OF MISTAKE / INTERMEDIATE RUBRIC	NUMBER OF TIMES IN THIS PAPER
1 .	Awkward/choppy/unclear/words omitted	
2 .	Cliché/trite vocabulary/dead words/slang	
3 .	Filler/strays from the topic	
4 .	Fragment	
5 .	Problems with thesis or no thesis	
6 .	Huh? Didn't understand	
7 .	Sentence fluency	
8 .	MLA problems (citation heading) title page/indenting/margins	
9 .	No-no words (would, should, could, might, if, you, your, yours, I, me, my, we, us, our, ours in literature papers)	
10 .	Not a commentary	
11 .	Not a concrete detail	
12 .	Parallel structure	
13 .	Passive voice	
14 .	Needs to relate to concrete detail/more specifics/more	
15 .	Problems with concrete detail	
16 .	Pronoun antecedent	
17 .	Punctuation	
18 .	Repeats	
19 .	Run-on sentence	
20 .	Spelling (sp/cap/contr/abb/apost)/conventions/spell out numbers	
21 .	Subject-verb agreement	
22 .	Transition language to concrete detail	
23 .	Verb tense	
24 .	Word choice	
25 .	Wordy	
26 .	Wrong word	
27 .	Introduction: anecdote, dialogue, or starting information	
28 .	Ending (new information, too long, "zinger," missing)	
29 .	Incomplete paragraph/essay/did not follow guidelines	
30 .	Did not address the prompt/summary	
TOTAL NUMBER OF ERRORS IN THIS PAPER:		

Writing Scoring Guide Grade 3

4 Points

The paper:

- Has an effective beginning, middle, and end.
- Contains a clear controlling idea.
- Clearly addresses the topic and provides specific and relevant details/examples.
- Contains words that are specific, accurate, and suited to the topic.
- Consistently uses complete sentences.
- Clearly shows an awareness of audience and purpose.
- Contains few errors in grammar/usage, punctuation, capitalization, and/or spelling.

3 Points

The paper:

- Has a beginning, middle, and end.
- Contains a controlling idea.
- Addresses the topic and uses relevant details/examples.
- Contains some words that are specific, accurate, and related to the topic.
- Generally uses complete sentences.
- Shows an awareness of audience and purpose.
- May contain some errors in grammar/usage, punctuation, capitalization, and/or spelling that are not significantly distracting to the reader.

2 Points

The paper:

- Has evidence of a beginning, middle, and end.
- Contains a general sense of direction, but may lack focus.
- Generally addresses the topic, but may contain some details that are not relevant.
- Uses words that tend to be repetitive, imprecise, and ordinary.
- Contains some incomplete sentences that may be distracting to the reader.
- Shows some awareness of audience and purpose.
- Contains errors in grammar/usage, punctuation, capitalization and/or spelling that may be distracting to the reader.

1 Point

The paper:

- May lack evidence of a beginning, middle, and/or end.
- Is difficult to follow and/or lacks focus.
- Attempts to address topic, but lacks development.
- Uses words that are consistently repetitive, dull, and colorless.
- Includes incomplete sentences that are distracting to the reader.
- Shows little or no awareness of audience and purpose.
- Contains repeated errors in grammar/usage, punctuation, capitalization and/or spelling that may be distracting to the reader.

**CONNECTICUT MASTERY TEST
RUBRIC FOR NARRATIVE WRITING
Grade 4**

Score Point 6

Well-developed narratives; writers expand on all key events and characters

- fully elaborated with specific details
- strong organizational strategy/sequencing
- fluent

Score Point 5

Developed narratives; writers expand on most key events and characters

- moderately well-elaborated with mostly specific details
- generally strong organizational strategy/sequencing
- moderately fluent

Score Point 4

Somewhat-developed narratives; some expansion of key events and characters

- adequately elaborated with mix of general and specific details
- satisfactory organizational strategy/sequencing
- somewhat fluent

Score Point 3

Minimally-developed narratives; little expansion of key events and characters; some details just listed

- more general than specific details
- some evidence of organization/sequencing
- some awkwardness may be present

Score Point 2

Undeveloped narratives; usually brief responses, details just listed

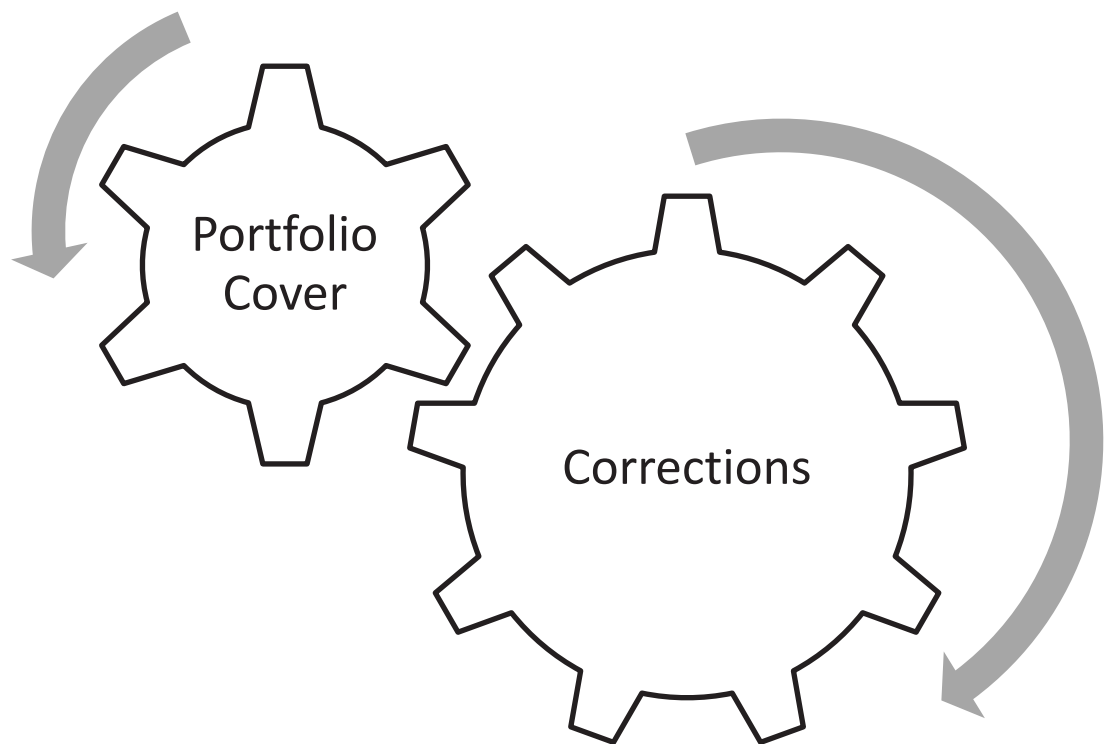
- mostly general details
- may be disorganized/weak sequencing
- may be awkward and confused

Score Point 1

Very sparse narratives

- may have few/vague details
- too brief to indicate sequencing
- awkward and confused

Analytic Rubric/Scoring Guide: Autobiographical Narrative				
Content & Organization	Weak		Strong	
The writer is clearly established as the main character.	1	2	3	4
The writer sticks to first-person point of view.	1	2	3	4
The setting is described with vivid sensory details.	1	2	3	4
The writer includes interesting details and dialogue to reveal characters' personalities.	1	2	3	4
The central conflict or problem is clearly explained.	1	2	3	4 x2
The events are organized in chronological order.	1	2	3	4
The writer uses transition/signal words and phrases to clarify the order of events.	1	2	3	4 x2
The writer includes thoughts, feelings, and reactions.	1	2	3	4 x2
The writer ends with a thoughtful discussion of the personal insight, lesson or value gained from this event.	1	2	3	4 x3
Proofreading				
The verbs are written in the correct tense.	1	2	3	4 x2
The sentence subjects and verbs agree.	1	2	3	4
The words are spelled correctly.	1	2	3	4
The paper is free of run-on sentences.	1	2	3	4



Jane's #10 Non-Negotiable: Multiyear, Cumulative Writing Folders/Portfolios

For each student we have multiyear, cumulative writing folders that we pass on to the next teacher each fall.

We can't say enough about writing folders. They have helped the writing lives for our students and for us in ways almost too numerous to describe. No one reads writing folders from beginning to end; that's not our purpose in keeping them.

Our five purposes are:

1. *Storage*
Students lose papers; teachers don't. We store the folders in a safe place in each teacher's classroom, often behind the teacher's desk or in file cabinets not easily accessible to students. They are immediately available for one of the other four purposes.
2. *Parent conferences*
We take them to every parent conference in case they are helpful in answering questions. One parent of a sophomore said that her son hadn't done any essays in ninth grade. We showed her the four essays that he had completed in his freshman year (of the required six we had agreed on) and the two cover sheets that showed non-completion. Those papers answered any questions she might have had. The conversation was over. Without the writing folder, it would have been the "he said, she said" conversation with which we are familiar. We don't let "live" papers leave the folder because they have occasionally been lost in transit when the student took them home. We offer to photocopy the paper if the family would like a copy sent home.
3. *Student self-reflection*
Students do a self-analysis of their folders twice a year at the end of each semester. We've included the self-reflection form on our website. We don't need a lesson plan on these days. Students are ghoulishly curious about their earlier work and often say, "I can't believe how much I've learned!" It warms our hearts.
4. *Teacher reference*
If teachers want to look at previous papers, they can do so without delay. For example, if the current teacher is having difficulty teaching the introduction, she may skim last year's essays to glean ideas and see what the student wrote previously. Teachers can also contact last year's teacher listed on the cover sheet.
5. *Teacher accountability*
If the department has agreed on the number of paragraphs and essays to be done in a given year, they should all be in the writing folder. If they are not,

we check to see what happened: Did the student transfer after ninth grade began? Did the teacher do all the required papers? This can sometimes lead to an administrator entering the conversation to confirm that the teacher is adhering to department policies and, if not, help the teacher do so.

What Writing Folders Include and What They Don't

Writing folders (also called *portfolios*) show a student's writing life at our school. They contain all major process paragraphs and essays, all timed writings (on-demand papers), and any local assessments. We also add any papers we inherit from another school. We pass the folders on to the next teacher in the fall and give them to seniors before they graduate.

Our folders are a collection, not a selection. If students are allowed to select which papers to delete, they will often omit a paper that teachers wish were there later on. If it's a lower grade that has been deleted, teachers don't have a comparison to show how far the student has come. One folder has been large enough to serve students well during grades three, four, and five, even with each process paper including all the steps that students have completed.

Small assignments like vocabulary quizzes and quickwrites aren't included. We call this group of work *Small Stuff*. Small Stuff, collages, artwork all go in a different folder. We only place published or non-published paragraphs and essays in the writing portfolios.

We recommend that elementary portfolios move to feeder middle schools, and middle school portfolios feed to high schools, which teachers read and either return them to their owners or file the contents into their middle school or high school folders. To ignore what students have written before high school strikes us as rude and disrespectful to our colleagues and students alike. We can learn what kinds of assignments they did and what grades they earned.

- We provide the student name labels, printed by our registrar. Students don't label their own. Too often, they do it incorrectly, giving their first names first or writing illegibly.
- We use multi-colored file folders, a different color for each year. It's worth the money.
- Some schools pre-print folders with an index or a table of contents by grade level.
- Some schools have electronic portfolios, and we like this method the best.

Cover Sheet

All major paragraph and essay assignments have a cover sheet. We issue the cover sheets the day the assignment is due. If we give them out beforehand, many students lose them.

The routine of the order is this:

- cover sheet on top
- final draft next
- all pieces of the first draft in order next
- the scoring guide next
- grading codes at the end

For students who haven't done the assignment, we give them two copies of the cover sheet to complete -- one for their writing folders and another for us to keep in case the writing folder version disappears. We had a problem with students taking the first copy as if the assignment never existed. We haven't needed to use the duplicate since then to show parents; requiring it has stopped the problem. We staple the cover sheet in front of any pieces of the process that the students may have completed and put it in the writing folder. Otherwise, the cover sheet goes into the folder by itself. Sometimes, we print a red cover sheet for incomplete work (the "Scarlet Letter" version) and blue for summer school papers.

Sometimes the reason that the student gives at the bottom is serious and needs immediate attention. One girl wrote that her father had died recently. She couldn't bring herself to say it, but the cover sheet allowed her a chance to write it to us. Most of the time, though, students say, "I forgot" or "I didn't do it."

End of Semester and Year

- Students do a self-analysis of their folders twice a year at the end of each semester. We've included the self-reflection form on our website.
- We don't give students their folders to review over the summer. It's a good and worthy idea, but it hasn't worked. Some students will scrutinize every comma, but they are rarely the ones who need to, and the ones who should, don't. In the fall, in addition, many forget to return with their folders in the fall and have to be reminded more than once.

Moving Them to the Next Teacher (Pass-Along Folders)

Overview. We use three approaches to moving the folders to the next teacher. Folder Swap #1 and #2 transfers the folders to the next teacher. Each June, prior to the new school year, teachers arrange their folders in boxes alphabetically by period or by a compilation of all of their students, whichever is easier for them.

E-Portfolios. These days, some schools have purchased enough bandwidth to house their students' portfolios electronically. Students upload their final drafts into their personal folders: a .pdf of the final draft with the teacher's comments and the final score (secured); and corrections of the final draft in Word (especially narratives for accumulating college essay topics). Many more applications and clouds are developing every day to house portfolios.

Hard-Copy Portfolios: Two Options

- *Folder Swap #1.* In the fall on a given Wednesday (the highest attendance day of the week for both students and teachers), students go to their previous year's English teachers, collect their folders, and return to class. This takes about ten minutes per period. We have learned to alert administration so they know that these students are not out of class without permission at the beginning of each period.

For teachers who are no longer with the school or out on leave, we assign their boxes to another teacher and tell students. For example, we say, “If you had Mrs. Schaffer last year, she’s on leave. Mrs. Smith has her folders in room E-1.”

The unclaimed folders are sent then to the department chair who groups them by year and stores them until the year after those students would have graduated. If we know where the student has transferred, we contact the new school about sending the folder on (if the system is truly on point, students who transfer from the school receive their portfolio as they leave).

- *Folder Swap #2.* Some schools use Folder Swap #2 to monitor students more easily during the folder pick-up. They take all the boxes identified on the outside by teacher to a central location like an unused classroom or a spare storage room. Each class goes there with its teacher to retrieve their folders. Departments organize a schedule and accomplish the job over a week or two. This method is less chaotic for some schools.

Our goal is to have the folders re-distributed within six weeks from the beginning of school, but that is up to each site to decide what is most workable. Schools with little transiency can disseminate the folders earlier; schools with higher transiency rates usually need to wait a bit for class lists to settle down.

COVER SHEET PARAGRAPHS AND ESSAYS

NAME: _____

DATE: _____

FORMAT: ☐ **PROCESS PAPER (2 or more drafts)**
☐ **TIMED WRITING**
☐ **ONE-CHUNK PARAGRAPH**
☐ **TWO-CHUNK PARAGRAPH**

PROMPT: _____

CLASS/LEVEL: _____

TEACHER: _____

**IF YOU DID NOT DO THIS ASSIGNMENT, COMPLETE
THIS SECTION AND SIGN BELOW:**

I did not do this assignment because

SIGNED: _____

_____ Elementary School
Essay Cover Sheet
Grade Level: K 1 2 3 4 5

NAME _____

DUE DATE: _____

FORMAT (Circle one.): __ CHUNK(S) PARAGRAPH ESSAY

PROMPT: _____

TYPE (Circle one): NARRATIVE EXPOSITORY / INFORMATIONAL
OPINION RESPONSE TO LITERATURE

MY ORIGINAL TITLE: _____

(underlined or quotation marks?)

CLASS / PERIOD: _____

TEACHER: M _____

THIS STUDENT TURNED IN THE ESSAY LATE.

DATE TURNED IN: _____

LATE POLICY: (1st day, minus ____; 2nd day, minus ____; 3rd day, minus ____)
(reserved for teacher)

----- **THIS STUDENT CHOSE NOT TO DO THE ESSAY.**
(Student Signature)

SCHOOL

Essay Cover Sheet

Grade Level: 6 7 8 9 10 11 12

NAME _____

DUE DATE: _____

FORMAT: (Circle one.)

PROCESS PAPER

TIMED WRITING

ESSAY TOPIC: _____

_____ minutes

ESSAY CHOICE: (if applicable) _____

MODE: _____

MY ORIGINAL TITLE: _____

(underlined or quotation marks?)

CLASS / PERIOD: _____

TEACHER:

M _____

THIS STUDENT TURNED IN THE ESSAY LATE.

DATE TURNED IN: _____

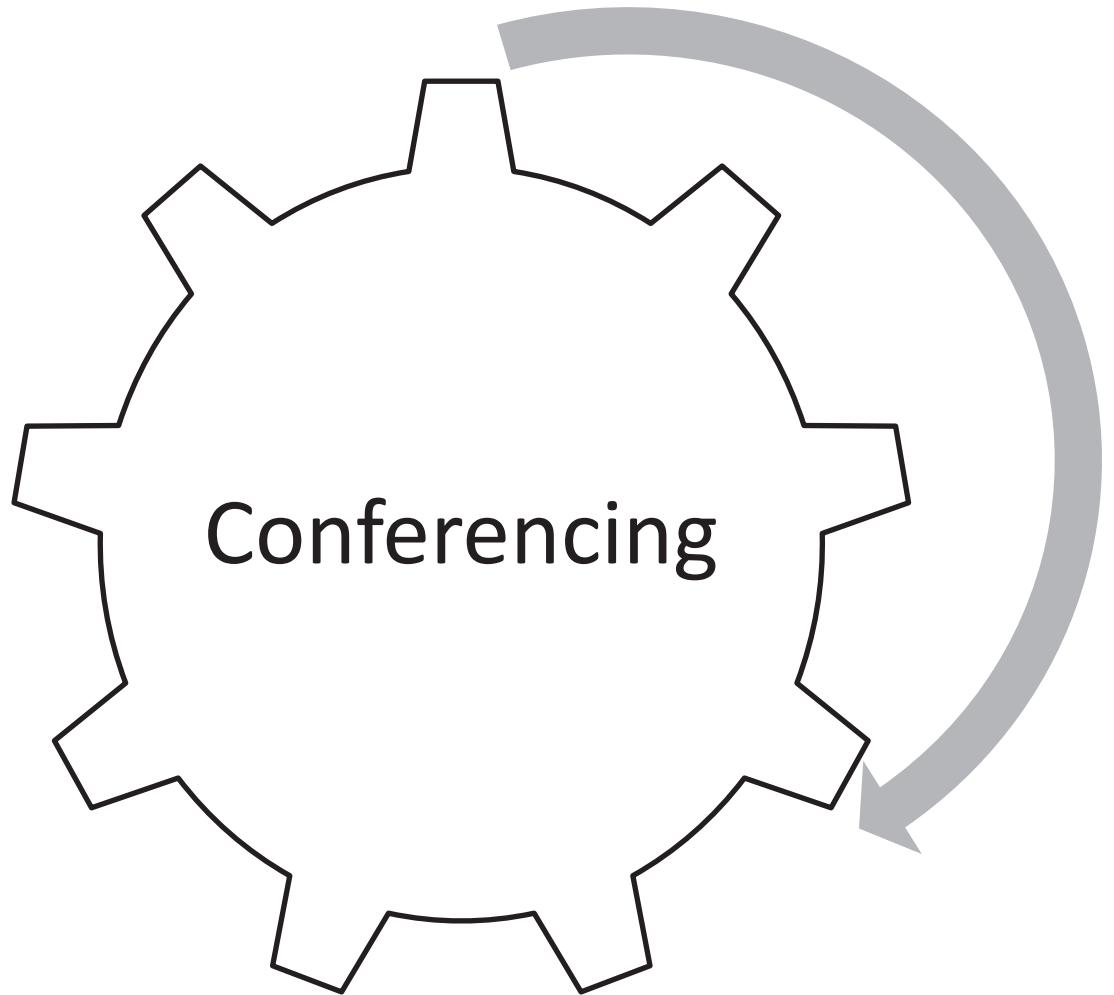
LATE POLICY: (1st day, minus ____; 2nd day, minus ____; 3rd day, minus ____)

(reserved for teacher)

THIS STUDENT CHOSE NOT TO DO THE ESSAY.

REASON: _____

(Student Signature)



Jane's #9 Non-Negotiable: One-to-one Conferencing

As a department, we decided to institute this one-to-one conferencing as a standard teacher tool in all of our classes. Its impact surpassed our greatest expectations. Without one-to-one conferencing, we could not elicit the quality and quantity of thought that appear in our students' papers.

Description

One-to-one conferencing means seeing students individually either in or outside of class. We have developed two versions, one we call *Row Running (RR)* and another called *Table Talks (TT)*.

With Row Running (RR), the talk is public and informal. It deals with only one or two steps in the writing process, so it is quick, fewer than thirty seconds per student. As its name implies, the teacher is on his or her feet, walking up and down the rows, checking work all the while – not sitting at the teacher's desk but out keeping things moving. Desks must be arranged so that the teacher can move easily in and out without retracing steps. It can be a quick five seconds of praise or thirty seconds of direction, always positive. Good work is recognized, and those who need help are going to get it.

With Table Talks (TT), students come up to the teacher's desk or table for approximately two to five minutes to discuss a thornier, lengthier problem. The teacher can sit across from or next to the student. It is private and more intense than RR. We use a timer if we tend to run over. If the issue can't be addressed in two to five minutes, the student meets with us later or arranges a time before or after school. If it works better for the class, TT can be done quietly with the teacher sitting in a student desk to confer instead of up front. This is a good idea when some students might disrupt others just by walking up to our table.

There are two schools of thought regarding conferencing: in-class and outside of class. Our preference is in-class at specified checkpoints and other points that students request.

No student is allowed to ask, "Would you look at my paper?" That person wants us to catch every mistake so the paper receives the "A" that the writer feels it's entitled to.

Purpose

RR is for us to check for understanding at certain points in the process and re-teach as necessary. Sometimes we can do the re-teaching right there at the moment; sometimes we need to see the student for a longer period of time or at a TT. And sometimes, we notice that a problem applies to many students, so we re-teach the point to the entire class.

TT's are designed for a more relaxed conversation. Each student has our undivided attention for approximately two to five minutes. We also implement differentiated instruction here. Each student receives the individual help he or she needs.

Audience

For RR, we see all students' current work at their desks as we walk around. For TT, we give ourselves two choices, voluntary or mandatory. Both approaches work. With younger students or less experienced writers, we tend to require TT; with older, more advanced students, we more often call for voluntary sign-ups.

All students must arrive with something written down to start. We don't allow blank papers with one exception: special education and English Language Learners (ELL) students who may need help just getting the first pre-writing words down on paper.

Frequency

We use RR to check every step of the process, from prompt to final draft, until we decide that students don't need as much monitoring. This means checking early and checking often; as long as we don't look at more than one or two points, RR goes quickly as it should. Once students have internalized the writing process, we check less frequently, but we never completely stop RR. We catch too many mistakes and re-direct students before the paper goes too far wrong. For example, a student may have not done the pre-writing pages as thoroughly as we want and may choose a weak concrete detail that isn't productive or is so closely related to another concrete detail that the commentary will be repetitive. The writing will be affected by this choice, so we return the student to revisit his/her pre-writing and do a more thoughtful job.

Every teacher has thought, "If I had caught this paper earlier, I could have stopped the problems I'm seeing now." To address that concern, we do TT with every major paragraph and essay assignment -- without fail. The most common first TT is the first draft, but you can do TT for earlier steps, depending on the class's needs. Students may come up for "second helpings" if you have time. Sometimes we limit a student to one or two conferences, regardless of how much time we have available, so that we aren't essentially writing the paper for him or her.

For RR, we can reach thirty-five to forty students in fifteen minutes. With TT, we need two days to see everyone once, but we have to move quickly and watch our time. Getting through a large class is challenging but feasible.

Record Keeping

For RR, students earn credit for completion, so we take a copy of our class list or the seating chart to record work and later transfer it to our computers.

For TT, the record-keeping is more complicated. We have a dated sign-in sheet up front for both mandatory and voluntary TT. At the end of the class period, we collect the sheet and save it for the current year and the next year for reference. It has helped us when parents question the student's grade and ask when or if we gave individual help. Students sign their own names.

Teachers may annotate the list as they wish with comments about the contents of the conference, but it isn't required.

Sample Questions We Ask in a Conference

Questions and comments can apply to anything we notice in the paper. Here is a representative sample:

- “You wrote the word *yearn* on your WOW page for *Of Mice and Men* but didn’t complete the page. What does it mean for people like George and Lennie to *yearn* for something?” Or the same question in different words: “When people like George and Lennie *yearn* for something, they.... – now complete the thought for me with some commentary ideas.”
- See video samples on our website of Deborah Louis providing TT. They are longer than the normal 2-5 minutes so that you will see the various questions asked of a student.

Scribing

For both RR and TT, *scribing* means writing down what a student says. It’s like taking dictation. We learned to do this when students were working so hard to think a thought that they didn’t remember what they said even thirty seconds before. Taking notes while students talk through their writing concerns solves this problem. We use student papers or 4x6 post-it pads or have students take their own notes. They are often surprised and pleased when they read what they said. When we show our notes to them, we often hear reactions such as “I said that? I sound smart!”

For TT, scribing can be done on a computer as the student talks. We can print our notes to be included with the final draft.

Classroom Management

For both RR and TT, we have never once had a class stay completely on task, and that applies to Pre-AP® and AP® classes as well. The teacher is not standing in front of the class, and students tend to misbehave. They know our attention is diverted. It’s like a toddler who knows that when his mother is on the phone, it’s time to turn on the water in the tub.

In order to address classroom management when providing TT, we always have a parallel assignment operating at the same time as conferences, based on the class’s needs and one that is subject to assessment at any moment. These assignments are nicknamed *autopilot*. Our job is to keep students engaged with an assignment that reinforces some aspect of the curriculum (i.e. writing, vocabulary work, or projects).

The concept and implementation of Blended Learning, however, has saved us. With student assignments delivered via online courses, digital content, and other technology applications, students seem to focus much better. If you have a 1:1 laptop program, create a webquest or have the students working on an online self-paced project while you are giving TT. If your department has a technology budget, request noise-canceling headphones for students to use as they work on the computer. The Silence will be Golden!

Even with blended learning and autopilot, though, we are no longer surprised that we sometimes still have to tell our students to get back to work. It's the nature of the beast. We tend not to have parallel assignments for RR; students are working on their papers or waiting briefly for us to get around, but sometimes we choose to create a short one for the minutes involved.

One Final Caveat and a General Observation

A warning: On conferencing days, we are more tired than we believed was possible. We are not one teacher with thirty-five students; we are thirty-five different teachers because we are giving each student something tailored to him or her. We don't recommend doing one-to-one conferencing more than twice a day until teachers gain a sense of their stamina doing it. Furthermore, your fatigue will affect your conferencing skills. Stagger your class table talks:

<i>Traditional Schedule: 45 – 55 minute periods*</i>	<i>A/B 90-minute Block Schedule*</i>
• Week 1: ○ Monday, Tuesday: Periods 1, 4 ○ Wednesday, Thursday: Periods 2, 5 ○ Friday – Second Helpings • Week 2: ○ Monday, Tuesday: Periods 3, 6 ○ Wednesday, Thursday: Period 7 ○ Friday – Second Helpings	• Week 1: ○ A Day: Blocks 1, 3 ○ B Day: Blocks 2, 4 ○ A Day: Blocks 1, 3 ○ B Day: Blocks 2, 4 • Week 2: ○ A Day: Blocks 5, 7 ○ B Day: Blocks 6, 8 ○ A Day: Blocks 5, 7 ○ B Day: Blocks 6, 8

*with more than one prep (which we all usually have), pair the same prep for each day.

One-to-one conferences also address a point mentioned earlier: talking is the missing link in writing. It allows students to say what's in their heads. Done consistently over a period of weeks and months, they learn to trust themselves and believe in their ability to think thoughts without our prompting them. Moreover, they start to hear you ask the same questions or provide the same comments, and they begin to assimilate those questions and comments as they write individually, and the TT's become shorter and more concise. We cannot express the total impact, both tangible and intangible, that your one-to-one teaching can have on a child's life.

Writing Workshop: A Helping Hand

Dear Writing Coach, I am writing my essay on _____
_____.

and I need advice on my

Students must choose one for today's conference:

Parts of an Essay

- ☐ Introduction
- ☐ Thesis statement
- ☐ Body Paragraph # ____
- ☐ Topic Sentence
- ☐ Concrete Detail
- ☐ Commentary
- ☐ Concluding Sentence
- ☐ Conclusion

My specific question is

- ☐ How do I start? _____
- ☐ I seem to be repeating myself.
- ☐ I do not know how to say what I'm trying to say.
- ☐ I do not know how to _____
- ☐ I cannot tell the difference between concrete detail and commentary.
- ☐ What can I do to make this part sound more convincing?
- ☐ I need help with transitions.
- ☐ Is my writing logical in this paragraph based on my topic sentence?
- ☐ Can you see any no-no words in this section?
- ☐ I struggle with _____. Would you check that in this section?

☐ Would you check one of these grammar components in this section?

☐ Punctuation ☐ Capitalization ☐ Agreement ☐ Spelling ☐ Possessive Case

☐ Would you check my syntax in this section?

☐ Sentence Beginnings Vary ☐ Sentence Types Vary ☐ A Sentence's Parallel Structure

☐ Literary Analysis Questions

☐ When do I use the word "speaker" and when do I use the word "author?"

☐ How do I quote lines from a poem?

☐ I am struggling with embedding quotations. Would you help me embed this particular quotation?

☐ I'm trying to decide which of my selected quotes is the best to support my topic sentence.

☐ Research Questions

☐ Parenthetical citations format

☐ Works Cited Question

☐ Narrative Questions

☐ I need help writing dialogue.

☐ I need help with my back story.

☐ I need help with the conflict.

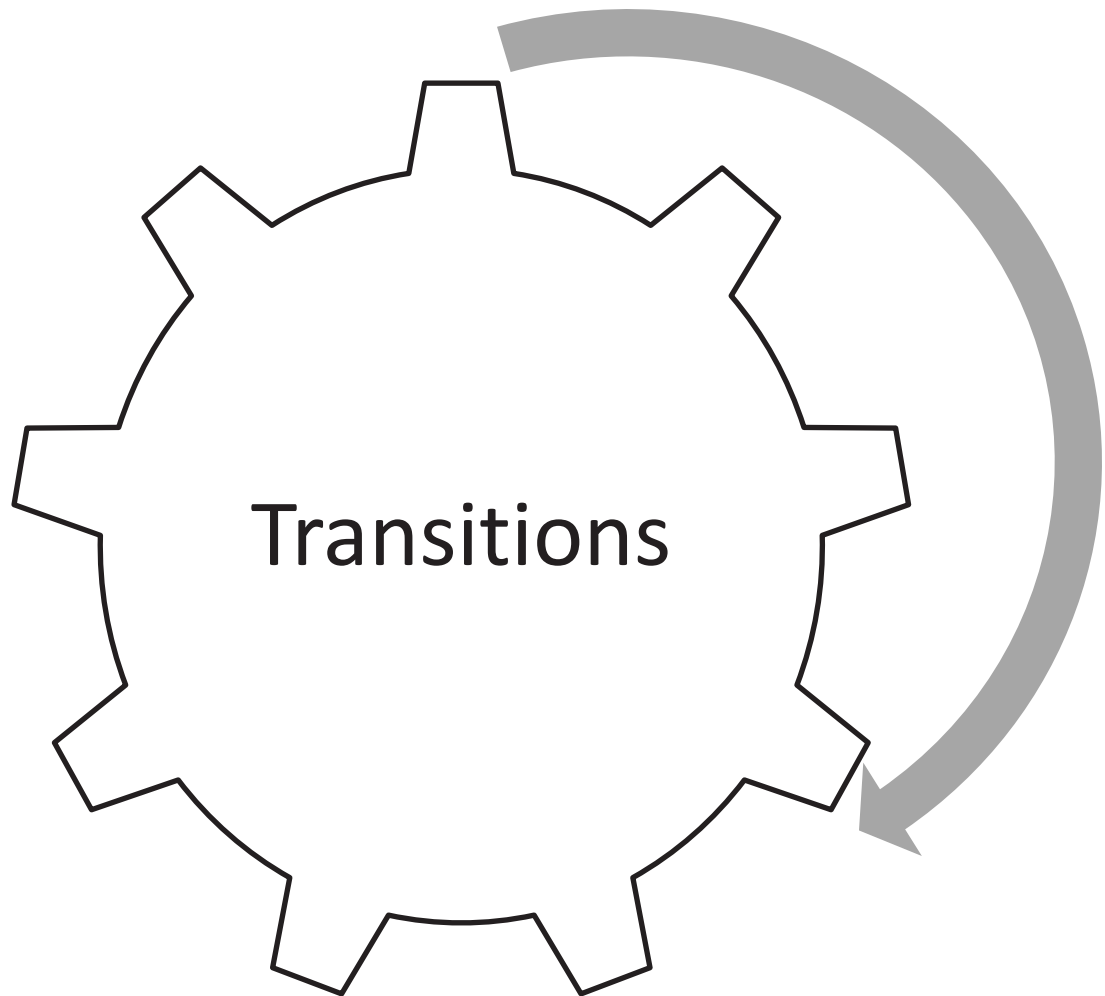
☐ I need help with the resolution.

Where is the Jane Schaffer Writing Program Headed Now?

Since its inception, it has moved across the curriculum to include content-area paragraphs and essays and toward other genres more common to the English curriculum, such as expository, narrative, and persuasive. In student teaching, people still don't always receive instruction in ways to teach writing, so this guide continues to fill that gap. Based on the feedback we receive from our students, from other schools, from our graduates in college, and from our students in the world of work, we know we are achieving our goal. The following reveal just a few of hundreds of testimonials:

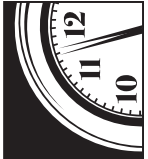
- *I am the English Department Chair for a diverse-ability, multi-ethnic high school with 1,100 students. Jane's program is the best I've seen to use with these students, because it reaches all ability levels; once they master the basics, they can go on to "weaving," as Jane calls it, and soar! But they need a format they can understand, and this works! We are implenting her program department-wide next year, after having had great results piloting it this year.*
- *As a Director of Curriculum for a large school district, I am now sold on the Schaffer model. Teachers attending the workshops have a good time, think hard, and leave with something they can use in their classroom the next day. The program has also been successful with our "Writing across the Curriculum" implementation.*
- *Each year my former high school students return from college excited that the Jane Schaffer Writing Program prepared them so well for university-level work. The multiparagraph essay unit works with all levels of students.*
- *I love you, Jane Schaffer!!!!*

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TRANSITIONS THAT . . .

Personal and Fictional Narrative

 ADD	 COMPARE & CONTRAST	 SITUATE PEOPLE, PLACES, THINGS, & IDEAS	 CONSIDER TIME	 ARGUE / DISCUSS	 EMPHASIZE	
• Additionally,** • Again, • also • and • and then • as well as • besides • further • Furthermore, • in addition • Moreover, • next • nor • or • Secondly, • too <u>Introduce an Example</u> • For example, • For instance, • in particular • namely • specifically • such as • that is • to illustrate	<u>Introduce a Similarity</u> • In like manner • Likewise, • Similarly, <u>Introduce a Difference</u> • Alternatively, • And yet • at the same time • but • Conversely, • even so • for all that • ; however, • in contrast • in the same way • Nevertheless, • Nonetheless • notwithstanding • On the contrary, • on the other hand • or • otherwise • still • yet	• aboard • about • above • across • adjacent to • against • ahead of • along • alongside • amid • among • apart from • around • at • back of • before • behind • below • beneath • between • beyond • down • in-/outside • juxtaposed to • nearby • next to • opposite • throughout • underneath	• after • Afterward, • as soon as • at least • at the same time • at this point • before • during • earlier • eventually • finally • First, • formerly • in the beginning • in the end • in the meantime • in the past • Later, • Meanwhile, • moments later • now • presently • since • soon • sooner or later • then • until • when • while	<u>Introduce a Concession</u> • Admittedly, • Granted, • Although true . . . <u>Introduce a Refutation</u> • And yet, • but • Even so, • However, • Nevertheless, • notwithstanding • regardless • yet <u>Introduce a Purpose</u> • For this purpose, • To this end, • With this __ in mind,	• above all • assuredly • certainly • clearly • especially • equally important • even more important • In fact • Indeed, • No one denies • Of course, • The fact remains • the greatest • the worst • to be sure • undoubtedly • unquestionably	<u>Introduce a Result</u> • Accordingly, • as a result • because • Consequently, • for • For this reason, • Hence, • so • then • therefore • thereupon • thus <u>Introduce an Ending</u> • as has been noted • in any event • In brief, • In fact, • in other words • in short • in the end • indeed • on the whole • that is • to be sure

**In conclusion," and "To sum up," to be used sparingly, please.

*** Capitalization and punctuation marks assist in normal placement of sentence structures, but many constructions exist.

Where is the Jane Schaffer Writing Program Headed Now?

Since its inception, it has moved across the curriculum to include content-area paragraphs and essays and toward other genres more common to the English curriculum, such as expository, narrative, and persuasive. In student teaching, people still don't always receive instruction in ways to teach writing, so this guide continues to fill that gap. Based on the feedback we receive from our students, from other schools, from our graduates in college, and from our students in the world of work, we know we are achieving our goal. The following reveal just a few of hundreds of testimonials:

- *I am the English Department Chair for a diverse-ability, multi-ethnic high school with 1,100 students. Jane's program is the best I've seen to use with these students, because it reaches all ability levels; once they master the basics, they can go on to "weaving," as Jane calls it, and soar! But they need a format they can understand, and this works! We are implenting her program department-wide next year, after having had great results piloting it this year.*
- *As a Director of Curriculum for a large school district, I am now sold on the Schaffer model. Teachers attending the workshops have a good time, think hard, and leave with something they can use in their classroom the next day. The program has also been successful with our "Writing across the Curriculum" implementation.*
- *Each year my former high school students return from college excited that the Jane Schaffer Writing Program prepared them so well for university-level work. The multiparagraph essay unit works with all levels of students.*
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